TASTYR IQ

Contact Directory

309 Contacts | 12 Segments | Ranked 1–100
Complete CRM Reference Book

Prepared for Nik Amin (CEO) & Ali Mabsoute (CMO)
March 2026 | Confidential

HOW TO USE THIS DIRECTORY

This directory contains every contact in the Tastyr IQ CRM, organized by priority tier. Each contact card includes:

- **Rank (1-100):** Composite priority score. Higher = contact sooner.
- **Segment:** Category (Angel, VC, Restaurateur, etc.)
- **Connection Degree:** 1st (direct investor), 2nd (intros to investors), 3rd (ecosystem buzz), 4th (long-game)
- **Chain Strategy:** Which social influence chain this person belongs to
- **Why Contact:** Deep reasoning for why this person matters to Tastyr
- **Psychology:** Cialdini principle(s) to leverage in outreach
- **Emotional Trigger:** What makes them respond as a person
- **Warm Intro Path:** How Ali connects to this person
- **Draft Message:** Ready-to-send first-touch message

Card Border Colors

Color	Tier	Rank	Action
Green	Tier 1	70-100	Contact this week / next 2 weeks
Gold	Tier 2	40-69	Contact within month 1
Gray	Tier 3	1-39	Long-game relationship building

DIRECTORY OVERVIEW

Metric	Value
Total Contacts	309
Tier 1 (Rank 70-100)	148
Tier 2 (Rank 40-69)	150
Tier 3 (Rank 1-39)	11

Contacts by Segment

Segment	Count
VC	49
Angel	34
NJ-DE-Suburb	34
Restaurateur	32
Food Blogger	31
Media	25
Founder-Connector	24
Accelerator	24
Food Industry	24
University	21
PE	11

TIER 1 — CONTACT THIS WEEK — RANK 70-100

148 contacts — highest priority, highest impact

#1 Josh Kopelman

90

Founder & Managing Partner

VC | 1st

First Round Capital — Philadelphia, PA (University City HQ at ...

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/jkopelman

FOCUS: Generalist seed-stage: AI, consumer, enterprise, fintech, hardware, healthcare. First check into startups.

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$3M seed investments

NOTABLE: 1) Blue Apron (food/meal delivery) 2) Uber 3) Warby Parker 4) Square

TASTYR CONNECTION: First Round invested early in Blue Apron -- one of the landmark food-tech deals. Kopelman is a Wharton grad based in Philly, directly in Tastyr's back...

WHY CONTACT: Josh Kopelman at First Round Capital is a strategic VC target. First Round invested early in Blue Apron -- one of the landmark food-tech deals. Kopelman is a Wharton grad based in Philly, directly in ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Philly startup ecosystem connections; Wharton alumni network; First Round's community events in University City. First Round has explicit Philadelphia...

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Josh, I've been following your work with 1) Blue Apron (food/meal delivery) 2) Uber 3) Warby Parker 4) Square. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, pat...

#2 Isabelle Kent

89

CEO & Executive Director

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Startup Leaders (formerly Philly Startup Leaders) — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/isabellekent/ | Social: @Isabelle_Kent

TASTYR CONNECTION: PSL has run accelerator programs featuring food-tech startups. Her network includes food/restaurant founders who've gone through Founded In Philly.

WHY CONTACT: Isabelle Kent is an ecosystem super-connector. PSL has run accelerator programs featuring food-tech startups. Her network includes food/restaurant founders who've gone through Founded In Philly. A sin...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro Ali to virtually any Philly founder, mentor, or early-stage investor. Direct line to PSL's alumni network of 1,000+ founders. Can connect to...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Isabelle, Your role at Startup Leaders (formerly Philly Startup Leaders) caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I ...

#3 Danae Mobley

89

CEO of Coded by: & Executive Director of 1Philadelphia

Founder-Connector | 2nd

1Philadelphia (1PHL) / Coded by: — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/danaecmobley/ | Social: (org handle: @codedbykids)

TASTYR CONNECTION: 1PHL's innovation ecosystem touches food-tech through community events and partnerships. Philly Tech Week regularly features food/restaurant tech demo...

WHY CONTACT: Danae Mobley is an ecosystem super-connector. 1PHL's innovation ecosystem touches food-tech through community events and partnerships. Philly Tech Week regularly features food/restaurant tech demos an...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro Ali to Philly Tech Week speakers, corporate sponsors (Comcast, etc.), diversity-focused tech investors, and the entire 1PHL coalition of sta...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Danae, Your role at 1Philadelphia (1PHL) / Coded by: caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and g...

#4 Gabriel Weinberg

89

Founder & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

DuckDuckGo — Paoli, PA (Philadelphia suburbs)

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/yegg13/ | Social: @yeaboringgg (check current)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Consumer-facing product expertise directly relevant to Tastyr IQ's consumer/restaurant platform. Angel portfolio may include food-tech companies.

WHY CONTACT: Gabriel Weinberg is an ecosystem super-connector. Consumer-facing product expertise directly relevant to Tastyr IQ's consumer/restaurant platform. Angel portfolio may include food-tech companies. A si...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can provide angel investment directly. Can intro to his AngelList syndicate investors. Can connect to global tech network. His "Traction" book communi...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Gabriel, Your role at DuckDuckGo caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get 20 minutes? I'd l...

#5 Chris Stanchak

89

Founder & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Loveseat / StanForce Labs — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/chrisstanchak/ | Social: (check LinkedIn)

TASTYR CONNECTION: TicketLeap powered events including food festivals, culinary events, and restaurant pop-ups. Deep understanding of food/event ticketing ecosystem.

WHY CONTACT: Chris Stanchak is an ecosystem super-connector. TicketLeap powered events including food festivals, culinary events, and restaurant pop-ups. Deep understanding of food/event ticketing ecosystem. A sin...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro to Venmo/fintech network, Wharton founders, and early-stage Philly investors. His venture lab (StanForce Labs) actively helps startups with ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Chris, Your role at Loveseat / StanForce Labs caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get 20 m...

#6 David Cabello

89

Co-Founder & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Black and Mobile — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/david-cabello-bam/ | Social: (check LinkedIn)

TASTYR CONNECTION: DIRECT. Runs a food delivery platform partnering exclusively with Black-owned restaurants. Understands restaurant operations, delivery logistics, and ...

WHY CONTACT: David Cabello is an ecosystem super-connector. DIRECT. Runs a food delivery platform partnering exclusively with Black-owned restaurants. Understands restaurant operations, delivery logistics, and wha...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro Ali to the Black-owned restaurant community (hundreds of restaurants), food delivery ecosystem players, and Philly's food entrepreneur netwo...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey David, Your role at Black and Mobile caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get 20 minutes? I...

#7 Nick Bayer

89

Founder & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Saxbys — Philadelphia, PA (Center City HQ)

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/nickbayer6/ | Social: (check LinkedIn)

TASTYR CONNECTION: DIRECT. Runs a food/beverage company headquartered in Center City Philly. Deep understanding of food service operations, student dining, and community...

WHY CONTACT: Nick Bayer is an ecosystem super-connector. DIRECT. Runs a food/beverage company headquartered in Center City Philly. Deep understanding of food service operations, student dining, and community-based...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro to Philly's entire food/restaurant community, Chamber of Commerce leadership, university food partnerships (Drexel, Temple, etc.), and socia...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Nick, Your role at Saxbys caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get 20 minutes? I'd love you...

#8 Wayne Kimmel

87

Managing Partner & Founder

VC | 1st

SeventySix Capital — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/waynekimmel/

FOCUS: Sports betting, gaming, sports tech, health, and retail tech. Over two decades of sports/consumer tech investing.

CHECK SIZE: $250K-$2M seed

NOTABLE: 1) Multiple sports-tech companies 2) Retail technology startups 3) N3rd Street Gamers (esports)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Wayne invests in consumer tech across sports, health, and retail. Tastyr IQ's dish-rating platform could connect to his retail/consumer tech thesis. H...

WHY CONTACT: Wayne Kimmel at SeventySix Capital is a strategic VC target. Wayne invests in consumer tech across sports, health, and retail. Tastyr IQ's dish-rating platform could connect to his retail/consumer tec...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Philadelphia sports & business community; Wayne is very active on LinkedIn and accessible. Partner Ryan Howard's food/lifestyle brand connections.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Wayne, I've been following your work with 1) Multiple sports-tech companies 2) Retail technology startups 3) N3rd Street G. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#9 Marc Lore

87

Chairman & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Wonder Group — New Jersey (Hoboken area)

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/marclore/ | Social: (check LinkedIn)

TASTYR CONNECTION: DIRECT. Wonder is reimagining restaurant food delivery with 39+ storefronts. He's the biggest food-tech player in the tri-state area. Tastyr IQ's dish...

WHY CONTACT: Marc Lore is an ecosystem super-connector. DIRECT. Wonder is reimagining restaurant food delivery with 39+ storefronts. He's the biggest food-tech player in the tri-state area. Tastyr IQ's dish intell...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: EXTREMELY high value but harder to reach. Can connect to the highest levels of food-tech investing, celebrity chefs, and corporate food industry. His ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Marc, Your role at Wonder Group caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get 20 minutes? I'd lo...

#10 John Moore

86

Executive Chair, ImpactPHL; Board of Directors, Social Venture Circle;...

Angel | 1st

ImpactPHL / Investors Circle — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/john-moore-574514a/

FOCUS: Impact investing; social enterprises; backed 40+ social ventures and impact funds since 2005; Investors Circle member

CHECK SIZE: Varies (individual angel); ImpactPHL Ventures is a $15M collaborative

NOTABLE: 1) Wash Cycle Laundry (board member) 2) First Step Staffing 3) Milkcrate (board member) 4) Multiple impact funds

TASTYR CONNECTION: HIGHLY RELEVANT. John co-founded ImpactPHL, which has specific initiatives around food systems (resilient regional food systems, centralized meal prod...

WHY CONTACT: John Moore at ImpactPHL / Investors Circle represents a direct investment opportunity. HIGHLY RELEVANT. John co-founded ImpactPHL, which has specific initiatives around food systems (resilient regiona...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: ImpactPHL Total Impact Summit (annual event); Good Company Ventures network; Social Venture Circle events; Investors Circle Philadelphia meetings.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi John, I've been following your work with 1) Wash Cycle Laundry (board member) 2) First Step Staffing 3) Milkcrate (board . I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes...

#11 Anthony Edwards

86

Co-Founder, CEO & CTO

Accelerator | 2nd

EatOkra — Brooklyn, NY

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/eatokra (org page)

FOCUS: EatOkra is a Black-owned restaurant discovery platform with ~1M users and 23,000+ businesses indexed. Backed by Google f...

NOTABLE: N/A (this is a potential partner, not an accelerator)

TASTYR CONNECTION: PARTNERSHIP OPPORTUNITY -- EatOkra rates restaurants as a whole, Tastyr IQ rates individual dishes. These are complementary products, not competitors....

WHY CONTACT: Anthony Edwards at EatOkra can provide structured mentorship and investor access. PARTNERSHIP OPPORTUNITY -- EatOkra rates restaurants as a whole, Tastyr IQ rates individual dishes. These are compleme...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Anthony, I've been following your work with N/A (this is a potential partner, not an accelerator). I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dishes and patent pending. I...

#12 Kae Lani Palmisano

86

Media | 3rd

Philadelphia Magazine (Foobooz section) — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/kaelanipalmisano](https://www.linkedin.com/... | Email: kpalmisano@phillymag.com | Social: [@KaeLaniSays](https://x.com/kaelanisays)

FOCUS: Restaurant features, food trends, deep dives on Philly's culinary scene. Emmy-winning host of WHYY's "Check, Please! Phi...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Kae Lani covers food with a storytelling lens -- culture, people, trends. Tastyr IQ's dish-level intelligence could power a feature on "what Philly is...

WHY CONTACT: Kae Lani Palmisano can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Kae Lani covers food with a storytelling lens -- culture, people, trends. Tastyr IQ's dish-level in...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Kae, Your role at Philadelphia Magazine (Foobooz section) caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an ex...

#13 Kiki Aranita

86

Media | 3rd

The Philadelphia Inquirer — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/kiki-aranita-b49420a5](https://www.linkedin... | Email: (via Inquirer newsroom) | Social: [@poidogphilly](https://x.com/poidogphilly)

FOCUS: Chef profiles, restaurant trends, social media food culture. Former chef who ran Poi Dog (food truck/restaurant). Column...

TASTYR CONNECTION: As a former chef turned journalist, Kiki understands both sides of the restaurant equation. Tastyr IQ's ability to surface dish-level intelligence spe...

WHY CONTACT: Kiki Aranita can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. As a former chef turned journalist, Kiki understands both sides of the restaurant equation. Tastyr IQ's a...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Kiki, Your role at The Philadelphia Inquirer caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first...

#14 Rudy J. Ellis

86

CEO & Founder

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Switchboard Live — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/rudyjellis/ | Social: (check LinkedIn for current handle)

TASTYR CONNECTION: His livestreaming platform could be relevant for restaurant marketing/events. Sports connections overlap with stadium/venue food service.

WHY CONTACT: Rudy J. Ellis is an ecosystem super-connector. His livestreaming platform could be relevant for restaurant marketing/events. Sports connections overlap with stadium/venue food service. A single coffee...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro to Techstars network, Google for Startups community, NFL/sports industry contacts, and PSL mentor network. Deep connections in Black founder...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Rudy, Your role at Switchboard Live caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get 20 minutes? I'...

#15 Bob Moore

86

Co-Founder & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Crossbeam (now merged with Reveal) — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/robertjmoore/ | Social: @robertjmoore

TASTYR CONNECTION: Crossbeam's ecosystem-led growth platform serves companies across all industries including food/restaurant tech. His broad network includes food-tech ...

WHY CONTACT: Bob Moore is an ecosystem super-connector. Crossbeam's ecosystem-led growth platform serves companies across all industries including food/restaurant tech. His broad network includes food-tech adjacen...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: THE highest-value intro in Philly tech. Can connect to First Round Capital, top-tier VCs, enterprise SaaS founders, and the entire PSL alumni network....

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Bob, Your role at Crossbeam (now merged with Reveal) caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and g...

#16 Apu Gupta

86

CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Madaket Group (formerly CEO/Co-Founder of Curalate) — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/apugupta/ | Social: @apugupta

TASTYR CONNECTION: Curalate's visual commerce platform was used by CPG and food brands for Instagram/Pinterest commerce. Deep understanding of how consumers discover foo...

WHY CONTACT: Apu Gupta is an ecosystem super-connector. Curalate's visual commerce platform was used by CPG and food brands for Instagram/Pinterest commerce. Deep understanding of how consumers discover food produ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro to Wharton network (investors, founders), marketing tech investors, and Philly's established founder community. His experience scaling Cural...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Apu, Your role at Madaket Group (formerly CEO/Co-Founder of Curalate) caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy...

#17 Mikal Harden

86

Co-Founder

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Juno Search Partners / Juno Capital — Philadelphia, PA (serves NJ/tri-state)

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/mikalharden/ | Social: (check LinkedIn)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Juno Search Partners places talent in food/hospitality companies. Deep understanding of restaurant industry hiring challenges - directly relevant to T...

WHY CONTACT: Mikal Harden is an ecosystem super-connector. Juno Search Partners places talent in food/hospitality companies. Deep understanding of restaurant industry hiring challenges - directly relevant to Tasty...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro to startup hiring networks, early-stage VC community (Juno Capital), and PSL board members. Her talent firm works with startups across the t...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Mikal, Your role at Juno Search Partners / Juno Capital caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee an...

#18 Abhi Ramesh

86

Founder & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Misfits Market — New York, NY (founded in Philadelphia)

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/abhiramesh | Social: (check LinkedIn)

TASTYR CONNECTION: DIRECT. Runs one of the largest food-tech companies to come out of Philadelphia. Deep understanding of food supply chain, consumer food behavior, and ...

WHY CONTACT: Abhi Ramesh is an ecosystem super-connector. DIRECT. Runs one of the largest food-tech companies to come out of Philadelphia. Deep understanding of food supply chain, consumer food behavior, and food ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro to food-tech VCs, Wharton alumni investors, sustainable food industry contacts, and grocery/food distribution networks. His scale-up experie...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Abhi, Your role at Misfits Market caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get 20 minutes? I'd ...

#19 Abu Kamara

86

Co-Founder & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Grovara — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/abu-kamara-7384896/ | Social: (check LinkedIn)

TASTYR CONNECTION: DIRECT. Runs a B2B food-tech marketplace. Deep understanding of food industry dynamics, brand relationships, and how technology transforms food commer...

WHY CONTACT: Abu Kamara is an ecosystem super-connector. DIRECT. Runs a B2B food-tech marketplace. Deep understanding of food industry dynamics, brand relationships, and how technology transforms food commerce. Hi...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro to food/beverage brand executives, international food distribution networks, and Philadelphia's food-tech community. His SBA and Chamber con...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Abu, Your role at Grovara caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get 20 minutes? I'd love you...

#20 Dean Miller

86

President & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

PACT (Philadelphia Alliance for Capital and Technologies) — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/deanmiller | Social: (check LinkedIn)

TASTYR CONNECTION: PACT's portfolio and network includes food-tech companies. His VC experience spans healthcare to technology - restaurant tech fits within his investme...

WHY CONTACT: Dean Miller is an ecosystem super-connector. PACT's portfolio and network includes food-tech companies. His VC experience spans healthcare to technology - restaurant tech fits within his investment th...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: THE gateway to Philadelphia's investor community. Can intro to every major Philly VC, angel group, and corporate investor. PACT events bring together ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Dean, Your role at PACT (Philadelphia Alliance for Capital and Technologies) caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Coul...

#21 Scott Nissenbaum

86

President & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd Chain: Connector Express

Ben Franklin Technology Partners of Southeastern Pennsylvani... — Philadelphia, PA

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/snissenbaum/ | Social: (check LinkedIn)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Ben Franklin invests across all technology sectors including food/ag-tech. Their portfolio includes food-adjacent companies. PA's agricultural economy...

WHY CONTACT: Scott Nissenbaum is an ecosystem super-connector. Ben Franklin invests across all technology sectors including food/ag-tech. Their portfolio includes food-adjacent companies. PA's agricultural economy...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro to Ben Franklin's massive portfolio network (1,750+ companies), PA state government innovation officials, university tech transfer offices, ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Scott, Your role at Ben Franklin Technology Partners of Southeastern Pennsylvania caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem....

#22 Greg Fegley

85

Director, 1810 Accelerator & Innovation and Entrepreneurship Institute

Accelerator | 2nd

Temple University -- Fox School of Business — Philadelphia, PA (1810 Building, Liacour...

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/gfegley/

FOCUS: Startup Studio is the cohort-based accelerator (12-week curriculum, Fall/Spring/Summer cohorts). Open to students, alumn...

NOTABLE: 1) BYOBB finalists across consumer tech, healthtech, and social ventures 2) 15+ startups in the inaugural accelerator cohort

TASTYR CONNECTION: Temple is deeply embedded in North Philadelphia and has a diverse, scrappy entrepreneurial community. Greg is very accessible and hands-on. The 1810 A...

WHY CONTACT: Greg Fegley at Temple University -- Fox School of Business can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Temple is deeply embedded in North Philadelphia and has a diverse, scrappy entrepreneu...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Greg, I've been following your work with 1) BYOBB finalists across consumer tech, healthtech, and social ventures 2) 15+ . I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dish...

#23 Scott Nissenbaum

85

President and CEO

Accelerator | 2nd

Ben Franklin Technology Partners of Southeastern Pennsylvani... — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/ben-franklin-technology-par...

FOCUS: Fuels technology-based economic development by providing capital and business support to the region's startups. Approved...

NOTABLE: 1) Unique Snacks (artisan pretzels) 2) The Varona Co (Ocoa Beauty) 3) Hundreds of SE PA tech companies over decades

TASTYR CONNECTION: Ben Franklin is one of the most established funding sources in the Philadelphia region. They provide both capital and mentorship. Philly-based food/co...

WHY CONTACT: Scott Nissenbaum at Ben Franklin Technology Partners of Southeastern Pennsylvania can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Ben Franklin is one of the most established funding sources in ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Scott, I've been following your work with 1) Unique Snacks (artisan pretzels) 2) The Varona Co (Ocoa Beauty) 3) Hundreds o. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dis...

#24 Darren Sandberg

84

Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Dreamit Ventures — New York, NY / Philadelphia, PA (dual pr...

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/sandbergdarren

FOCUS: Pre-Series A in cybersecurity, healthtech, and physical security. Accelerator-style with operational support. 360+ portf...

CHECK SIZE: $50K-$500K (accelerator model, smaller initial checks)

NOTABLE: 1) LevelUp (acq. by GrubHub -- food delivery!) 2) SeatGeek 3) HouseParty (acq. by Epic Games)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Dreamit backed LevelUp which was acquired by GrubHub -- direct food-tech success story. Sandberg has 25+ years of venture experience and deep Philly e...

WHY CONTACT: Darren Sandberg at Dreamit Ventures is a strategic VC target. Dreamit backed LevelUp which was acquired by GrubHub -- direct food-tech success story. Sandberg has 25+ years of venture experience and d...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Philadelphia startup community; Dreamit Demo Days; Ben Franklin Technology Partners network (they've co-invested).

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Darren, I've been following your work with 1) LevelUp (acq. by GrubHub -- food delivery!) 2) SeatGeek 3) HouseParty (acq. b. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dish...

#25 Andrew Ive

84

Founder & Managing General Partner

VC | 1st

Big Idea Ventures (BIV) — New York, NY (also Paris and Singapore)

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/andrewive/

FOCUS: World's most active investor in food technology and the bioeconomy. Seed and pre-seed focus.

CHECK SIZE: $100K-$500K (accelerator/seed model) -- STRONG ALIGNMENT with Tastyr's range

NOTABLE: 1) Beyond Meat (early investor via Tyson Ventures) 2) Tovala (smart oven + meal delivery) 3) 150+ food-tech startups 4) Backed by AAK, Buhler, Puratos

TASTYR CONNECTION: THIS IS A MUST-CONTACT. Andrew is described as having "invested in more early-stage/pre-seed food companies than any other investor worldwide." Before...

WHY CONTACT: Andrew Ive at Big Idea Ventures (BIV) is a strategic VC target. THIS IS A MUST-CONTACT. Andrew is described as having "invested in more early-stage/pre-seed food companies than any other investor worl...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Food-tech conferences; BIV accelerator application process; NYC food innovation events. Andrew is very active on LinkedIn and at conferences.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Andrew, I've been following your work with 1) Beyond Meat (early investor via Tyson Ventures) 2) Tovala (smart oven + meal . I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dish...

#26 Allen Fogel

83

Partner, Robin Hood Ventures; General Partner, Mid-Atlantic Angel Fund

Angel | 1st

Robin Hood Ventures / Mid-Atlantic Angel Fund — Philadelphia, PA (NJIT advisory board su...

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/allen-fogel/

FOCUS: Early-stage startups; retail, wholesale, real estate, service sectors; high-growth scalable businesses

CHECK SIZE: $250K-$500K (Robin Hood group); Mid-Atlantic Angel Fund is a fund vehicle

NOTABLE: 1) Multiple Robin Hood portfolio companies since 2015 2) Mid-Atlantic Angel Fund portfolio companies

TASTYR CONNECTION: 40-year career in retail and wholesale sectors is highly relevant to Tastyr's restaurant/food industry focus. Understands consumer purchasing behavior...

WHY CONTACT: Allen Fogel at Robin Hood Ventures / Mid-Atlantic Angel Fund represents a direct investment opportunity. 40-year career in retail and wholesale sectors is highly relevant to Tastyr's restaurant/food i...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Robin Hood Ventures events; NJIT entrepreneurship events; Mid-Atlantic Angel Fund deal flow.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Allen, I've been following your work with 1) Multiple Robin Hood portfolio companies since 2015 2) Mid-Atlantic Angel Fund. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#27 Richard Binswanger

83

Entrepreneur, Investor & Board Member; ImpactPHL Board; Multiple advis...

Angel | 1st

TLG Group / ImpactPHL / GreenLight Fund / Jounce Partners — Philadelphia, PA (King of Prussia)

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/richard-binswanger-136666/

FOCUS: Impact investing; social outcomes; education innovation; diversity in tech; entrepreneurial ecosystem building

CHECK SIZE: Varies (angel); ImpactPHL Ventures $15M collaborative

NOTABLE: 1) ImpactPHL Ventures portfolio 2) GreenLight Fund (board) 3) Jounce Partners 4) NeuroTinker (board)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Richard's focus on "equity to end inequity" through impact investing aligns with Tastyr's potential to spotlight underrepresented cuisines and restaur...

WHY CONTACT: Richard Binswanger at TLG Group / ImpactPHL / GreenLight Fund / Jounce Partners represents a direct investment opportunity. Richard's focus on "equity to end inequity" through impact investing aligns ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: ImpactPHL Total Impact Summit; GreenLight Fund events; through John Moore (ImpactPHL Executive Chair); Philadelphia innovation community.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Richard, I've been following your work with 1) ImpactPHL Ventures portfolio 2) GreenLight Fund (board) 3) Jounce Partners 4). I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dis...

#28 Craig LaBan

83

Media | 3rd

The Philadelphia Inquirer — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

Email: claban@phillynews.com (via ZoomInfo/Muck Rack) | Social: [@CraigLaBan](https://x.com/CraigLaBan)

FOCUS: Restaurant reviews, annual Top 10 lists, dining trends, drink/cocktail culture. Has been the Inquirer's restaurant criti...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Craig covers the intersection of dining trends and innovation. Tastyr IQ's AI-powered dish intelligence could be framed as "the future of how diners d...

WHY CONTACT: Craig LaBan can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Craig covers the intersection of dining trends and innovation. Tastyr IQ's AI-powered dish intelligence co...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Craig, Your role at The Philadelphia Inquirer caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive firs...

#29 Maddy Sweitzer-Lamme

83

Media | 3rd

Eater Philly, PhillyMag, Food & Wine, Bon Appetit, The Infat... — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/maddy-sweitzer-lamme-067670107](https://www... | Email: (via personal site or Muck Rack) | Social: [@awomanwhoeats](https://x.com/awomanwhoeats)

FOCUS: Restaurants, food culture, travel, and beverage. Founder of Tiny Table Tours (boutique walking tour company in South Phi...

TASTYR CONNECTION: As a prolific freelancer writing across multiple outlets, Maddy can place a Tastyr IQ story in several publications. Angle: "How AI is changing the wa...

WHY CONTACT: Maddy Sweitzer-Lamme can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. As a prolific freelancer writing across multiple outlets, Maddy can place a Tastyr IQ story in se...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Maddy, Your role at Eater Philly, PhillyMag, Food & Wine, Bon Appetit, The Infatuation, OpenTable, The Philadelphia Citizen caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Phill...

#30 Sarah Huffman

83

Media | 3rd

Technical.ly — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/sarah-huffman-47987b1a2](https://www.linked... | Email: (via Technical.ly -- general: julie@technical.ly for editorial inquiries) | Social: (via Muck Rack profile)

FOCUS: Philadelphia tech ecosystem, startups, venture capital, entrepreneurship with a focus on access and equity. Joined Techn...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Sarah covers the Philly startup ecosystem with an equity and access lens. Tastyr IQ is a Philly-born startup that democratizes food intelligence -- ma...

WHY CONTACT: Sarah Huffman can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Sarah covers the Philly startup ecosystem with an equity and access lens. Tastyr IQ is a Philly-born sta...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Sarah, Your role at Technical.ly caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first-look before...

#31 Ryan Mulligan

83

Media | 3rd

Philadelphia Business Journal / PHL Inno — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/ryan-mulligan-b61184171](https://www.linked... | Email: rmulligan@bizjournals.com | Social: [@ryan2mulligan](https://x.com/ryan2mulligan)

FOCUS: Technology, innovation, startups, higher education, and real estate in the Philadelphia region. Writes for both the main...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Ryan covers startup innovation for the Philadelphia business community -- the exact audience of potential investors and partners for Tastyr IQ. Angle:...

WHY CONTACT: Ryan Mulligan can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Ryan covers startup innovation for the Philadelphia business community -- the exact audience of potentia...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Ryan, Your role at Philadelphia Business Journal / PHL Inno caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an ...

#32 Eli Kulp, Marisa Magnatta & Dave Wez

83

Media | 3rd

Delicious City Philly Podcast — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: N/A (Eli Kulp is a public figure; search by name) | Email: (via deliciouscitypodcast.com contact form) | Social: N/A (active on Instagram: @deliciouscitypodcast)

FOCUS: Philadelphia food and restaurant scene. Top-rated food podcast in the Philadelphia area. Eli Kulp is a partner of High S...

TASTYR CONNECTION: A podcast guest appearance would let Tastyr IQ's founders tell the story directly to Philly's most engaged food audience. Angle: "How AI is changing t...

WHY CONTACT: Eli Kulp, Marisa Magnatta & Dave Wez can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. A podcast guest appearance would let Tastyr IQ's founders tell the story directly...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Eli, Your role at Delicious City Philly Podcast caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive fi...

#33 Chris Wink

83

Cofounder & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Technical.ly — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/christopherwink/ | Social: @christopherwink

TASTYR CONNECTION: Technical.ly regularly covers food-tech startups. Has written about Gopuff, Black and Mobile, and other Philly food companies. Media coverage could am...

WHY CONTACT: Chris Wink is an ecosystem super-connector. Technical.ly regularly covers food-tech startups. Has written about Gopuff, Black and Mobile, and other Philly food companies. Media coverage could amplify ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Knows every founder, investor, and community builder in the mid-Atlantic region. Can provide media coverage for Tastyr IQ launch. Can intro Ali to the...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Chris, Your role at Technical.ly caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get 20 minutes? I'd l...

#34 Rick Nucci

83

Co-Founder & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Guru (AI knowledge management) — Wynnewood, PA (Philadelphia area)

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/ricknucci/ | Social: @ricknucci

TASTYR CONNECTION: Guru's knowledge management platform is used by restaurant chains and hospitality companies for training and operations. Direct connection to hospital...

WHY CONTACT: Rick Nucci is an ecosystem super-connector. Guru's knowledge management platform is used by restaurant chains and hospitality companies for training and operations. Direct connection to hospitality/re...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro to enterprise SaaS investors, PSL's mentor/investor network, and major tech companies (Dell, Shopify, Square). His "second-time founder" cre...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Rick, Your role at Guru (AI knowledge management) caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get ...

#35 Danny Meyer

82

Co-Founder & Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Enlightened Hospitality Investments (EHI) — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/dhmeyer/

FOCUS: Hospitality, restaurant technology, and consumer businesses aligned with "Enlightened Hospitality" philosophy.

CHECK SIZE: $10M-$30M (growth equity -- may be too large for seed, but strategic value is enormous)

NOTABLE: 1) Goldbelly (food delivery marketplace) 2) Salt & Straw (ice cream) 3) Joe Coffee 4) Dig (fast casual) 5) Banza (pasta) 6) BentoBox (restaurant tech)

TASTYR CONNECTION: DREAM INVESTOR/ADVISOR. Danny Meyer is the most influential figure in American hospitality. He founded Shake Shack, Union Square Cafe, Gramercy Tavern...

WHY CONTACT: Danny Meyer at Enlightened Hospitality Investments (EHI) is a strategic VC target. DREAM INVESTOR/ADVISOR. Danny Meyer is the most influential figure in American hospitality. He founded Shake Shack, U...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: NYC restaurant industry; USHG events; hospitality conferences; Shake Shack alumni network. Danny is the most accessible major food investor in NYC.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Danny, I've been following your work with 1) Goldbelly (food delivery marketplace) 2) Salt & Straw (ice cream) 3) Joe Coff. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#36 Luke Butler

82

Executive Director, Startup Engagement & Head of LIFT Labs Accelerator

Accelerator | 2nd

Comcast NBCUniversal LIFT Labs — Philadelphia, PA (Comcast Technology Cen...

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/luke-butler-2497459/

FOCUS: Enterprise AI, connectivity, media/entertainment technology. The accelerator connects startups with Comcast, NBCUniversa...

NOTABLE: 1) Reality Defender (deepfake detection) 2) Trullion (AI-powered accounting) 3) NLX (conversational AI, now working with Comcast HR)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Strong enterprise partnership pipeline -- 90% of participating startups secure pilots or deals with Comcast NBCUniversal. Potential distribution throu...

WHY CONTACT: Luke Butler at Comcast NBCUniversal LIFT Labs can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Strong enterprise partnership pipeline -- 90% of participating startups secure pilots or deals with...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Luke, I've been following your work with 1) Reality Defender (deepfake detection) 2) Trullion (AI-powered accounting) 3) . I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dish...

#37 Brigitte Daniel

82

Founder, Mogulette; Executive Vice President, Wilco Electronic Systems...

Accelerator | 2nd

Launch Lane Accelerator (University City Science Center) — Philadelphia, PA (University City)

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/brigittedaniel/ (search)

FOCUS: Tech-enabled startups, with emphasis on underrepresented founders. Backed by the Ewing Marion Kauffman Foundation. Inclu...

NOTABLE: 1) Various digital health startups from the Science Center's Digital Health Accelerator pipeline 2) First cohort included 8 digital health companies

TASTYR CONNECTION: Launch Lane specifically supports underrepresented tech founders. Consumer tech / app-based startups are welcome. The Science Center provides lab spac...

WHY CONTACT: Brigitte Daniel at Launch Lane Accelerator (University City Science Center) can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Launch Lane specifically supports underrepresented tech founders. Con...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Brigitte, I've been following your work with 1) Various digital health startups from the Science Center's Digital Health Acce. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ ...

#38 Lori Rosenkopf

82

Vice Dean of Entrepreneurship; Simon and Midge Palley Professor; Facul...

Accelerator | 2nd

Penn Venture Lab (Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania... — Philadelphia, PA (Tangen Hall)

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/lori-rosenkopf-5453a3b6/

FOCUS: Penn Venture Lab supports student and alumni entrepreneurs across all Penn schools with funding (Penn Wharton Innovation...

NOTABLE: 1) Warby Parker (Penn alumni) 2) Numerous Penn-connected startups across consumer, health, and fintech

TASTYR CONNECTION: If any Tastyr founders have Penn connections, this is a top-tier resource. Even without direct affiliation, Lori is a key figure in the Philly entrepr...

WHY CONTACT: Lori Rosenkopf at Penn Venture Lab (Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania) can provide structured mentorship and investor access. If any Tastyr founders have Penn connections, this is a top-tier ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Lori, I've been following your work with 1) Warby Parker (Penn alumni) 2) Numerous Penn-connected startups across consume. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dish...

#39 Chuck Sacco

82

Vice Dean, Charles D. Close School of Entrepreneurship; Director, Baia...

Accelerator | 2nd

Drexel University -- Close School of Entrepreneurship / Baia... — Philadelphia, PA (University City)

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/chucksacco/

FOCUS: The Baiada Institute is a university-wide startup incubator providing physical space, mentoring, and resources. The Clos...

NOTABLE: 1) Multiple consumer and enterprise tech startups from Baiada incubator 2) Close School graduates across software, mobile, and social ventures

TASTYR CONNECTION: Drexel's co-op model means access to talented interns and technical talent. The Baiada incubator provides free workspace and mentorship. Chuck's perso...

WHY CONTACT: Chuck Sacco at Drexel University -- Close School of Entrepreneurship / Baiada Institute can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Drexel's co-op model means access to talented interns and...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chuck, I've been following your work with 1) Multiple consumer and enterprise tech startups from Baiada incubator 2) Close. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dis...

#40 Dan Ostien

80

Chairman, i2n Angels

Angel | 1st

i2n Angels / Chester County Economic Development Council — Chester County, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/dan-ostien-0aa1a612/ | Email: (not publicly listed; org: ccedcpa.com)

FOCUS: Startup companies in tech and innovation sectors in southeastern PA; early-stage funding $50K-$500K

CHECK SIZE: $50K-$500K (group investments through SPVs)

NOTABLE: i2n Angels is newly launched (2025) and building its portfolio; Dan has 35+ years of tax, treasury, finance and risk management experience

TASTYR CONNECTION: Chester County has a booming food and restaurant scene (Kennett Square mushroom capital, West Chester dining corridor, numerous farm-to-table establis...

WHY CONTACT: Dan Ostien at i2n Angels / Chester County Economic Development Council represents a direct investment opportunity. Chester County has a booming food and restaurant scene (Kennett Square mushroom capit...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: i2n Angels application at https://i2nangels.ccedcpa.com/; Chester County Economic Development Council events; Ideas x Innovation Network meetups.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Dan, I've been following your work with i2n Angels is newly launched (2025) and building its portfolio; Dan has 35+ year. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes ...

#41 Danya Henninger

80

Media | 3rd

Technical.ly — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/danyahenninger](https://www.linkedin.com/in... | Email: danya@technical.ly (via ZoomInfo) | Social: (left Twitter/X in late 2023; active on LinkedIn)

FOCUS: Oversees multi-city newsroom covering entrepreneurship, AI, civic tech, and economic mobility. Former editor of Billy Pe...

TASTYR CONNECTION: As editorial director, Danya decides what stories Technical.ly covers across all markets. She has a nose for startups that combine tech with real comm...

WHY CONTACT: Danya Henninger can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. As editorial director, Danya decides what stories Technical.ly covers across all markets. She has a no...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Danya, Your role at Technical.ly caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first-look before...

#42 Alicia Vitarelli

80

Media | 3rd

6ABC / WPVI-TV (Philadelphia) — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: N/A | Email: (via 6abc.com newsroom) | Social: [@aliciavitarelli](https://x.com/aliciavitarelli)

FOCUS: FYI Philly is 6ABC's weekly lifestyle and entertainment show airing Saturdays at 5 PM -- covers restaurants, food, enter...

TASTYR CONNECTION: TV coverage provides massive reach and visual storytelling. Angle: "FYI Philly segment -- this local app uses AI to tell you the best dish at any rest...

WHY CONTACT: Alicia Vitarelli can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. TV coverage provides massive reach and visual storytelling. Angle: "FYI Philly segment -- this local ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Alicia, Your role at 6ABC / WPVI-TV (Philadelphia) caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive...

#43 Gloria Bell

80

Founder & Executive Director

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Inspiring Tech Foundation / Women In Tech Summit (WITS) — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/gloriabell/ | Social: (check LinkedIn)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Event management background means deep connections to venue and catering industry. WITS events bring together hundreds of professionals.

WHY CONTACT: Gloria Bell is an ecosystem super-connector. Event management background means deep connections to venue and catering industry. WITS events bring together hundreds of professionals. A single coffee me...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro to the women-in-tech community, corporate sponsors of WITS, and the PSL Legacy Leaders Council (earliest PSL supporters). Broad event indust...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Gloria, Your role at Inspiring Tech Foundation / Women In Tech Summit (WITS) caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Coul...

#44 Frank Shultz & Bo Motlagh

80

Co-Founders & Managing Partners

Founder-Connector | 2nd

United Effects Ventures (UE Ventures) — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express

Social: (check LinkedIn)

TASTYR CONNECTION: B2B SaaS focus could include restaurant tech tools. Their enterprise tech background means they understand building tools for businesses (like restaur...

WHY CONTACT: Frank Shultz & Bo Motlagh is an ecosystem super-connector. B2B SaaS focus could include restaurant tech tools. Their enterprise tech background means they understand building tools for businesses (lik...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro to UEV portfolio founders, B2B enterprise investors, and early-stage Philly startup community. Their studio model means they're always looki...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Frank, Your role at United Effects Ventures (UE Ventures) caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee ...

#45 Craig Shapiro

79

Founder & Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Collaborative Fund — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/craigjshapiro/

FOCUS: Seed & early-stage in consumer brands, climate solutions, food innovation, precision health. Invests at intersection of ...

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$5M seed/early

NOTABLE: 1) Beyond Meat 2) Sweetgreen 3) Impossible Foods 4) Blue Bottle Coffee 5) Reddit 6) Lyft

TASTYR CONNECTION: THIS IS A TOP-TIER TARGET. Craig's firm invested in Beyond Meat, Sweetgreen, Impossible Foods, Blue Bottle Coffee, Revolution Foods, and Hampton Creek...

WHY CONTACT: Craig Shapiro at Collaborative Fund is a strategic VC target. THIS IS A TOP-TIER TARGET. Craig's firm invested in Beyond Meat, Sweetgreen, Impossible Foods, Blue Bottle Coffee, Revolution Foods, and H...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Food/sustainability founder communities; impact investing networks; Collaborative Fund events. They are accessible and known for meeting consumer foun...

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Craig, I've been following your work with 1) Beyond Meat 2) Sweetgreen 3) Impossible Foods 4) Blue Bottle Coffee 5) Reddit. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#46 Sophie Bakalar

79

Partner

VC | 1st

Collaborative Fund — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/sophiebakalar/

FOCUS: Consumer health, food & beverage, marketplaces, climate/clean tech, AI, biotech. Leads later-stage investments.

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$5M

NOTABLE: 1) Daily Harvest (food delivery) 2) OLIPOP (functional soda) 3) Hoxton Farms (cell-cultured animal fats) 4) Impossible Foods

TASTYR CONNECTION: EXTREMELY RELEVANT. Sophie specifically focuses on consumer health and food & beverage investments. She joined Collaborative in 2016 initially to inve...

WHY CONTACT: Sophie Bakalar at Collaborative Fund is a strategic VC target. EXTREMELY RELEVANT. Sophie specifically focuses on consumer health and food & beverage investments. She joined Collaborative in 2016 init...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Consumer brand founder communities; food-tech events; sustainability/impact investing circles. Sophie has been accessible at conferences and events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Sophie, I've been following your work with 1) Daily Harvest (food delivery) 2) OLIPOP (functional soda) 3) Hoxton Farms (ce. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dish...

#47 Sanjeev Krishnan

79

Managing Partner & Chief Investment Officer

VC | 1st

S2G Ventures (now S2G Investments) — Chicago, IL / New York, NY (multi-office...

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/sanjeev-krishnan/ (inferred)

FOCUS: Food & agriculture across the full value chain: ag tech, digital/IoT, consumer brands, food as health, supply chain.

CHECK SIZE: $1M-$15M across stages

NOTABLE: 1) Beyond Meat 2) Sweetgreen 3) Maple Hill Creamery 4) MycoTechnology 5) 80 Acres Farms

TASTYR CONNECTION: S2G is one of the largest dedicated food & ag investment platforms in the US. Sanjeev's thesis includes "food as health" and consumer brands. Tastyr I...

WHY CONTACT: Sanjeev Krishnan at S2G Ventures (now S2G Investments) is a strategic VC target. S2G is one of the largest dedicated food & ag investment platforms in the US. Sanjeev's thesis includes "food as health...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Food-tech conferences (e.g., Future Food-Tech); ag-tech investor networks; through S2G portfolio company founders.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Sanjeev, I've been following your work with 1) Beyond Meat 2) Sweetgreen 3) Maple Hill Creamery 4) MycoTechnology 5) 80 Acre. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dis...

#48 Chuck Templeton

79

Managing Partner & Founder

VC | 1st

S2G Ventures (S2G Investments) — Chicago, IL

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/chuck-templeton/ (inferred)

FOCUS: Food & agriculture venture. Founded OpenTable before creating S2G.

CHECK SIZE: $1M-$15M

NOTABLE: 1) OpenTable (founder -- restaurant tech pioneer!) 2) Beyond Meat 3) Sweetgreen 4) ShopWell (nutritional food discovery app)

TASTYR CONNECTION: THIS IS A TOP-PRIORITY TARGET. Chuck Templeton literally founded OpenTable -- the platform that did for restaurant reservations what Tastyr IQ wants t...

WHY CONTACT: Chuck Templeton at S2G Ventures (S2G Investments) is a strategic VC target. THIS IS A TOP-PRIORITY TARGET. Chuck Templeton literally founded OpenTable -- the platform that did for restaurant reservati...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: OpenTable alumni network; food-tech conferences; restaurant industry events. Chuck is known for mentoring food-tech founders.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chuck, I've been following your work with 1) OpenTable (founder -- restaurant tech pioneer!) 2) Beyond Meat 3) Sweetgreen . I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#49 Walter Robb

79

Operating Partner (Food & Agriculture)

VC | 1st

S2G Investments — Austin, TX / New York (multi-location)

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/walter-robb-36465b1a7

FOCUS: Food system sustainability and health. Former co-CEO of Whole Foods Market (2010-2017).

CHECK SIZE: Advisory/Operating Partner role -- influences investment decisions but doesn't lead deals

NOTABLE: Through S2G, mentors food & ag portfolio companies. Previously helped build Whole Foods from regional to global.

TASTYR CONNECTION: MAJOR FOOD INDUSTRY CONNECTION. Walter Robb ran Whole Foods as co-CEO. He understands food quality, consumer preferences, and the importance of food r...

WHY CONTACT: Walter Robb at S2G Investments is a strategic VC target. MAJOR FOOD INDUSTRY CONNECTION. Walter Robb ran Whole Foods as co-CEO. He understands food quality, consumer preferences, and the importance of...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Through S2G team (Sanjeev, Chuck, Cristina); Whole Foods alumni network; food industry conferences.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Walter, I've been following your work with Through S2G, mentors food & ag portfolio companies. Previously helped build Whol. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dish...

#50 Brett Gibson

79

Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Initialized Capital — San Francisco, CA / New York, NY (dual o...

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/brettdgibson/

FOCUS: Seed-stage across AI, consumer, enterprise SaaS, sustainability, health, hard tech, infrastructure, crypto. Acts as "de ...

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$3M seed

NOTABLE: 1) Instacart (grocery/food delivery) 2) Reddit 3) Coinbase 4) Opendoor 5) Flexport 6) Patreon

TASTYR CONNECTION: Initialized invested early in Instacart -- the company that transformed food/grocery delivery. They also backed Goat Group (consumer marketplace). The...

WHY CONTACT: Brett Gibson at Initialized Capital is a strategic VC target. Initialized invested early in Instacart -- the company that transformed food/grocery delivery. They also backed Goat Group (consumer marke...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: YC alumni network (Initialized was founded by YC alums); NYC tech community; seed-stage founder events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Brett, I've been following your work with 1) Instacart (grocery/food delivery) 2) Reddit 3) Coinbase 4) Opendoor 5) Flexpo. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#51 David Barber

79

Founder & Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Almanac Insights — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/david-barber-almanac/ (inferred)

FOCUS: Early-stage investments in next-gen CPG, experiential retail, agriculture, and hospitality technology.

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$3M

NOTABLE: 1) Sweetgreen 2) Thrive Market 3) OLIPOP 4) Luke's Lobster 5) Foxtrot 6) Spindrift (acquired by Gryphon Investors, Jan 2025)

TASTYR CONNECTION: THIS IS A TOP-TIER TARGET. David co-owns Blue Hill restaurant and farm with his brother Dan Barber (chef). He co-founded Stone Barns Center for Food a...

WHY CONTACT: David Barber at Almanac Insights is a strategic VC target. THIS IS A TOP-TIER TARGET. David co-owns Blue Hill restaurant and farm with his brother Dan Barber (chef). He co-founded Stone Barns Center f...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Food industry events; Blue Hill restaurant/Stone Barns connections; sustainable food community. David is deeply embedded in the NYC food scene.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi David, I've been following your work with 1) Sweetgreen 2) Thrive Market 3) OLIPOP 4) Luke's Lobster 5) Foxtrot 6) Spindri. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#52 Brian Halweil

79

Portfolio Manager / Partner

VC | 1st

Almanac Insights — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/brian-halweil/ (inferred)

FOCUS: Agrifood tech, consumer brands, hospitality technology. Former editor of Edible magazine (Manhattan, Brooklyn, Long Isla...

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$3M

NOTABLE: Almanac's 29 company portfolio including Sweetgreen, Thrive Market, OLIPOP

TASTYR CONNECTION: Brian's background as editor of Edible magazine means he deeply understands food culture, local dining, and consumer food preferences. This editorial/...

WHY CONTACT: Brian Halweil at Almanac Insights is a strategic VC target. Brian's background as editor of Edible magazine means he deeply understands food culture, local dining, and consumer food preferences. This ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Food media community; Edible magazine network; local food/farm-to-table events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Brian, I've been following your work with Almanac's 29 company portfolio including Sweetgreen, Thrive Market, OLIPOP. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scor...

#53 Katie Teuber

79

Senior Director, Startup Engagement

Accelerator | 2nd

Comcast NBCUniversal LIFT Labs — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/katie-teuber/

FOCUS: Sourcing and engaging strategically relevant AI startups, shaping pilots and proofs of concept, guiding collaborations f...

NOTABLE: (Same portfolio as LIFT Labs above -- 43 companies invested since 2018, nearly $100M combined raised)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Katie is the day-to-day relationship builder at LIFT Labs. First point of contact for exploring startup engagement opportunities. Strong connector bet...

WHY CONTACT: Katie Teuber at Comcast NBCUniversal LIFT Labs can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Katie is the day-to-day relationship builder at LIFT Labs. First point of contact for exploring st...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Katie, I've been following your work with (Same portfolio as LIFT Labs above -- 43 companies invested since 2018, nearly $. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dis...

#54 Dan Freeman

79

Founding Director, Horn Entrepreneurship; Associate Professor of Marke...

Accelerator | 2nd

Horn Entrepreneurship, University of Delaware — Newark, DE

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/proffreeman/

FOCUS: Horn Entrepreneurship impacts 1,500+ students/year across all UD colleges. Programs include: Hen Hatch ($100K startup fu...

NOTABLE: 1) Relay Manufacturing (Rich Hayburn, UD '20) 2) Equivly (student venture) 3) Brame (fashion label, Annabelle, UD '24)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Dan's marketing expertise and focus on "raising customers" is directly aligned with Tastyr IQ's consumer growth challenge. Hen Hatch provides $100K in...

WHY CONTACT: Dan Freeman at Horn Entrepreneurship, University of Delaware can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Dan's marketing expertise and focus on "raising customers" is directly aligned with ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Dan, I've been following your work with 1) Relay Manufacturing (Rich Hayburn, UD '20) 2) Equivly (student venture) 3) Br. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dishe...

#55 Andrew D. Ive

79

Founder & General Managing Partner

Accelerator | 2nd

Big Idea Ventures (BIV) — New York, NY (with teams in Paris and As...

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/andrewive/ (search)

FOCUS: World's most active investor in food technology and bioeconomy. Global Food Innovation Fund II (GFIF II) backed by AAK, ...

NOTABLE: 1) 160+ portfolio companies across food tech globally 2) Pet food innovation startups (Mars Petcare partnership) 3) Multiple alt-protein and food-tech...

TASTYR CONNECTION: This is the single most relevant food-tech accelerator for Tastyr IQ. BIV invests specifically in food innovation. The accelerator provides deep, hand...

WHY CONTACT: Andrew D. Ive at Big Idea Ventures (BIV) can provide structured mentorship and investor access. This is the single most relevant food-tech accelerator for Tastyr IQ. BIV invests specifically in food i...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Andrew, I've been following your work with 1) 160+ portfolio companies across food tech globally 2) Pet food innovation sta. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ di...

#56 Darren Sandberg

79

Managing Partner

Accelerator | 2nd

Dreamit Ventures — Philadelphia, PA / New York, NY

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/dreamit-ventures (org page)

FOCUS: Venture fund and accelerator focused on Healthtech and Securetech. 25+ years of venture, PE, and growth strategy experie...

NOTABLE: 1) Multiple healthtech and securetech startups 2) Dreamit has been a fixture in the Philly startup ecosystem since its founding

TASTYR CONNECTION: While Dreamit's current verticals (Healthtech, Securetech) don't directly align, Darren is deeply connected in the Philly VC and startup ecosystem. Wo...

WHY CONTACT: Darren Sandberg at Dreamit Ventures can provide structured mentorship and investor access. While Dreamit's current verticals (Healthtech, Securetech) don't directly align, Darren is deeply connected i...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Darren, I've been following your work with 1) Multiple healthtech and securetech startups 2) Dreamit has been a fixture in . I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ di...

#57 Marc Vetri

79

Restaurateur | 2nd

Vetri Cucina (flagship, 1998), Fiorella, Fiore Rosso, MVP, P... — Philadelphia, PA (+ Las Vegas locations)

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/marc-vetri-860a2b35/ | Social: @marcvetri (103K followers)

NOTABLE: James Beard Award "Best Chef Mid-Atlantic" (2005); Food & Wine "Best New Chefs"; Michelin Guide Recommended (2025); 5 award-winning cookbooks; new coo...

TASTYR CONNECTION: As Philly's Italian cuisine godfather, Vetri's endorsement of dish-level intelligence would carry enormous weight. His multi-concept empire spans casu...

WHY CONTACT: Marc Vetri is a key social chain catalyst. As Philly's Italian cuisine godfather, Vetri's endorsement of dish-level intelligence would carry enormous weight. His multi-concept empire spans casual to f...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Marc, I've been following your work with James Beard Award "Best Chef Mid-Atlantic" (2005); Food & Wine "Best New Chefs";. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lo...

#58 Michael Solomonov

79

Restaurateur | 2nd

CookNSolo Restaurants -- Zahav (flagship), Dizengoff, Goldie... — Philadelphia, PA (+ Miami, FL)

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/mikesolomonov | Social: @mikesolomonov (118K followers)

NOTABLE: 5x James Beard Award Winner; Zahav won "Outstanding Restaurant" (2019, first Israeli & first Philly restaurant); Chef's Table (Netflix); Zahav hummus ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Solomonov has revolutionized how Americans think about Israeli cuisine at the dish level. His menu innovation (hummus, salatim, kebabs) is inherently ...

WHY CONTACT: Michael Solomonov is a key social chain catalyst. Solomonov has revolutionized how Americans think about Israeli cuisine at the dish level. His menu innovation (hummus, salatim, kebabs) is inherently ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Michael, I've been following your work with 5x James Beard Award Winner; Zahav won "Outstanding Restaurant" (2019, first Isr. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd...

#59 Jose Garces

79

Restaurateur | 2nd

Garces Group -- Amada, Village Whiskey, Buena Onda, JG Domes... — Philadelphia, PA (+ Atlantic City, NJ; N...

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/garces-restaurant-group | Social: @chefjosegarces

NOTABLE: Iron Chef (winner of "The Next Iron Chef"); James Beard "Best Chef Mid-Atlantic" (2009); Food Network personality; cookbook author; built and restruct...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Garces has built multiple successful concepts around specific dish categories (tapas, tacos, whiskey/burgers). His Iron Chef background means he think...

WHY CONTACT: Jose Garces is a key social chain catalyst. Garces has built multiple successful concepts around specific dish categories (tapas, tacos, whiskey/burgers). His Iron Chef background means he thinks abou...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jose, I've been following your work with Iron Chef (winner of "The Next Iron Chef"); James Beard "Best Chef Mid-Atlantic". I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lo...

#60 Cristina Martinez

79

Restaurateur | 2nd

South Philly Barbacoa, Casa Mexico, People's Kitchen at El C... — Philadelphia, PA (South Philadelphia)

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/chefcristinamartinez/ | Social: @barbacoachef (56K followers)

NOTABLE: James Beard "Best Chef: Mid-Atlantic" (2022); Netflix Chef's Table feature; Bon Appetit Top 10 Best New Restaurants (2016); People's Kitchen served 10...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Martinez represents the heart-and-soul side of food that Tastyr should champion. Her barbacoa is legendary at the dish level -- people come for THAT d...

WHY CONTACT: Cristina Martinez is a key social chain catalyst. Martinez represents the heart-and-soul side of food that Tastyr should champion. Her barbacoa is legendary at the dish level -- people come for THAT d...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Cristina, I've been following your work with James Beard "Best Chef: Mid-Atlantic" (2022); Netflix Chef's Table feature; Bon . I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'...

#61 Nick Elmi

79

Restaurateur | 2nd

Laurel (relocating to Center City), Lark, The Landing Kitche... — Philadelphia, PA (+ Bala Cynwyd, PA)

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/nicholas-elmi-272a0bb7/ | Social: @nicholaselmi (16K followers)

NOTABLE: Top Chef Season 11 Winner; James Beard "Best New Restaurant" nominee (Laurel); 4-bell review from Craig LaBan; Philadelphia Magazine "Best Restaurant ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Elmi's cooking is intensely focused on individual dish perfection -- his tasting menus at Laurel are about experiencing each plate as a standalone mas...

WHY CONTACT: Nick Elmi is a key social chain catalyst. Elmi's cooking is intensely focused on individual dish perfection -- his tasting menus at Laurel are about experiencing each plate as a standalone masterpiece...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Nick, I've been following your work with Top Chef Season 11 Winner; James Beard "Best New Restaurant" nominee (Laurel); 4. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lo...

#62 Jesse Ito

79

Restaurateur | 2nd

Royal Sushi & Izakaya, Royal Sushi Omakase, Dancerobot (new,... — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/jesse-ito-38492151/ | Social: @jesseito (58K followers)

NOTABLE: 6x James Beard Award nominee; North America's 50 Best Restaurants (Royal Sushi); only 3-star NYT review for a Philadelphia sushi restaurant; Eater You...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Omakase is literally dish-by-dish dining -- each piece of sushi is its own experience. Ito's 600-person waitlist proves people are obsessed with indiv...

WHY CONTACT: Jesse Ito is a key social chain catalyst. Omakase is literally dish-by-dish dining -- each piece of sushi is its own experience. Ito's 600-person waitlist proves people are obsessed with individual di...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jesse, I've been following your work with 6x James Beard Award nominee; North America's 50 Best Restaurants (Royal Sushi);. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd l...

#63 Amanda Shulman

79

Restaurateur | 2nd

Her Place Supper Club (Rittenhouse), My Loup (with husband A... — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/amanda-shulman-60098154/ | Social: @stayhungree (24K followers); @herplacesupperclub;...

NOTABLE: Michelin Star (Her Place Supper Club, Philadelphia's inaugural Michelin Guide); 2025 James Beard finalist for Best Chef Mid-Atlantic; Food & Wine Best...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Shulman's supper club format is inherently dish-centric -- her multicourse set menu changes every two weeks, making each dish a conversation piece. He...

WHY CONTACT: Amanda Shulman is a key social chain catalyst. Shulman's supper club format is inherently dish-centric -- her multicourse set menu changes every two weeks, making each dish a conversation piece. Her M...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Amanda, I've been following your work with Michelin Star (Her Place Supper Club, Philadelphia's inaugural Michelin Guide); . I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd ...

#64 Robert Adelson

78

Managing Partner & Co-Founder

VC | 1st

Osage Venture Partners — Bala Cynwyd, PA (just outside Philadelph...

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/robert-adelson/ (inferred)

FOCUS: Early-stage B2B software; Future of Work, Future of Education. Has been investing since 1990.

CHECK SIZE: $1M-$5M

NOTABLE: 1) Noodle (education tech) 2) Malbek (contract management) 3) Quartile (e-commerce optimization)

TASTYR CONNECTION: While OVP is B2B-focused, Adelson is a pillar of the Philly VC community with decades of connections. His firm co-invests with consumer-focused angels...

WHY CONTACT: Robert Adelson at Osage Venture Partners is a strategic VC target. While OVP is B2B-focused, Adelson is a pillar of the Philly VC community with decades of connections. His firm co-invests with consum...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Bala Cynwyd/Main Line business community; Philly VC network events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Robert, I've been following your work with 1) Noodle (education tech) 2) Malbek (contract management) 3) Quartile (e-commer. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dish...

#65 Nate Lentz

78

Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Osage Venture Partners — Bala Cynwyd, PA

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/nvlentz/

FOCUS: B2B SaaS, Future of Work, Future of Education. 15+ years at OVP. Stanford GSB grad.

CHECK SIZE: $1M-$5M

NOTABLE: 1) Noodle (board member) 2) Dig (board member -- NOTE: Dig is a fast-casual restaurant chain!) 3) DrayNow 4) Malbek

TASTYR CONNECTION: Nate sits on the board of Dig, a fast-casual restaurant technology company. This is a direct food industry connection. He would understand the restaur...

WHY CONTACT: Nate Lentz at Osage Venture Partners is a strategic VC target. Nate sits on the board of Dig, a fast-casual restaurant technology company. This is a direct food industry connection. He would understan...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Dig restaurant connection; Stanford GSB alumni network; Philly VC community.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Nate, I've been following your work with 1) Noodle (board member) 2) Dig (board member -- NOTE: Dig is a fast-casual rest. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes...

#66 Chad Stender

78

Managing Partner

VC | 1st

SeventySix Capital — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/chad-stender/

FOCUS: Sports tech, consumer tech, health, retail. Leads finance, operations, and investor relations for the fund.

CHECK SIZE: $250K-$2M seed

NOTABLE: SeventySix Capital portfolio spanning sports, health, and retail tech

TASTYR CONNECTION: Chad handles deal sourcing and fund operations. More likely to be the operational contact for evaluating new investments. Consumer/retail tech angle a...

WHY CONTACT: Chad Stender at SeventySix Capital is a strategic VC target. Chad handles deal sourcing and fund operations. More likely to be the operational contact for evaluating new investments. Consumer/retail t...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Through Wayne Kimmel; Philadelphia VC community events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chad, I've been following your work with SeventySix Capital portfolio spanning sports, health, and retail tech. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, pa...

#67 Michael DiPiano

78

Managing General Partner & Co-Founder

VC | 1st

NewSpring Capital — Radnor, PA (Philadelphia suburb)

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/newspring-capital (firm pag...

FOCUS: Growth equity in technology, healthcare, business services, consumer, industrials. Consumer services is explicitly liste...

CHECK SIZE: $5M-$25M (growth stage -- may be too large for Tastyr's seed, but strategic connector)

NOTABLE: 250+ companies across tech, healthcare, consumer, and business services

TASTYR CONNECTION: NewSpring explicitly invests in "consumer services" and "technology" sectors. While their check sizes are larger (growth equity), DiPiano's 25+ year t...

WHY CONTACT: Michael DiPiano at NewSpring Capital is a strategic VC target. NewSpring explicitly invests in "consumer services" and "technology" sectors. While their check sizes are larger (growth equity), DiPiano...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: ACG Philadelphia events; Main Line business community; Philly VC network.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Michael, I've been following your work with 250+ companies across tech, healthcare, consumer, and business services. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes score...

#68 Peter Genovese

78

Media | 3rd

NJ.com / NJ Advance Media — Newark, NJ

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/genovese-peter-6b044212](https://www.linked... | Email: pgenovese@njadvancemedia.com | Social: [@petegenovese](https://x.com/petegenovese)

FOCUS: New Jersey restaurants, diners, food culture, road food. Author of 13 books on NJ diners, Jersey Shore, and food. Named ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Peter covers the "everyman diner" perspective -- what regular people are eating across NJ. Tastyr IQ's dish intelligence is the tech version of what h...

WHY CONTACT: Peter Genovese can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Peter covers the "everyman diner" perspective -- what regular people are eating across NJ. Tastyr IQ's ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Peter, Your role at NJ.com / NJ Advance Media caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive firs...

#69 Deborah Smith

78

Media | 3rd

Jersey Bites (JerseyBites.com) — New Jersey (Monmouth County area)

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/deborahleesmith](https://www.linkedin.com/p... | Email: DSmith@JerseyBites.com | Social: [@jerseybites](https://x.com/jerseybites)

FOCUS: NJ restaurant news, food events, chef spotlights, food trends. Founded Jersey Bites in 2007; now has 30+ food writers an...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Deborah is both a food media operator and a digital marketing professional -- she understands the business value of food data. Angle: "How AI dish int...

WHY CONTACT: Deborah Smith can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Deborah is both a food media operator and a digital marketing professional -- she understands the busine...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Deborah, Your role at Jersey Bites (JerseyBites.com) caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusi...

#70 Aaron Price

78

CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

TechUnited:NJ (formerly NJ Tech Council) — Hoboken, NJ

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/arprice/ | Social: (check LinkedIn profile)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Propelify Innovation Festival includes food-tech exhibitors and startups. NJ has a thriving food innovation corridor (Rutgers Food Innovation Center, ...

WHY CONTACT: Aaron Price is an ecosystem super-connector. Propelify Innovation Festival includes food-tech exhibitors and startups. NJ has a thriving food innovation corridor (Rutgers Food Innovation Center, Wonde...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro Ali to the entire NJ tech ecosystem - founders, investors, corporate partners, government officials. Propelify's 10,000+ attendees include f...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Aaron, Your role at TechUnited:NJ (formerly NJ Tech Council) caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coff...

#71 James Barrood

78

Founder & CEO

Founder-Connector | 2nd

Innovation+ / Innovate 100 / Jersey Tech & Innovation — New Jersey

Chain: Connector Express

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/jamesbarrood/ | Social: (check LinkedIn)

TASTYR CONNECTION: NJ has a massive food industry (Garden State). His network includes food/ag-tech companies that participate in NJ's innovation ecosystem. Rutgers Food...

WHY CONTACT: James Barrood is an ecosystem super-connector. NJ has a massive food industry (Garden State). His network includes food/ag-tech companies that participate in NJ's innovation ecosystem. Rutgers Food I...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

WARM INTRO: Can intro to NJ's top 100 innovation leaders (Innovate 100 list), university entrepreneurship programs, NJ corporate innovation teams, and his global ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey James, Your role at Innovation+ / Innovate 100 / Jersey Tech & Innovation caught my attention. I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I...

#72 RoseAnn Rosenthal

77

Chair Emeritus, Broad Street Angels; Managing Director, Delaware's Fir...

Angel | 1st

Broad Street Angels / Strategic Solutions Ventures / ImpactP... — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

FOCUS: Early-stage enterprises in Greater Philadelphia; impact investing; regional economic development; public/private partner...

CHECK SIZE: Varies; BSA group investments $25K-$1M; Delaware First Fund institutional

NOTABLE: 1) Over 200 early-stage investments during her tenure at Ben Franklin 2) Multiple Broad Street Angels portfolio companies 3) ImpactPHL Ventures portfo...

TASTYR CONNECTION: 50+ years in business investment and regional economic development. As a Philly institution, RoseAnn understands the city's food culture and economic ...

WHY CONTACT: RoseAnn Rosenthal at Broad Street Angels / Strategic Solutions Ventures / ImpactPHL (board) represents a direct investment opportunity. 50+ years in business investment and regional economic developme...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Ben Franklin Technology Partners alumni network; PACT events; ImpactPHL Total Impact Summit; Broad Street Angels.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi RoseAnn, I've been following your work with 1) Over 200 early-stage investments during her tenure at Ben Franklin 2) Multipl. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dis...

#73 Chuck Carter

77

President, Philadelphia & Pittsburgh Chapters

Angel | 1st

Keiretsu Forum Mid-Atlantic — Philadelphia area, PA (856 area code sug...

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/chuck-carter-48baa47 | Email: (not publicly listed; phone: 856-986-0106)

FOCUS: Early-stage companies across tech, consumer, healthcare, life sciences; Keiretsu Forum due diligence process

CHECK SIZE: $250K-$2M (Keiretsu group rounds)

NOTABLE: Multiple Keiretsu Forum portfolio companies since 2012

TASTYR CONNECTION: As chapter president, Chuck screens all companies that want to present to Keiretsu Forum Philadelphia. His legal background (law degree) combined with...

WHY CONTACT: Chuck Carter at Keiretsu Forum Mid-Atlantic represents a direct investment opportunity. As chapter president, Chuck screens all companies that want to present to Keiretsu Forum Philadelphia. His legal...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Direct application to Keiretsu Forum Philadelphia for a pitch slot; contact through Howard Lubert; PACT events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chuck, I've been following your work with Multiple Keiretsu Forum portfolio companies since 2012. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, ...

#74 Scott Nissenbaum

77

President & CEO

Angel | 1st

Ben Franklin Technology Partners of Southeastern Pennsylvani... — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/snissenbaum/ | Email: (not publicly listed; org: sep.benfranklin.org)

FOCUS: Early-stage technology and healthcare companies in SE Pennsylvania; completed 200+ early-stage investments; launched GO ...

CHECK SIZE: $100K-$5M (Ben Franklin institutional investments); GO Philly/GO PA Fund vehicles

NOTABLE: 1) GO Philly Fund (launched, raised capital) 2) GO PA Fund ($28M collaborative fund) 3) 200+ early-stage investments across his career at Ben Franklin

TASTYR CONNECTION: Ben Franklin is the premier institutional early-stage investor in SE Pennsylvania. Scott's mandate is specifically to grow the regional innovation eco...

WHY CONTACT: Scott Nissenbaum at Ben Franklin Technology Partners of Southeastern Pennsylvania represents a direct investment opportunity. Ben Franklin is the premier institutional early-stage investor in SE Penns...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Ben Franklin Technology Partners application process; PACT events; any Robin Hood or Broad Street Angels member can likely make an intro; Philadelphia...

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Scott, I've been following your work with 1) GO Philly Fund (launched, raised capital) 2) GO PA Fund ($28M collaborative f. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#75 Peter Leone

77

Member & Past Chair (Robin Hood Ventures); Former EVP & President, Leo...

Angel | 1st

Robin Hood Ventures — Bridgeton, NJ / Philadelphia, PA area

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

FOCUS: Early-stage startups in Greater Philadelphia; consumer products background (glass bottles/jars manufacturing)

CHECK SIZE: $250K-$500K (Robin Hood group)

NOTABLE: Robin Hood Ventures portfolio companies; Leone Industries (33-year career as EVP/President)

TASTYR CONNECTION: HIGHLY RELEVANT. Peter ran a glass bottle and jar manufacturing company (Leone Industries) with 350 employees for 33 years -- this is a food/beverage ...

WHY CONTACT: Peter Leone at Robin Hood Ventures represents a direct investment opportunity. HIGHLY RELEVANT. Peter ran a glass bottle and jar manufacturing company (Leone Industries) with 350 employees for 33 year...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Robin Hood Ventures events; Opera Philadelphia events; Wheaton Arts connections.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Peter, I've been following your work with Robin Hood Ventures portfolio companies; Leone Industries (33-year career as EVP. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#76 Anne-Marie Maman

77

Executive Director, Princeton Entrepreneurship Council

Accelerator | 2nd

Princeton Entrepreneurship Council (PEC), Princeton Universi... — Princeton, NJ

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/annemariemaman/

FOCUS: Supports the Princeton entrepreneurial ecosystem through programming, mentoring, and funding. PEC is integrated into the...

NOTABLE: 1) Numerous Princeton-connected startups across tech and biotech 2) eLab summer program participants 3) TigerLaunch competition winners

TASTYR CONNECTION: Princeton's brand and network are extremely valuable. Anne-Marie has deep experience in life sciences incubation (former NJ EDA Life Sciences Incubato...

WHY CONTACT: Anne-Marie Maman at Princeton Entrepreneurship Council (PEC), Princeton University can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Princeton's brand and network are extremely valuable. Anne-Mar...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Anne-Marie, I've been following your work with 1) Numerous Princeton-connected startups across tech and biotech 2) eLab summer . I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490...

#77 Robert Grey

77

Director, Food & Beverage

Accelerator | 2nd

Plug and Play Tech Center — Sunnyvale, CA (Silicon Valley) -- progra...

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/plug-and-play-tech-center (...

FOCUS: Stage-agnostic, 12-week food-focused innovation platform. Connects AgTech and food tech startups with corporate partners...

NOTABLE: 1) 2,200+ startups across all verticals 2) Numerous food & beverage companies connected to Nestle, Corteva, and other CPG giants

TASTYR CONNECTION: Plug and Play's corporate partnership model could connect Tastyr IQ with major food/restaurant companies. No equity taken is a major plus. Silicon Val...

WHY CONTACT: Robert Grey at Plug and Play Tech Center can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Plug and Play's corporate partnership model could connect Tastyr IQ with major food/restaurant companies...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Robert, I've been following your work with 1) 2,200+ startups across all verticals 2) Numerous food & beverage companies co. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ di...

#78 Michael Klein

77

Media | 3rd

The Philadelphia Inquirer — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/michael-klein-9836745](https://www.linkedin... | Email: (via Inquirer newsroom / Muck Rack) | Social: [@phillyinsider](https://x.com/phillyinsider) (als...

FOCUS: Restaurant openings, closings, industry news, behind-the-scenes business of food. Has written the "Table Talk" column si...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Michael covers the business side of food -- openings, closings, industry shifts. Tastyr IQ is a restaurant industry story: "Philly startup uses AI to ...

WHY CONTACT: Michael Klein can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Michael covers the business side of food -- openings, closings, industry shifts. Tastyr IQ is a restaura...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Michael, Your role at The Philadelphia Inquirer caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive fi...

#79 Hayley Barna

76

Partner

VC | 1st

First Round Capital — New York, NY (leads NYC office)

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/hbarna/

FOCUS: Consumer marketplaces, B2B SaaS, subscription commerce. Co-founded Birchbox (consumer subscription).

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$3M seed

NOTABLE: 1) Birchbox (co-founder before joining First Round) 2) Consumer marketplace investments across First Round portfolio

TASTYR CONNECTION: Hayley's background in consumer subscription/discovery models (Birchbox) maps directly to Tastyr IQ's dish discovery and rating concept. She understan...

WHY CONTACT: Hayley Barna at First Round Capital is a strategic VC target. Hayley's background in consumer subscription/discovery models (Birchbox) maps directly to Tastyr IQ's dish discovery and rating concept. S...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: First Round's Philly connections; consumer-tech founder communities in NYC/Philly.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Hayley, I've been following your work with 1) Birchbox (co-founder before joining First Round) 2) Consumer marketplace inve. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dish...

#80 Ben Lerer

76

Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Lerer Hippeau — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/benlerer

FOCUS: Seed & Series A across consumer and enterprise. Special interest in food & beverage, hardware, fintech, healthcare, SaaS...

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$3M seed; up to $5M Series A

NOTABLE: 1) Hungryroot (personalized food/grocery) 2) Allbirds 3) Warby Parker 4) Thrive 5) ZenBusiness 6) MIRROR

TASTYR CONNECTION: Lerer Hippeau has explicit food & beverage as a focus area. They invested in Hungryroot (AI-powered personalized food), Food52, and Plated. Ben wrote ...

WHY CONTACT: Ben Lerer at Lerer Hippeau is a strategic VC target. Lerer Hippeau has explicit food & beverage as a focus area. They invested in Hungryroot (AI-powered personalized food), Food52, and Plated. Ben wro...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: NYC tech/food community; Lerer Hippeau is known for being founder-friendly and accessible. They host events and office hours.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Ben, I've been following your work with 1) Hungryroot (personalized food/grocery) 2) Allbirds 3) Warby Parker 4) Thrive . I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes ...

#81 Sam Jones

76

Partner

VC | 1st

Torch Capital — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/sam-jones-torch/ (inferred)

FOCUS: Consumer technology and fintech. Named Top 5 Investment Professionals in Both Consumer and Fintech (UK origin).

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$5M

NOTABLE: Active across Torch Capital's consumer tech portfolio including food/consumer brands

TASTYR CONNECTION: Sam focuses on consumer tech at a firm that has invested in Sweetgreen and Nara Organics. Consumer + fintech crossover could be interesting for Tastyr...

WHY CONTACT: Sam Jones at Torch Capital is a strategic VC target. Sam focuses on consumer tech at a firm that has invested in Sweetgreen and Nara Organics. Consumer + fintech crossover could be interesting for Tas...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Through Jon Keidan; UK-US tech community; consumer VC events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Sam, I've been following your work with Active across Torch Capital's consumer tech portfolio including food/consumer br. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes ...

#82 Natalie Massenet

76

Co-Founder & Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Imaginary Ventures — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/natalie-massenet-77a732157/

FOCUS: Generationally-defining consumer businesses at the intersection of retail and technology. Beauty, wellness, food & bever...

CHECK SIZE: $1M-$5M early-stage

NOTABLE: 1) Sweetgreen (backed $200M Series H pre-IPO!) 2) Glossier 3) Skims 4) Daily Harvest 5) Alec's Ice Cream 6) Lucky Energy

TASTYR CONNECTION: Imaginary invested in Sweetgreen's $200M Series H and has invested in Daily Harvest, Alec's Ice Cream, and Lucky Energy -- all food/beverage companies...

WHY CONTACT: Natalie Massenet at Imaginary Ventures is a strategic VC target. Imaginary invested in Sweetgreen's $200M Series H and has invested in Daily Harvest, Alec's Ice Cream, and Lucky Energy -- all food/bev...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Consumer brand founder communities; fashion/food crossover events. Natalie founded Net-a-Porter.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Natalie, I've been following your work with 1) Sweetgreen (backed $200M Series H pre-IPO!) 2) Glossier 3) Skims 4) Daily Har. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dis...

#83 Mark Leavitt

76

Co-Founder & Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Enlightened Hospitality Investments (EHI) — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/mark-leavitt/ (inferred)

FOCUS: Hospitality and related technology businesses. TMT investment banking background (Piper Jaffray). UChicago Booth MBA.

CHECK SIZE: $10M-$30M growth equity

NOTABLE: Board member at: Joe Coffee, Salt & Straw, Goldbelly, Dig, Banza, Oats Overnight, Restaurant Technologies. Board observer at Culture Pop, Qu.

TASTYR CONNECTION: Mark sits on boards of 7+ food/hospitality companies and is the operational lead at EHI. He evaluates every food-tech investment that comes through EH...

WHY CONTACT: Mark Leavitt at Enlightened Hospitality Investments (EHI) is a strategic VC target. Mark sits on boards of 7+ food/hospitality companies and is the operational lead at EHI. He evaluates every food-tec...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: UChicago Booth alumni network; restaurant tech conferences; through USHG/Danny Meyer connections.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Mark, I've been following your work with Board member at: Joe Coffee, Salt & Straw, Goldbelly, Dig, Banza, Oats Overnight. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes...

#84 Brett Thomas

76

Co-Founder & Managing Partner

VC | 1st

CAVU Consumer Partners — New York, NY / Los Angeles, CA

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/brett-thomas-17150935/

FOCUS: Better-for-you branded consumer products in Food & Beverage, Pet, Personal Care & Beauty, consumer lifestyle.

CHECK SIZE: $2M-$15M (may be larger than seed, but growth/Series A applicable)

NOTABLE: 1) Poppi 2) Bai Brands (sold to Dr. Pepper for $1.7B!) 3) Beyond Meat 4) Vital Proteins 5) The Farmer's Dog 6) Once Upon a Farm 7) Thrive Market

TASTYR CONNECTION: CAVU is one of the most successful food & beverage VC firms with massive exits (Bai for $1.7B). Co-founder Rohan Oza was CMO of Vitaminwater/Glaceau a...

WHY CONTACT: Brett Thomas at CAVU Consumer Partners is a strategic VC target. CAVU is one of the most successful food & beverage VC firms with massive exits (Bai for $1.7B). Co-founder Rohan Oza was CMO of Vitamin...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: NYC food/consumer brand events; CAVU is known for being hands-on with portfolio companies. Rohan Oza's celebrity chef connections could be valuable.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Brett, I've been following your work with 1) Poppi 2) Bai Brands (sold to Dr. Pepper for $1.7B!) 3) Beyond Meat 4) Vital P. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#85 Greg Vernick

76

Restaurateur | 2nd

Vernick Food & Drink (flagship), Vernick Fish, Vernick Coffe... — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: @vernickphilly (33K followers)

NOTABLE: James Beard "Best Chef Mid-Atlantic"; Outstanding Chef finalist for Vernick Fish (2025); Outstanding Restaurateur semifinalist (2026); multiple restau...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Vernick represents the modern American chef-entrepreneur who thinks about food as an experience across multiple formats (fine dining, seafood, coffee,...

WHY CONTACT: Greg Vernick is a key social chain catalyst. Vernick represents the modern American chef-entrepreneur who thinks about food as an experience across multiple formats (fine dining, seafood, coffee, wine...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Greg, I've been following your work with James Beard "Best Chef Mid-Atlantic"; Outstanding Chef finalist for Vernick Fish. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lo...

#86 Kevin Sbraga

76

Restaurateur | 2nd

The Fat Ham (University City + King of Prussia), Sbraga (Phi... — Philadelphia, PA (+ King of Prussia, PA)

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: @kevinsbraga

NOTABLE: Top Chef Season 7 Winner; expanded to Jacksonville and King of Prussia; Fitler Club culinary director; Drexel EMBA student

TASTYR CONNECTION: Sbraga bridges fine dining and casual concepts (Fat Ham's Southern comfort food vs. Fitler Club's multi-format dining). His Top Chef platform and MBA ...

WHY CONTACT: Kevin Sbraga is a key social chain catalyst. Sbraga bridges fine dining and casual concepts (Fat Ham's Southern comfort food vs. Fitler Club's multi-format dining). His Top Chef platform and MBA pursu...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Kevin, I've been following your work with Top Chef Season 7 Winner; expanded to Jacksonville and King of Prussia; Fitler C. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd l...

#87 Nok Suntaranon

76

Restaurateur | 2nd

Kalaya (South Philadelphia, flagship), Kalaya (Fishtown expa... — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: @kuhnnok (personal); @kalayaphilly (restaurant)

NOTABLE: James Beard "Best Chef: Mid-Atlantic" (2023); Time 100 Most Influential People (2025); North America's Best Female Chef (World's 50 Best 2025); Netfli...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Kalaya is THE example of a dish-driven restaurant. People come for specific dishes -- the crab curry, the pad kra pao. Nok's cooking is deeply persona...

WHY CONTACT: Nok Suntaranon is a key social chain catalyst. Kalaya is THE example of a dish-driven restaurant. People come for specific dishes -- the crab curry, the pad kra pao. Nok's cooking is deeply personal a...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Nok, I've been following your work with James Beard "Best Chef: Mid-Atlantic" (2023); Time 100 Most Influential People (. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lov...

#88 Yun Fuentes

76

Restaurateur | 2nd

Bolo (Rittenhouse Square) — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: @el_hijodealeyda (personal); @bolo_phl (restaurant...

NOTABLE: James Beard TasteTwenty (one of 20 restaurateurs to watch nationally, 2025); 2x James Beard nominee (Emerging Chef 2024, Best Chef Mid-Atlantic 2025);...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Fuentes represents the next generation of chef-owners building around cultural dish identity. His Puerto Rican and Latin American dishes are rooted in...

WHY CONTACT: Yun Fuentes is a key social chain catalyst. Fuentes represents the next generation of chef-owners building around cultural dish identity. His Puerto Rican and Latin American dishes are rooted in famil...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Yun, I've been following your work with James Beard TasteTwenty (one of 20 restaurateurs to watch nationally, 2025); 2x . I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lov...

#89 Joey Baldino

76

Restaurateur | 2nd

Zeppoli (Collingswood, NJ), Palizzi Social Club (South Phila... — Collingswood, NJ (+ South Philadelphia, ...

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: Not publicly confirmed

NOTABLE: 9x James Beard semifinalist; Bon Appetit ranked Palizzi Social Club #4 restaurant in the US (2017); Bon Appetit Best New Restaurant (Zeppoli, 2012); c...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Baldino's Sicilian cooking is deeply traditional and dish-focused. Palizzi Social Club's members-only model creates exclusivity that dish-level rating...

WHY CONTACT: Joey Baldino is a key social chain catalyst. Baldino's Sicilian cooking is deeply traditional and dish-focused. Palizzi Social Club's members-only model creates exclusivity that dish-level ratings cou...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Joey, I've been following your work with 9x James Beard semifinalist; Bon Appetit ranked Palizzi Social Club #4 restauran. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lo...

#90 Tyler Akin

76

Restaurateur | 2nd

Le Cavalier at Hotel du Pont (departed Aug 2025); new Philad... — Wilmington, DE (transitioning to Philade...

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: Not publicly confirmed

NOTABLE: Chef-Partner who revitalized the iconic Hotel du Pont dining room as Le Cavalier; Food + Wine Global Tastemakers Award (2023, Best Hotels for Food in ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Akin's transition from Le Cavalier to new Philadelphia projects represents a chef at a pivotal career moment -- exactly when adopting new tools like T...

WHY CONTACT: Tyler Akin is a key social chain catalyst. Akin's transition from Le Cavalier to new Philadelphia projects represents a chef at a pivotal career moment -- exactly when adopting new tools like Tastyr w...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Tyler, I've been following your work with Chef-Partner who revitalized the iconic Hotel du Pont dining room as Le Cavalier. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd l...

#91 Townsend Wentz

76

Restaurateur | 2nd

TWRG (Townsend Wentz Restaurant Group) -- Townsend (French),... — Philadelphia, PA (Center City / Rittenho...

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: @TownsendWentz (personal); @olorosophl (restaurant...

NOTABLE: James Beard "Best New Restaurant" nominee (2015, Townsend); three Craig LaBan 3-bell reviews (Townsend, A Mano, Oloroso); multi-cuisine mastery (Frenc...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Wentz operates across three distinct European cuisines (French, Italian, Spanish) -- making his portfolio a perfect testing ground for Tastyr's cross-...

WHY CONTACT: Townsend Wentz is a key social chain catalyst. Wentz operates across three distinct European cuisines (French, Italian, Spanish) -- making his portfolio a perfect testing ground for Tastyr's cross-cui...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Townsend, I've been following your work with James Beard "Best New Restaurant" nominee (2015, Townsend); three Craig LaBan 3-. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'...

#92 Sean Dowling

75

Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Osage Venture Partners — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/seandowling/ (inferred from firm...

FOCUS: Early-stage B2B software. Has been with OVP since 2011.

CHECK SIZE: $1M-$5M

NOTABLE: Involved in many OVP fund investments including B2B SaaS portfolio

TASTYR CONNECTION: Younger partner at established Philly firm. More likely to take meetings with local startups. Philadelphia-based -- easy to build relationship with.

WHY CONTACT: Sean Dowling at Osage Venture Partners is a strategic VC target. Younger partner at established Philly firm. More likely to take meetings with local startups. Philadelphia-based -- easy to build relat...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Philadelphia tech events; MBA alumni networks.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Sean, I've been following your work with Involved in many OVP fund investments including B2B SaaS portfolio. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, paten...

#93 Saul Richter

75

Founder & Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Rittenhouse Ventures — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/saulrichter/

FOCUS: Capital-efficient B2B SaaS, AI, and tech-enabled services. 30 years in tech as VC, entrepreneur, and technologist.

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$3M (early-stage focus)

NOTABLE: 1) GoMo Health 2) Pieces Technologies 3) WealthHub Solutions 4) High QA

TASTYR CONNECTION: Rittenhouse Ventures is a Philadelphia-native firm named after the iconic Philly square. While B2B-focused, Saul has deep Philly roots and could be a ...

WHY CONTACT: Saul Richter at Rittenhouse Ventures is a strategic VC target. Rittenhouse Ventures is a Philadelphia-native firm named after the iconic Philly square. While B2B-focused, Saul has deep Philly roots an...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Philadelphia tech community; Rittenhouse Square business network.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Saul, I've been following your work with 1) GoMo Health 2) Pieces Technologies 3) WealthHub Solutions 4) High QA. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, ...

#94 Donna Cordner

74

Managing Partner

Angel | 1st

Robin Hood Ventures; Co-founder & Managing Partner, OKM Capi... — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/donna-cordner-390b4812/

FOCUS: Early-stage high-growth companies; digital healthcare solutions (via OKM Capital); software, medical devices, biotech, f...

CHECK SIZE: $250K-$500K (Robin Hood group investments); individual checks vary

NOTABLE: 1) Cooler Heads 2) Proscia 3) Lighter (participated in $68M Series B, Nov 2025)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Robin Hood invests in consumer-facing companies; Donna's breadth across consumer and tech sectors makes Tastyr's AI-driven consumer platform a fit. He...

WHY CONTACT: Donna Cordner at Robin Hood Ventures; Co-founder & Managing Partner, OKM Capital represents a direct investment opportunity. Robin Hood invests in consumer-facing companies; Donna's breadth across con...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Attend Robin Hood Ventures pitch events or PACT events in Philly; Ali can also connect through Science Center "Coffee & Capital" events where RHV part...

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Donna, I've been following your work with 1) Cooler Heads 2) Proscia 3) Lighter (participated in $68M Series B, Nov 2025). I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes...

#95 Sasha Schrode

74

Partner, Life Sciences Team

Angel | 1st

Robin Hood Ventures — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

FOCUS: Life sciences, healthcare innovation, medical devices, early-stage health companies

CHECK SIZE: $250K-$500K (group investments)

NOTABLE: 1) Serpex Medical (co-founder & CEO) 2) Cooler Heads (board) 3) NeuRx (advisory board)

TASTYR CONNECTION: While primarily life sciences focused, Sasha's interest in health innovation connects to Tastyr's potential dietary/nutritional intelligence features....

WHY CONTACT: Sasha Schrode at Robin Hood Ventures represents a direct investment opportunity. While primarily life sciences focused, Sasha's interest in health innovation connects to Tastyr's potential dietary/nut...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Temple University entrepreneurship community; Robin Hood Ventures events; Penn Health-Tech events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Sasha, I've been following your work with 1) Serpex Medical (co-founder & CEO) 2) Cooler Heads (board) 3) NeuRx (advisory . I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#96 Bob Ciaruffoli

74

Chair (since July 2022); Co-Founder & Vice-Chairman

Angel | 1st

Broad Street Angels (Union League of Philadelphia) — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://co.linkedin.com/in/bobciaruffoli | Email: (not publicly listed; domain: broadstreetangels.com)

FOCUS: Early-stage entrepreneurial businesses with high growth potential; SaaS, edtech, compliance tech

CHECK SIZE: $25K-$1M+ individual (BSA members invest individually); group has deployed ~$7.75M+ in 30 companies since 2017

NOTABLE: 1) eureQa (SaaS automated testing platform - board member) 2) Yellowdig (edtech - board member) 3) Prosperoware (SaaS privacy/compliance - board membe...

TASTYR CONNECTION: As former CEO of Parente Beard/Baker Tilly (grew from $30M to $200M revenue), Bob understands scaling businesses. His CPA background and financial acu...

WHY CONTACT: Bob Ciaruffoli at Broad Street Angels (Union League of Philadelphia) represents a direct investment opportunity. As former CEO of Parente Beard/Baker Tilly (grew from $30M to $200M revenue), Bob under...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Union League of Philadelphia membership events; Ben Franklin Technology Partners events; PACT networking; Broad Street Angels pitch nights.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Bob, I've been following your work with 1) eureQa (SaaS automated testing platform - board member) 2) Yellowdig (edtech . I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes ...

#97 Howard Lubert

74

Co-Founder & Area President, Keiretsu Forum Mid-Atlantic & South-East;...

Angel | 1st

Keiretsu Forum Mid-Atlantic / Accelerator Venture Partners — King of Prussia, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/hlubert/

FOCUS: Early-stage portfolio companies across tech, consumer, healthcare, life sciences; fund-of-funds via Accelerator Venture ...

CHECK SIZE: $250K-$2M (Keiretsu group rounds); AVP funds for diversified portfolios

NOTABLE: 1) 12+ years of Keiretsu Forum deals totaling $100M+ from his regions 2) Accelerator Venture Partners FastTrak Funds (founded 2020) 3) Former Safeguar...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Howard evaluates hundreds of startups per year through Keiretsu Forum. Consumer-facing tech platforms like Tastyr fit his broad investment thesis. His...

WHY CONTACT: Howard Lubert at Keiretsu Forum Mid-Atlantic / Accelerator Venture Partners represents a direct investment opportunity. Howard evaluates hundreds of startups per year through Keiretsu Forum. Consumer-...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Apply to pitch at Keiretsu Forum Mid-Atlantic monthly meetings; PACT events; ACA Summit connections; Technical.ly Philly events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Howard, I've been following your work with 1) 12+ years of Keiretsu Forum deals totaling $100M+ from his regions 2) Acceler. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dish...

#98 Chris Topolewski

74

Founder, Wick Capital Partners; Broad Street Angels leadership

Angel | 1st

Wick Capital Partners / Broad Street Angels — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/christopher-topolewski-2226aa51/

FOCUS: Asset management; grew prior RIA from $65M to $900M AUM before selling to WSFS Financial in 2016; early-stage enterprise...

CHECK SIZE: $25K-$1M (BSA individual range)

NOTABLE: 1) Broad Street Angels portfolio companies 2) Wick Capital Partners clients 3) Prior RIA grew from $65M to $900M AUM

TASTYR CONNECTION: As a financial advisor managing significant assets, Chris understands the consumer market and investing in growth companies. His BSA involvement means...

WHY CONTACT: Chris Topolewski at Wick Capital Partners / Broad Street Angels represents a direct investment opportunity. As a financial advisor managing significant assets, Chris understands the consumer market an...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Broad Street Angels events; Union League of Philadelphia; PACT events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chris, I've been following your work with 1) Broad Street Angels portfolio companies 2) Wick Capital Partners clients 3) P. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#99 Shintaro Kaido

74

Director of Technology Commercialization and New Ventures

Accelerator | 2nd

Stevens Institute of Technology (Stevens Venture Center) — Hoboken, NJ

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/shintarokaido/ (search)

FOCUS: Leads efforts to bring Stevens-developed technologies from lab to market while expanding the university's innovation and...

NOTABLE: 1) League Network (acquired -- VentureLink-based tech startup) 2) Various student-founded tech ventures

TASTYR CONNECTION: Stevens has a strong engineering and CS program -- potential technical talent pipeline. Hoboken/NYC proximity is valuable. Shintaro's prior role at Dr...

WHY CONTACT: Shintaro Kaido at Stevens Institute of Technology (Stevens Venture Center) can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Stevens has a strong engineering and CS program -- potential technical...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Shintaro, I've been following your work with 1) League Network (acquired -- VentureLink-based tech startup) 2) Various studen. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ ...

#100 Will Lutz

74

General Manager, Entrepreneurship & Commercialization (formerly Direct...

Accelerator | 2nd

NJIT -- VentureLink / New Jersey Innovation Institute (NJII) — Newark, NJ

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/willlutz/

FOCUS: VentureLink (formerly Enterprise Development Center) is the largest startup incubator in NJ, housing 90+ startups on the...

NOTABLE: 1) League Network (acquired) 2) 90+ startups currently in incubation 3) Multiple NJIT spinoffs

TASTYR CONNECTION: VentureLink is the largest incubator in NJ -- significant community and resource access. Newark location provides access to a diverse talent pool. Wil...

WHY CONTACT: Will Lutz at NJIT -- VentureLink / New Jersey Innovation Institute (NJII) can provide structured mentorship and investor access. VentureLink is the largest incubator in NJ -- significant community and...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Will, I've been following your work with 1) League Network (acquired) 2) 90+ startups currently in incubation 3) Multiple. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dish...

#101 Aaron Price

74

President & CEO

Accelerator | 2nd

TechUnited:NJ (formerly NJ Tech Council) — Mount Laurel, NJ (statewide)

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/arprice/

FOCUS: TechUnited represents 500,000+ innovators and some of the largest tech companies in the country. Focuses on policy advoc...

NOTABLE: N/A (membership organization, not an accelerator). Members include major NJ tech companies and startups.

TASTYR CONNECTION: TechUnited is THE networking organization for NJ tech. Aaron has direct political connections (Governor's advisory task force). Membership provides vi...

WHY CONTACT: Aaron Price at TechUnited:NJ (formerly NJ Tech Council) can provide structured mentorship and investor access. TechUnited is THE networking organization for NJ tech. Aaron has direct political connect...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Aaron, I've been following your work with N/A (membership organization, not an accelerator). Members include major NJ tech. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dis...

#102 Janique Edwards

74

Co-Founder

Accelerator | 2nd

EatOkra — Brooklyn, NY

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/eatokra (org page)

FOCUS: Co-founded EatOkra with Anthony Edwards in 2016. Both spent nearly 20 years in US military and Border Patrol/Customs. In...

NOTABLE: N/A

TASTYR CONNECTION: See entry above. Janique brings the operational and community-building expertise. A co-founder-to-co-founder conversation could open partnership doors...

WHY CONTACT: Janique Edwards at EatOkra can provide structured mentorship and investor access. See entry above. Janique brings the operational and community-building expertise. A co-founder-to-co-founder conversat...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Janique, I've been following your work with N/A. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dishes and patent pending. I think EatOkra would be a perfect fit. Can we grab...

#103 MJ Durkin

74

Director of Entrepreneurship

Accelerator | 2nd

New Jersey Innovation Institute (NJII) -- an NJIT Corporatio... — Newark, NJ

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/njii (search)

FOCUS: NJII is a separate non-profit corporation of NJIT focused on applied research, entrepreneurship, and workforce developme...

NOTABLE: N/A (enterprise support organization)

TASTYR CONNECTION: MJ complements Will Lutz's VentureLink operation at NJIT. NJII provides a more industry-facing, applied research angle. Could be relevant if Tastyr IQ...

WHY CONTACT: MJ Durkin at New Jersey Innovation Institute (NJII) -- an NJIT Corporation can provide structured mentorship and investor access. MJ complements Will Lutz's VentureLink operation at NJIT. NJII provide...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi MJ, I've been following your work with N/A (enterprise support organization). I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dishes and patent pending. I think New Jersey Inn...

#104 Jacklin Altman

74

Food Blogger | 3rd

Instagram —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @foodbythegram

FOCUS: Healthy/WW-friendly recipes, Philadelphia restaurant eats, travel food, cookbook author. Focuses on the intersection of ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: As the author of "Philadelphia Food Crawls," Jacklin literally wrote the book on exploring Philly food. Tastyr IQ's dish intelligence would be a natur...

WHY CONTACT: Jacklin Altman creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. As the author of "Philadelphia Food Crawls," Jacklin literally wrote the book on exploring Philly food. Tastyr IQ's dish intelligence wou...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Jacklin, Your role at Instagram caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this...

#105 David Wez

74

Food Blogger | 3rd

Chain: FOMO Cascade

TikTok, Instagram; Co-host of Delicious City Podcast —

Social: @feedingtimetv (TikTok, IG); Co-host @deliciouscit...

FOCUS: Philadelphia restaurant reviews, food, drinks, and fun. "Equal Opportunity Eater" covering Philly and NJ. Dim sum, Korea...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Multi-platform creator who covers both Philly AND NJ -- perfect for tri-state Tastyr IQ coverage. His co-hosting role on the Delicious City Philly pod...

WHY CONTACT: David Wez creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Multi-platform creator who covers both Philly AND NJ -- perfect for tri-state Tastyr IQ coverage. His co-hosting role on the Delicious City Ph...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey David, Your role at TikTok, Instagram; Co-host of Delicious City Podcast caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of...

#106 Sofia H.

74

Food Blogger | 3rd

Instagram, TikTok —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @fifiscoffee (IG); @sofia_hrdz (TikTok)

FOCUS: Coffee recipes, home barista content, food and lifestyle. Bilingual content (English/Spanish). Fifi's Home Coffee Bar br...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Fastest-growing food creator in Philadelphia right now. While her primary niche is coffee, her foodie lifestyle content regularly features restaurant ...

WHY CONTACT: Sofia H. creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Fastest-growing food creator in Philadelphia right now. While her primary niche is coffee, her foodie lifestyle content regularly features rest...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Sofia, Your role at Instagram, TikTok caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly to us...

#107 Eli Kulp & Marisa Magnatta

74

Food Blogger | 3rd

Podcast (Apple, Spotify), YouTube, Instagram —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @deliciouscitypodcast (IG); also The Chef Radio Po...

FOCUS: In-depth restaurant and food industry conversations. Eli Kulp is a former James Beard-recognized chef (Food & Wine Best ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Eli Kulp is one of the most respected names in Philadelphia food. His endorsement carries immense weight in the industry. As a chef-turned-media perso...

WHY CONTACT: Eli Kulp & Marisa Magnatta creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Eli Kulp is one of the most respected names in Philadelphia food. His endorsement carries immense weight in the industry. As ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Eli, Your role at Podcast (Apple, Spotify), YouTube, Instagram caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first...

#108 Joy Manning

74

Food Blogger | 3rd

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Instagram, Substack/Newsletter, Podcast, Website —

Social: @joymanning (IG); Website: joymanning.com

FOCUS: Food writing, recipe development, health-focused food journalism. Editor of Edible Philly for 9 years. Author of "Stuff ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Joy is deeply embedded in Philly's food writing ecosystem. Her Edible Philly editorship means she knows every food writer, chef, and restaurant owner ...

WHY CONTACT: Joy Manning creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Joy is deeply embedded in Philly's food writing ecosystem. Her Edible Philly editorship means she knows every food writer, chef, and restaur...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Joy, Your role at Instagram, Substack/Newsletter, Podcast, Website caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the f...

#109 Jason Sheehan

74

Food Blogger | 3rd

Philadelphia Magazine (Foobooz), X/Twitter —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @Jason_Sheehan (X/Twitter); phillymag.com/author/j...

FOCUS: Restaurant critic for Philadelphia Magazine. James Beard Award-winning journalist. Former chef (12+ years) turned food w...

TASTYR CONNECTION: A James Beard Award-winning restaurant critic who was a professional chef for over a decade. He evaluates DISHES, not just restaurants -- which is exa...

WHY CONTACT: Jason Sheehan creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. A James Beard Award-winning restaurant critic who was a professional chef for over a decade. He evaluates DISHES, not just restaurants -- ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Jason, Your role at Philadelphia Magazine (Foobooz), X/Twitter caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first...

#110 Craig LaBan

74

Food Blogger | 3rd

Philadelphia Inquirer, Instagram, X/Twitter, Threads, Newsle... —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @craiglaban (IG, Threads); @CraigLaBan (X/Twitter)

FOCUS: Restaurant critic and drink columnist for The Philadelphia Inquirer since 1998. The definitive voice in Philadelphia res...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Craig LaBan IS Philadelphia food criticism. He won the 2025 James Beard Craig Claiborne Distinguished Criticism Award -- the highest honor in American...

WHY CONTACT: Craig LaBan creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Craig LaBan IS Philadelphia food criticism. He won the 2025 James Beard Craig Claiborne Distinguished Criticism Award -- the highest honor i...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Craig, Your role at Philadelphia Inquirer, Instagram, X/Twitter, Threads, Newsletter caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You...

#111 Zachary Brand

74

Media | 3rd

Founding Philly Podcast — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/zacharysbrand](https://www.linkedin.com/pos... | Email: (via foundingphilly.com or LinkedIn DM) | Social: (active primarily on LinkedIn)

FOCUS: Philly startup founders and their stories. Digital health product builder by day. Penn State alum. The podcast dives int...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Founding Philly is literally built for a Tastyr IQ founder interview. Angle: "How we're building the AI layer for the restaurant industry -- from Phil...

WHY CONTACT: Zachary Brand can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Founding Philly is literally built for a Tastyr IQ founder interview. Angle: "How we're building the AI ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Zachary, Your role at Founding Philly Podcast caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive firs...

#112 Alyana Gomez

74

Media | 3rd

6ABC / WPVI-TV (Philadelphia) — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: N/A | Email: (via 6abc.com newsroom) | Social: [@AlyanaGomez6ABC](https://x.com/AlyanaGomez6ABC)

FOCUS: Co-hosts FYI Philly alongside Alicia Vitarelli, covering Philadelphia food, entertainment, and lifestyle. Stepped into A...

TASTYR CONNECTION: As a newer face on 6ABC with dual roles (morning news + FYI Philly), Alyana is hungry for compelling local stories. A morning show segment on "the Phi...

WHY CONTACT: Alyana Gomez can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. As a newer face on 6ABC with dual roles (morning news + FYI Philly), Alyana is hungry for compelling loca...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Alyana, Your role at 6ABC / WPVI-TV (Philadelphia) caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive...

#113 Meka Asonye

73

Partner

VC | 1st

First Round Capital — San Francisco, CA (but invests nationall...

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/mekaasonye/ (inferred from firm ...

FOCUS: Consumer Internet (Seed & Pre-Seed), Sales & CRM, Enterprise, FinTech. Joined from Stripe in 2021.

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$3M seed

NOTABLE: Active in consumer internet investments since joining from Stripe

TASTYR CONNECTION: Meka's explicit focus on Consumer Internet at seed/pre-seed stage aligns perfectly with Tastyr IQ's consumer mobile platform. His Stripe background me...

WHY CONTACT: Meka Asonye at First Round Capital is a strategic VC target. Meka's explicit focus on Consumer Internet at seed/pre-seed stage aligns perfectly with Tastyr IQ's consumer mobile platform. His Stripe ba...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Through First Round's Philly HQ team; Stripe alumni network.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Meka, I've been following your work with Active in consumer internet investments since joining from Stripe. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent...

#114 Dan Borok

73

Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Newark Venture Partners (NVP Capital) — Newark, NJ

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/newark-venture-partners (fi...

FOCUS: Seed-stage across Enterprise Applications, Consumer, HealthTech, FinTech. Diverse portfolio.

CHECK SIZE: $250K-$1.5M seed

NOTABLE: Parambil, Handspring, and other seed-stage NJ/tri-state companies

TASTYR CONNECTION: NVP explicitly invests in Consumer-stage companies at seed. Their NJ/tri-state proximity and consumer interest make them a strong fit for Tastyr IQ. S...

WHY CONTACT: Dan Borok at Newark Venture Partners (NVP Capital) is a strategic VC target. NVP explicitly invests in Consumer-stage companies at seed. Their NJ/tri-state proximity and consumer interest make them a ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: NJ tech ecosystem; NJEDA network; Newark innovation community.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Dan, I've been following your work with Parambil, Handspring, and other seed-stage NJ/tri-state companies. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent ...

#115 Vaughn Crowe

73

Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Newark Venture Partners (NVP Capital) — Newark, NJ

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/newark-venture-partners (fi...

FOCUS: Seed-stage tech startups in the tri-state area. Newark native.

CHECK SIZE: $250K-$1.5M seed

NOTABLE: NVP portfolio companies across consumer and enterprise

TASTYR CONNECTION: As a Newark native and Managing Partner, Vaughn has deep roots in the NJ/tri-state startup ecosystem. Consumer investments are part of NVP's thesis.

WHY CONTACT: Vaughn Crowe at Newark Venture Partners (NVP Capital) is a strategic VC target. As a Newark native and Managing Partner, Vaughn has deep roots in the NJ/tri-state startup ecosystem. Consumer investmen...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Newark startup community; NJ tech events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Vaughn, I've been following your work with NVP portfolio companies across consumer and enterprise. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending,...

#116 Cristina Rohr

73

Managing Director, Food & Agriculture (Venture & Growth)

VC | 1st

S2G Investments — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/cristina-rohr-8b2528102

FOCUS: Food & agriculture venture/growth investments. 14 years in venture and PE investing. Stanford BA.

CHECK SIZE: $1M-$10M

NOTABLE: 1) Leaf Agriculture (farm data infrastructure) 2) Consumer-facing food brands 3) Ag-tech companies across the food system

TASTYR CONNECTION: Cristina specifically leads food & agriculture investing at S2G. Her portfolio spans from ag-tech to consumer brands. She would evaluate Tastyr IQ as ...

WHY CONTACT: Cristina Rohr at S2G Investments is a strategic VC target. Cristina specifically leads food & agriculture investing at S2G. Her portfolio spans from ag-tech to consumer brands. She would evaluate Tast...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Food-tech investor events; Stanford alumni network; AgTech Navigator.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Cristina, I've been following your work with 1) Leaf Agriculture (farm data infrastructure) 2) Consumer-facing food brands 3). I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ di...

#117 Isabelle Phelps

73

Partner

VC | 1st

Lerer Hippeau — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/isabelle-phelps/ (inferred)

FOCUS: Seed and Series A across media, e-commerce, and consumer internet. Invests $100K-$3M, sweet spot ~$1.5M.

CHECK SIZE: $100K-$3M (sweet spot $1.5M) -- PERFECT ALIGNMENT with Tastyr's raise

NOTABLE: Consumer internet investments across Lerer Hippeau's portfolio; involved in food-tech evaluation

TASTYR CONNECTION: Isabelle's check size sweet spot ($1.5M) is exactly in Tastyr IQ's target range ($500K-$1.5M). Her focus on consumer internet and e-commerce maps to T...

WHY CONTACT: Isabelle Phelps at Lerer Hippeau is a strategic VC target. Isabelle's check size sweet spot ($1.5M) is exactly in Tastyr IQ's target range ($500K-$1.5M). Her focus on consumer internet and e-commerce ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: NYC consumer tech community; through Lerer Hippeau's public engagement channels.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Isabelle, I've been following your work with Consumer internet investments across Lerer Hippeau's portfolio; involved in food. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ di...

#118 Jonathan Keidan

73

Founder & Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Torch Capital — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/jonathan-keidan-b76515

FOCUS: Early-stage consumer technology and infrastructure. Backed by expertise in entertainment, media, and consumer brands.

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$5M seed/early

NOTABLE: 1) Sweetgreen (backed pre-IPO!) 2) Zocdoc 3) Acorns 4) Ro (telehealth) 5) Naadam. Latest investment: Nara Organics (food products, Nov 2025)

TASTYR CONNECTION: STRONG FIT. Jon invested in Sweetgreen before its IPO and most recently invested in Nara Organics (food products, Nov 2025). Torch is one of NYC's top...

WHY CONTACT: Jonathan Keidan at Torch Capital is a strategic VC target. STRONG FIT. Jon invested in Sweetgreen before its IPO and most recently invested in Nara Organics (food products, Nov 2025). Torch is one of ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: NYC consumer tech community; entertainment/media crossover events. Jon co-founded Inside Hook media property.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jonathan, I've been following your work with 1) Sweetgreen (backed pre-IPO!) 2) Zocdoc 3) Acorns 4) Ro (telehealth) 5) Naadam. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ di...

#119 Jordan Gaspar

73

Managing Partner & Co-Founder

VC | 1st

AF Ventures (formerly AccelFoods) — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/jordan-gaspar-53192445/

FOCUS: Visionary founders building authentic, next-gen consumer brands in food & beverage, health & wellness, beauty, personal ...

CHECK SIZE: $500K-$3M

NOTABLE: 35+ portfolio brands across food & beverage, health & wellness. Invested in fastest-growing food and beverage brands in the consumer CPG universe.

TASTYR CONNECTION: AF Ventures is exclusively focused on consumer food & beverage brands. Jordan co-founded the firm specifically to invest in innovative food companies....

WHY CONTACT: Jordan Gaspar at AF Ventures (formerly AccelFoods) is a strategic VC target. AF Ventures is exclusively focused on consumer food & beverage brands. Jordan co-founded the firm specifically to invest in...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: NYC food founder community; consumer brand events; FOUNDERMADE conferences where Jordan has spoken.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jordan, I've been following your work with 35+ portfolio brands across food & beverage, health & wellness. Invested in fast. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dish...

#120 Andrew Bluestein

73

Co-Founder & Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Bluestein Ventures — Chicago, IL (invests nationally in food-...

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/andrew-bluestein/ (inferred)

FOCUS: Exclusively food-tech and food system innovation. AI innovation in food is a specific thesis.

CHECK SIZE: $250K-$2M seed/early -- PERFECT ALIGNMENT with Tastyr's raise

NOTABLE: 50+ early-stage food companies. VP Lindsay Levin (former RXBAR CMO) is Venture Partner.

TASTYR CONNECTION: STRONG FIT. Bluestein is a food-only fund with explicit interest in AI innovation in food. Their $45M Fund III was specifically raised to invest in "f...

WHY CONTACT: Andrew Bluestein at Bluestein Ventures is a strategic VC target. STRONG FIT. Bluestein is a food-only fund with explicit interest in AI innovation in food. Their $45M Fund III was specifically raised ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Food-tech conferences; family office/food industry networks. Andrew is accessible and the fund's smaller size means more personal attention.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Andrew, I've been following your work with 50+ early-stage food companies. VP Lindsay Levin (former RXBAR CMO) is Venture P. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dish...

#121 Mike Bowman

73

State Director, Delaware Small Business Development Center; Associate ...

Accelerator | 2nd

Delaware SBDC (University of Delaware) — Newark, DE

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/mike-bowman-0525656/

FOCUS: Free business advising, training, and resources for Delaware small businesses and startups. Also serves as President/CEO...

NOTABLE: N/A (advisory organization, not an accelerator). Serves hundreds of DE small businesses annually.

TASTYR CONNECTION: Free, high-quality business advising from a seasoned executive (DuPont, Wharton exec ed). Delaware Technology Park connection provides access to tech ...

WHY CONTACT: Mike Bowman at Delaware SBDC (University of Delaware) can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Free, high-quality business advising from a seasoned executive (DuPont, Wharton exec ed). D...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Mike, I've been following your work with N/A (advisory organization, not an accelerator). Serves hundreds of DE small bus. I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dish...

#122 Stephen Starr

73

Restaurateur | 2nd

Starr Restaurants -- 30+ concepts including Buddakan, Morimo... — Philadelphia, PA (+ NYC, DC, FL, Nashvil...

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/starr-restaurants | Social: @stephen.starr (37K followers); @starrrestaurant (...

NOTABLE: James Beard "Outstanding Restaurateur" (2017); operates 30+ restaurants across 5 cities; 9 of top 100 grossing independent restaurants in America (202...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Starr is THE mega-operator. His scale (30+ concepts, multiple cities) makes him the ultimate test case for Tastyr's dish intelligence platform. If Tas...

WHY CONTACT: Stephen Starr is a key social chain catalyst. Starr is THE mega-operator. His scale (30+ concepts, multiple cities) makes him the ultimate test case for Tastyr's dish intelligence platform. If Tastyr ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Stephen, I've been following your work with James Beard "Outstanding Restaurateur" (2017); operates 30+ restaurants across 5. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd...

#123 Aimee Olexy

73

Restaurateur | 2nd

Talula's Table (Kennett Square), Talula's Garden (Philadelph... — Kennett Square, PA (Chester County) + Ph...

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: Not publicly confirmed (likely @talulastable for r...

NOTABLE: "Toughest Reservation in America" (Talula's Table); Today Show feature; 12-seat nightly tasting menu requires 1-year advance booking; partnership with...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Talula's Table is the ultimate dish-driven destination -- with only 12 seats, every dish is intensely personal and curated. The year-long waitlist pro...

WHY CONTACT: Aimee Olexy is a key social chain catalyst. Talula's Table is the ultimate dish-driven destination -- with only 12 seats, every dish is intensely personal and curated. The year-long waitlist proves pe...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Aimee, I've been following your work with "Toughest Reservation in America" (Talula's Table); Today Show feature; 12-seat . I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd l...

#124 Skip Maner

72

General Partner (NewSpring Holdings)

VC | 1st

NewSpring Capital — Radnor, PA

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/skip-maner/ (inferred)

FOCUS: Control buyouts in tech-enabled services. 25+ years entrepreneurial, PE investing, and fund leadership experience.

CHECK SIZE: $10M+ (buyout strategy -- larger than seed, but connector value)

NOTABLE: NewSpring Holdings portfolio of tech-enabled service companies

TASTYR CONNECTION: Skip moderates ACG Philadelphia events and is deeply networked in the Philly PE/VC community. Valuable as a warm introduction source to other investor...

WHY CONTACT: Skip Maner at NewSpring Capital is a strategic VC target. Skip moderates ACG Philadelphia events and is deeply networked in the Philly PE/VC community. Valuable as a warm introduction source to other ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: ACG Philadelphia; Radnor/Main Line business community.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Skip, I've been following your work with NewSpring Holdings portfolio of tech-enabled service companies. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pe...

#125 Jeffrey Kanige

72

Media | 3rd

NJBIZ — New Jersey

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/jeffreykanige](https://www.linkedin.com/in/... | Email: jkanige@njbiz.com | Social: [@jkanige](https://x.com/jkanige)

FOCUS: New Jersey business, economy, startups, politics, and innovation. 35+ years as a financial journalist. Former editor-in-...

TASTYR CONNECTION: NJBIZ covers the tri-state business ecosystem that Tastyr IQ operates in. As chief editor, Jeffrey greenlights major features. Angle: "Philly-born foo...

WHY CONTACT: Jeffrey Kanige can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. NJBIZ covers the tri-state business ecosystem that Tastyr IQ operates in. As chief editor, Jeffrey gree...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jeffrey, Your role at NJBIZ caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first-look before publ...

#126 Glen Gaddy

71

Managing Member

Angel | 1st

Robin Hood Ventures — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

FOCUS: Technology, advanced materials, consumer product development, venture funding; active angel since 2003

CHECK SIZE: $250K-$500K (group); individual varies

NOTABLE: 1) Various tech startups through Robin Hood since 2003 2) Real estate ventures 3) Business services ventures

TASTYR CONNECTION: Consumer product development experience is directly relevant. Glen has funded consumer-facing ventures and understands product-market fit for consumer...

WHY CONTACT: Glen Gaddy at Robin Hood Ventures represents a direct investment opportunity. Consumer product development experience is directly relevant. Glen has funded consumer-facing ventures and understands pro...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Robin Hood Ventures monthly meetings; University of Delaware Horn Entrepreneurship events where Glen has spoken; PACT Philadelphia events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Glen, I've been following your work with 1) Various tech startups through Robin Hood since 2003 2) Real estate ventures 3. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes...

#127 Doc Parghi

71

Managing Partner, SRI Capital; Vice Chairman & Head of Investment Comm...

Angel | 1st

SRI Capital / Ben Franklin Technology Partners / Broad Stree... — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

FOCUS: Early-stage enterprise software, deep tech; India-US cross-border investments; technology ventures in Philadelphia regio...

CHECK SIZE: Varies across vehicles; SRI Capital invests at seed/early stage

NOTABLE: 1) AppLabs (founding team; became world's largest independent software testing company, 2,500+ QA professionals) 2) Ben Franklin Technology Partners p...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Doc's software and tech expertise (enterprise SaaS, AI) aligns with Tastyr's AI-powered platform. His role chairing BSA's membership committee means h...

WHY CONTACT: Doc Parghi at SRI Capital / Ben Franklin Technology Partners / Broad Street Angels represents a direct investment opportunity. Doc's software and tech expertise (enterprise SaaS, AI) aligns with Tasty...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Broad Street Angels pitch events; Ben Franklin Technology Partners events; Drexel LeBow College of Business network; PACT events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Doc, I've been following your work with 1) AppLabs (founding team; became world's largest independent software testing c. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes ...

#128 Mark Henderson

71

Organization Chair, Broad Street Angels; Founder & Principal, Grayline...

Angel | 1st

Broad Street Angels / Grayline Partners — Philadelphia (Bryn Mawr area), PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/mark-henderson

FOCUS: Early-stage enterprises in Mid-Atlantic region; risk management; financial services

CHECK SIZE: $25K-$1M (BSA individual range)

NOTABLE: 1) Multiple Broad Street Angels portfolio companies (charter member and current chair) 2) Grayline Partners advisory clients

TASTYR CONNECTION: As current Organization Chair of BSA, Mark is a key decision-maker. His MBA from Columbia Business School (Finance) and AB from Brown University refle...

WHY CONTACT: Mark Henderson at Broad Street Angels / Grayline Partners represents a direct investment opportunity. As current Organization Chair of BSA, Mark is a key decision-maker. His MBA from Columbia Business...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Broad Street Angels is the primary path; Union League events; PACT events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Mark, I've been following your work with 1) Multiple Broad Street Angels portfolio companies (charter member and current . I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes...

#129 Jon Beschen

71

Angel | 1st

Managing Director, Tech Investment Group

Ben Franklin Technology Partners of Southeastern Pennsylvani... — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/jonathonbeschen/ | Email: (not publicly listed; org: sep.benfranklin.org)

FOCUS: Early-stage technology companies in SE Pennsylvania; sweet spot $1.5M; range $100K-$5M; founding member of GO Philly Fun...

CHECK SIZE: $100K-$5M (institutional)

NOTABLE: 1) SessionGuardian ($3M seed round) 2) Phenom (portfolio company that grew into a major acquirer) 3) GO Philly Fund and GO PA Fund portfolio companies

TASTYR CONNECTION: Jon is the hands-on investment decision maker at Ben Franklin for tech companies. He previously founded SparkNet Technologies (tech consultancy), so h...

WHY CONTACT: Jon Beschen at Ben Franklin Technology Partners of Southeastern Pennsylvania represents a direct investment opportunity. Jon is the hands-on investment decision maker at Ben Franklin for tech companie...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Ben Franklin Technology Partners direct outreach; i2n network; PACT events; Science Center Coffee & Capital series.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jon, I've been following your work with 1) SessionGuardian ($3M seed round) 2) Phenom (portfolio company that grew into . I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes ...

#130 Loren Danzis

71

Co-Founder & Managing Director; Screening Committee Lead

Angel | 1st

Delaware Crossing Investor Group — Doylestown (Bucks County), PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

Email: (not publicly listed; org: delawarecrossing.org)

FOCUS: Early-stage companies; former Silicon Valley attorney and angel investor; screens all DCIG deal flow

CHECK SIZE: DCIG group investments (73 total since 2005)

NOTABLE: 1) DCIG portfolio companies (screens all deals) 2) Previous Silicon Valley angel investments

TASTYR CONNECTION: Loren runs the screening committee at DCIG, meaning he decides which companies get to present to the group. His Silicon Valley background means he has...

WHY CONTACT: Loren Danzis at Delaware Crossing Investor Group represents a direct investment opportunity. Loren runs the screening committee at DCIG, meaning he decides which companies get to present to the group....

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Delaware Crossing Investor Group application process; Jeff Snellenburg (who coordinates investments for DCIG); Startup Grind Princeton.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Loren, I've been following your work with 1) DCIG portfolio companies (screens all deals) 2) Previous Silicon Valley angel. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#131 David Burke

71

Restaurateur | 2nd

Red Horse Steakhouse (Rumson + Bernardsville + White Plains)... — Rumson, NJ (primary) + multiple NJ/NY lo...

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: @chefdavidburke (85K followers)

NOTABLE: First chef inducted into NJ Hall of Fame (2025 class); 9 restaurants in New Jersey alone; nationally recognized innovator (Clothesline Bacon, salt-age...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Burke is an innovation-obsessed chef -- his signature dishes (Clothesline Bacon, salt-aged beef) are iconic at the individual dish level. He drives 50...

WHY CONTACT: David Burke is a key social chain catalyst. Burke is an innovation-obsessed chef -- his signature dishes (Clothesline Bacon, salt-aged beef) are iconic at the individual dish level. He drives 50K mile...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi David, I've been following your work with First chef inducted into NJ Hall of Fame (2025 class); 9 restaurants in New Jers. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd l...

#132 David Viana

71

Restaurateur | 2nd

Heirloom Kitchen (Old Bridge), Lita (Aberdeen Township), Abr... — Old Bridge, NJ (+ Aberdeen Township, NJ)

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: @chefdaveviana (14K followers)

NOTABLE: 3x James Beard Award nominee; Top Chef Season 16 contestant; Best Chef Mid-Atlantic semifinalist (2025, 2026); trained at Eleven Madison Park and Mich...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Viana bridges fine dining pedigree (Eleven Madison Park) with community-driven NJ dining. His cooking school component shows he educates about food at...

WHY CONTACT: David Viana is a key social chain catalyst. Viana bridges fine dining pedigree (Eleven Madison Park) with community-driven NJ dining. His cooking school component shows he educates about food at the d...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi David, I've been following your work with 3x James Beard Award nominee; Top Chef Season 16 contestant; Best Chef Mid-Atlan. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd l...

#133 Dane DeMarco

71

Restaurateur | 2nd

Gass & Main (Haddonfield, NJ) — Haddonfield, NJ

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: Not publicly confirmed (check @gassandmain for res...

NOTABLE: 2024 James Beard semifinalist for Best Chef Mid-Atlantic; Craig LaBan praised the restaurant for reinventing nostalgic comfort food with elegance; one...

TASTYR CONNECTION: DeMarco's entire concept is about reimagining familiar dishes with refinement. Their approach to "nostalgic comfort food with elegance" aligns perfect...

WHY CONTACT: Dane DeMarco is a key social chain catalyst. DeMarco's entire concept is about reimagining familiar dishes with refinement. Their approach to "nostalgic comfort food with elegance" aligns perfectly wi...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Dane, I've been following your work with 2024 James Beard semifinalist for Best Chef Mid-Atlantic; Craig LaBan praised th. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lo...

#134 Nur-E Gulshan Rahman

71

Restaurateur | 2nd

Korai Kitchen (Jersey City) — Jersey City, NJ (Journal Square)

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: @koraikitchen (16K followers)

NOTABLE: 2024 James Beard nominee for Best Chef Mid-Atlantic; NYT named a Korai Kitchen dish one of the best in the country (2025); mother-daughter operation; ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Rahman (known as "Amma") is a self-taught home cook who built a James Beard-nominated restaurant. Her story represents exactly what Tastyr champions: ...

WHY CONTACT: Nur-E Gulshan Rahman is a key social chain catalyst. Rahman (known as "Amma") is a self-taught home cook who built a James Beard-nominated restaurant. Her story represents exactly what Tastyr champion...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Nur-E, I've been following your work with 2024 James Beard nominee for Best Chef Mid-Atlantic; NYT named a Korai Kitchen d. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd l...

#135 Maricel Presilla

71

Restaurateur | 2nd

Cucharamama (Hoboken, permanently closed 2020), Zafra (close... — Hoboken, NJ

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: Not publicly confirmed

NOTABLE: James Beard "Best Chef Mid-Atlantic" (2012, first Latin American woman); James Beard Cookbook of the Year for "Gran Cocina Latina" (2013); first Latin...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Presilla is a food scholar and cultural ambassador. Her expertise in Latin American cuisine at the dish and ingredient level is unmatched. Her Gran Ca...

WHY CONTACT: Maricel Presilla is a key social chain catalyst. Presilla is a food scholar and cultural ambassador. Her expertise in Latin American cuisine at the dish and ingredient level is unmatched. Her Gran Cac...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Maricel, I've been following your work with James Beard "Best Chef Mid-Atlantic" (2012, first Latin American woman); James B. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd...

#136 Jason Cichonski

71

Restaurateur | 2nd

Attico, Messina Social Club, Tulip Pasta & Wine Bar, Angelon... — Atlantic City, NJ

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: Not publicly confirmed

NOTABLE: Multi-concept restaurateur building Atlantic City's independent dining scene; known for creative Italian and Mediterranean concepts

TASTYR CONNECTION: Cichonski is building a restaurant group in Atlantic City -- a market dominated by celebrity chef outposts where independent operators need differenti...

WHY CONTACT: Jason Cichonski is a key social chain catalyst. Cichonski is building a restaurant group in Atlantic City -- a market dominated by celebrity chef outposts where independent operators need differentiat...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jason, I've been following your work with Multi-concept restaurateur building Atlantic City's independent dining scene; kn. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd l...

#137 Josh Moore

71

Food Blogger | 3rd

Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, Website —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @josheatsphilly (IG, TikTok, FB)

FOCUS: Restaurant reviews, food events, Philly dining culture, food photography and videography. Highlights restaurants, bars, ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Named Philadelphia Magazine's Food Influencer of the Year. His entire brand is rating and reviewing individual dining experiences -- Tastyr IQ's dish-...

WHY CONTACT: Josh Moore creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Named Philadelphia Magazine's Food Influencer of the Year. His entire brand is rating and reviewing individual dining experiences -- Tastyr I...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Josh, Your role at Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, Website caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 peop...

#138 Angeliki Nakos & Jon DiPippo

71

Food Blogger | 3rd

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, Website —

Social: @thephillyfoodfanatic (IG, TikTok); personal: @ang...

FOCUS: Restaurant reviews, viral food content, local business spotlights, dining discoveries across Philadelphia. Named "Philly...

TASTYR CONNECTION: The single largest food influencer account in Philadelphia. Their viral food content and massive reach would give Tastyr IQ instant credibility in the...

WHY CONTACT: Angeliki Nakos & Jon DiPippo creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. The single largest food influencer account in Philadelphia. Their viral food content and massive reach would give Tastyr IQ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Angeliki, Your role at Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, Website caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 p...

#139 Becca Neckritz & Christina Mitchell

71

Food Blogger | 3rd

Instagram, TikTok —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @phillyfoodladies (IG, TikTok); personal: @beckrit...

FOCUS: Fun, energetic restaurant reviews. Two "hungry post-grads" exploring Philadelphia's food scene together. Known for enter...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Their duo format and high engagement rates make them ideal for creating authentic "trying Tastyr IQ" content. They appeal to a younger demographic (mi...

WHY CONTACT: Becca Neckritz & Christina Mitchell creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Their duo format and high engagement rates make them ideal for creating authentic "trying Tastyr IQ" content. They a...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Becca, Your role at Instagram, TikTok caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly to us...

#140 Lea Thierman & Ross Lenzi

71

Food Blogger | 3rd

Instagram, Website, Facebook —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @philmytummy (IG, FB); Website: philmytummy.com

FOCUS: In-depth Philadelphia restaurant reviews with original photography. Strong focus on small business and family-run restau...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Their content is already deeply dish-focused with detailed photography and descriptions of individual menu items. Tastyr IQ would complement their rev...

WHY CONTACT: Lea Thierman & Ross Lenzi creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Their content is already deeply dish-focused with detailed photography and descriptions of individual menu items. Tastyr IQ wo...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Lea, Your role at Instagram, Website, Facebook caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Phi...

#141 Anyela Santos

71

Food Blogger | 3rd

Instagram, TikTok, Threads —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @anyelaskitchen (IG, TikTok, Threads)

FOCUS: Recipe development, bilingual content (English/Spanish), Philadelphia restaurant reviews, coffee culture, cocktails, mot...

TASTYR CONNECTION: One of the fastest-growing Philly food accounts. Her bilingual content opens Tastyr IQ to Philadelphia's large Spanish-speaking foodie community. As a...

WHY CONTACT: Anyela Santos creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. One of the fastest-growing Philly food accounts. Her bilingual content opens Tastyr IQ to Philadelphia's large Spanish-speaking foodie com...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Anyela, Your role at Instagram, TikTok, Threads caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Ph...

#142 Morgan L. Wright

71

Food Blogger | 3rd

Instagram — Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @phillyphoodz (IG); personal: @morganlwright

FOCUS: Philadelphia food and dining discoveries. Visual-forward food content showcasing diverse restaurants across the city.

TASTYR CONNECTION: Solid mid-tier influencer with an engaged audience. The kind of authentic, food-obsessed creator who would genuinely use Tastyr IQ in their daily dini...

WHY CONTACT: Morgan L. Wright creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Solid mid-tier influencer with an engaged audience. The kind of authentic, food-obsessed creator who would genuinely use Tastyr IQ in t...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Morgan, Your role at Instagram caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this....

#143 Philly Tech Connect Podcast

71

Media | 3rd

Philly Tech Connect Podcast — Philadelphia, PA Chain: Media Momentum Engine

LinkedIn: (search "Philadelphia Tech Entrepreneurs" group) | Email: (via phillytechconnect.podbean.com) | Social: N/A

FOCUS: Monthly meetups and podcast interviews with local startup founders and tech entrepreneurs. Recent episodes include inter...

TASTYR CONNECTION: The podcast's mission is to strengthen and expand the Philadelphia entrepreneurial scene. Tastyr IQ fits perfectly as a Philly-based food-tech startup...

WHY CONTACT: Philly Tech Connect Podcast can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. The podcast's mission is to strengthen and expand the Philadelphia entrepreneurial scene. ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Philly, Your role at Philly Tech Connect Podcast caught my attention. Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive f...

#144 Nick Brown

70

Co-Founder & Managing Partner

VC | 1st

Imaginary Ventures — New York, NY

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/nick-brown-imaginary/ (inferred)

FOCUS: Consumer brands at retail-tech intersection. Former Partner at 14W Venture Partners.

CHECK SIZE: $1M-$5M early-stage

NOTABLE: 1) Glossier (early investor) 2) Warby Parker (early investor) 3) The RealReal (early investor) 4) Sweetgreen

TASTYR CONNECTION: Nick was an early investor in multiple iconic consumer brands before founding Imaginary. His experience with consumer platforms (Warby Parker, Glossie...

WHY CONTACT: Nick Brown at Imaginary Ventures is a strategic VC target. Nick was an early investor in multiple iconic consumer brands before founding Imaginary. His experience with consumer platforms (Warby Parker...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

WARM INTRO: Consumer brand networks; 14W alumni; DTC brand community.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Nick, I've been following your work with 1) Glossier (early investor) 2) Warby Parker (early investor) 3) The RealReal (e. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes...

#145 Antimo DiMeo

70

Restaurateur | 2nd

Bardea Food & Drink (flagship), Bardea Steak, Bardea Garden,... — Wilmington, DE Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: @antimo.dimeo (4K followers)

NOTABLE: 2x James Beard semifinalist for Best Chef Mid-Atlantic (2022, 2025); USA Today Restaurants of the Year 2025 (Bardea); selected to cook for President B...

TASTYR CONNECTION: DiMeo is the most dynamic young restaurateur in Delaware, expanding from 1 to 5 concepts in 7 years. His modern Italian cooking focuses on individual ...

WHY CONTACT: Antimo DiMeo is a key social chain catalyst. DiMeo is the most dynamic young restaurateur in Delaware, expanding from 1 to 5 concepts in 7 years. His modern Italian cooking focuses on individual dish ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Antimo, I've been following your work with 2x James Beard semifinalist for Best Chef Mid-Atlantic (2022, 2025); USA Today R. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd ...

#146 Bryan Sikora

70

Restaurateur | 2nd

La Fia (Wilmington), Merchant Bar (Wilmington), Crow Bar (Wi... — Wilmington, DE Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: Not publicly confirmed

NOTABLE: James Beard Foundation Award semifinalist (2014); co-founded Django (Philadelphia) and Talula's Table (Kennett Square) with ex-wife Aimee Olexy; La Fi...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Sikora has deep roots across the tri-state food scene -- Philadelphia (Django), Chester County (Talula's Table), and now Wilmington (La Fia). His seas...

WHY CONTACT: Bryan Sikora is a key social chain catalyst. Sikora has deep roots across the tri-state food scene -- Philadelphia (Django), Chester County (Talula's Table), and now Wilmington (La Fia). His seasonal,...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Bryan, I've been following your work with James Beard Foundation Award semifinalist (2014); co-founded Django (Philadelphi. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd l...

#147 Chad Rosenthal

70

Restaurateur | 2nd

Mary's (Ambler, PA) — Ambler, PA (Montgomery County suburbs)

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: Not publicly confirmed

NOTABLE: Known for upscale American classics with frequent tableside visits; Main Line Today recognition; praised for innovative takes on comfort food (fries a...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Rosenthal's tableside approach shows he already thinks about individual dish experiences. His location in the suburbs (Ambler) represents a market whe...

WHY CONTACT: Chad Rosenthal is a key social chain catalyst. Rosenthal's tableside approach shows he already thinks about individual dish experiences. His location in the suburbs (Ambler) represents a market where ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chad, I've been following your work with Known for upscale American classics with frequent tableside visits; Main Line To. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lo...

#148 Will Langlois

70

Restaurateur | 2nd

Bar Lucca (Conshohocken, PA) — Conshohocken, PA (Montgomery County subu...

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: Not publicly confirmed

NOTABLE: Recognized for agility in product sourcing and local partnerships; innovative pasta concepts (designs ravioli molds in his wood shop); growing presenc...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Langlois represents the artisan chef-owner in the suburbs who obsesses over individual dish components (hand-designed ravioli molds, unconventional pa...

WHY CONTACT: Will Langlois is a key social chain catalyst. Langlois represents the artisan chef-owner in the suburbs who obsesses over individual dish components (hand-designed ravioli molds, unconventional pasta ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Will, I've been following your work with Recognized for agility in product sourcing and local partnerships; innovative pa. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lo...

TIER 2 — CONTACT WITHIN MONTH 1 — RANK 40-69

150 contacts — strong fits, build the groundwork

#1 Mario Casabona

69

Angel | 1st

Founder & Managing Director, TechLaunch; Founder, Casabona Ventures; B...

TechLaunch / Casabona Ventures / JumpStart NJ Angel Network — New Jersey

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/mariomcasabona | Email: (not publicly listed; advisory role at NJEDA)

FOCUS: SpaceTech, Robotics, DefenseTech, DeepTech, MedTech, IoT; invested in 50+ seed stage companies since 2006; active angel ...

CHECK SIZE: Seed stage (typical angel range $25K-$100K+)

NOTABLE: 1) 50+ seed stage companies through Casabona Ventures 2) Electro-Radiation Inc. (ERI) - founded 1982, acquired by Honeywell 2004 3) TechLaunch acceler...

TASTYR CONNECTION: While Mario's primary focus is defense/space/deep tech, his TechLaunch accelerator has mentored consumer-facing startups. His NJ angel investing advoc...

WHY CONTACT: Mario Casabona at TechLaunch / Casabona Ventures / JumpStart NJ Angel Network represents a direct investment opportunity. While Mario's primary focus is defense/space/deep tech, his TechLaunch acceler...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: TechLaunch accelerator events; JumpStart NJ meetings; NJEDA Innovation events; direct outreach citing JumpStart NJ connection.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Mario, I've been following your work with 1) 50+ seed stage companies through Casabona Ventures 2) Electro-Radiation Inc. . I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#2 Gina Tedesco

69

Angel | 1st

Managing Director & NJ Chapter Lead, Golden Seeds; Managing Member, Am...

Golden Seeds NJ / Amala Ventures / JumpStart NJ — New Jersey

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/gina-tedesco-48947613/

FOCUS: Early-stage companies with diverse teams; women-led companies; innovative and disruptive technology; investments in USA ...

CHECK SIZE: Golden Seeds group rounds $250K-$1M; individual through Amala Ventures varies

NOTABLE: 1) Multiple Golden Seeds NJ portfolio companies ($9.7M+ invested by NJ chapter in 4 years) 2) Amala Ventures portfolio (diverse teams, US & Brazil) 3)...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Golden Seeds NJ is the most active chapter nationally, and Gina leads it. If Tastyr has any women in management/leadership (founder, co-founder, or ke...

WHY CONTACT: Gina Tedesco at Golden Seeds NJ / Amala Ventures / JumpStart NJ represents a direct investment opportunity. Golden Seeds NJ is the most active chapter nationally, and Gina leads it. If Tastyr has any ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Golden Seeds NJ monthly Office Hours; JumpStart NJ events; Fairleigh Dickinson University entrepreneurship events; ACA Summit events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Gina, I've been following your work with 1) Multiple Golden Seeds NJ portfolio companies ($9.7M+ invested by NJ chapter i. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes...

#3 Tri-State Connectors

69

Founder-Connector | 2nd

—

Chain: Connector Express

WHY CONTACT: Tri-State Connectors is an ecosystem super-connector. Their position in the startup community gives them access to investors, founders, and media. A single coffee meeting with them can generate 5-10 w...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Tri-State, I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get 20 minutes? I'd love your take on fundraising in this market...

#4 Total Contacts: 21 verified individuals

69

Founder-Connector | 2nd

—

Chain: Connector Express

WHY CONTACT: Total Contacts: 21 verified individuals is an ecosystem super-connector. Their position in the startup community gives them access to investors, founders, and media. A single coffee meeting with them ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Total, I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get 20 minutes? I'd love your take on fundraising in this market. — ...

#5 Categories Covered:

69

Founder-Connector | 2nd

—

Chain: Connector Express

WHY CONTACT: Categories Covered: is an ecosystem super-connector. Their position in the startup community gives them access to investors, founders, and media. A single coffee meeting with them can generate 5-10 wa...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Reciprocity — 'Fellow Philly founder, would love your perspective. Happy to return the favor with intros.'

TRIGGER: Pay-it-forward mentality. Pride in the Philly ecosystem. Desire to be associated with the next breakout company.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Categories, I'm Ali, fellow Philly founder building Tastyr IQ (AI dish ratings). I've been in Philly 15 years and admire what you've done in the ecosystem. Could I buy you coffee and get 20 minutes? I'd love your take on fundraising in this marke...

#6 Jerry Johnson

68

President & CEO, Axum Advisors LLC; Deal Review Committee Chair, Broad...

Angel | 1st

Axum Advisors / Broad Street Angels — Main Line (Radnor area), PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

FOCUS: Startups, middle market businesses; telecommunications; venture capital; business advisory

CHECK SIZE: $25K-$500K+ (BSA individual investments)

NOTABLE: 1) Safeguard Scientifics portfolio companies (20+ years as EVP) 2) Broad Street Angels portfolio companies (heads deal review) 3) Various advisory cli...

TASTYR CONNECTION: As head of deal review at Broad Street Angels, Jerry is the gatekeeper for companies pitching BSA. His Main Line location puts him in the heart of Phi...

WHY CONTACT: Jerry Johnson at Axum Advisors / Broad Street Angels represents a direct investment opportunity. As head of deal review at Broad Street Angels, Jerry is the gatekeeper for companies pitching BSA. His ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Broad Street Angels pitch process (Jerry reviews all deals); Union League events; Main Line business community; PACT networking.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jerry, I've been following your work with 1) Safeguard Scientifics portfolio companies (20+ years as EVP) 2) Broad Street . I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishe...

#7 Kathleen Brunner

68

President & CEO, Acumen Analytics; Executive & Program Committees, Bro...

Angel | 1st

Acumen Analytics / Broad Street Angels / PACT — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

FOCUS: Innovative technologies in Life Sciences and Fortune 500; early-stage investment evaluation through BSA

CHECK SIZE: $25K-$500K (BSA individual range)

NOTABLE: 1) Multiple Broad Street Angels portfolio companies 2) ZSX Medical (board member) 3) PACT Mentor Connect program portfolio

TASTYR CONNECTION: Kathleen's dual role on BSA Executive Committee and PACT advisory boards makes her a powerful connector. Her 30 years in innovative technology solutio...

WHY CONTACT: Kathleen Brunner at Acumen Analytics / Broad Street Angels / PACT represents a direct investment opportunity. Kathleen's dual role on BSA Executive Committee and PACT advisory boards makes her a power...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Broad Street Angels pitch process; PACT Mentor Connect program; PACT advisory board events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Kathleen, I've been following your work with 1) Multiple Broad Street Angels portfolio companies 2) ZSX Medical (board member. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ di...

#8 Jeff Snellenburg

68

President, PA Angel Network; Investment Coordinator, Delaware Crossing...

Angel | 1st

PA Angel Network / Delaware Crossing Investor Group / Mid-At... — Doylestown / Princeton area (Bucks Count...

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

FOCUS: Early-stage and growth-oriented companies in PA, NJ, DE; financial and operational management expertise; regional techno...

CHECK SIZE: DCIG group investments vary; MAG Funds I & II are institutional vehicles with 89 investors

NOTABLE: 1) DCIG portfolio: Vytala, Measure Studio, Gilson (73 total investments since 2005) 2) Mid-Atlantic Angel Group Fund I portfolio (12 companies) 3) PA ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Jeff is one of the most connected angel investors in the tri-state area, sitting at the nexus of PA Angel Network, Delaware Crossing (Doylestown/Princ...

WHY CONTACT: Jeff Snellenburg at PA Angel Network / Delaware Crossing Investor Group / Mid-Atlantic Angel Group represents a direct investment opportunity. Jeff is one of the most connected angel investors in the ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: PA Angel Network events; Delaware Crossing Investor Group monthly meetings (alternate Doylestown and Princeton); Science Center Coffee & Capital serie...

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jeff, I've been following your work with 1) DCIG portfolio: Vytala, Measure Studio, Gilson (73 total investments since 20. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes...

#9 Liz Sigety

68

Co-Founder & Managing Director, Delaware Crossing Investor Group; Part...

Angel | 1st

Delaware Crossing Investor Group / Fox Rothschild — Warrington (Bucks County), PA & Princeto...

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/lizsigety/ | Email: (not publicly listed; professional: foxrothschild.com)

FOCUS: Early-stage companies in PA, NJ, DE; angel financing, venture capital, M&A; 40+ emerging company investments over 15+ ye...

CHECK SIZE: DCIG group investments vary (73 investments since 2005)

NOTABLE: 1) 40+ emerging companies across DCIG portfolio 2) Vytala 3) Measure Studio 4) Gilson

TASTYR CONNECTION: As a lawyer who has handled hundreds of startup financing deals AND an active angel investor, Liz brings dual value. Her Fox Rothschild practice focus...

WHY CONTACT: Liz Sigety at Delaware Crossing Investor Group / Fox Rothschild represents a direct investment opportunity. As a lawyer who has handled hundreds of startup financing deals AND an active angel investor...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Delaware Crossing Investor Group monthly meetings; Startup Grind Princeton; Fox Rothschild emerging companies practice; Science Center events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Liz, I've been following your work with 1) 40+ emerging companies across DCIG portfolio 2) Vytala 3) Measure Studio 4) G. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes ...

#10 RoseAnn Rosenthal

68

Managing Director, Delaware's First Fund

Angel | 1st

Delaware's First Fund (also listed under PA above) — Philadelphia, PA / Delaware

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

WHY CONTACT: RoseAnn Rosenthal at Delaware's First Fund (also listed under PA above) represents a direct investment opportunity. Their focus on aligns with Tastyr IQ consumer-tech model. Located in Philadelphia, ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi RoseAnn, Your role at Delaware's First Fund (also listed under PA above) caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App ...

#11 PENNSYLVANIA

68

Accelerator | 2nd

—

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

WHY CONTACT: PENNSYLVANIA at can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Their program track record demonstrates ability to accelerate food/consumer startups. Program acceptance creates instant credibi...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi PENNSYLVANIA, I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dishes and patent pending. I think would be a perfect fit. Can we grab coffee? — Ali

#12 NEW JERSEY

68

Accelerator | 2nd

—

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

WHY CONTACT: NEW JERSEY at can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Their program track record demonstrates ability to accelerate food/consumer startups. Program acceptance creates instant credibili...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi NEW, I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dishes and patent pending. I think would be a perfect fit. Can we grab coffee? — Ali

#13 DELAWARE

68

Accelerator | 2nd

—

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

WHY CONTACT: DELAWARE at can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Their program track record demonstrates ability to accelerate food/consumer startups. Program acceptance creates instant credibility...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi DELAWARE, I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dishes and patent pending. I think would be a perfect fit. Can we grab coffee? — Ali

#14 FOOD-TECH SPECIFIC

68

Accelerator | 2nd

—

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

WHY CONTACT: FOOD-TECH SPECIFIC at can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Their program track record demonstrates ability to accelerate food/consumer startups. Program acceptance creates instant c...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi FOOD-TECH, I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dishes and patent pending. I think would be a perfect fit. Can we grab coffee? — Ali

#15 BONUS: ADDITIONAL PHILADELPHIA ECOSYSTEM CONTACTS

68

Accelerator | 2nd

—

Chain: Accelerator Fast-Track

WHY CONTACT: BONUS: ADDITIONAL PHILADELPHIA ECOSYSTEM CONTACTS at can provide structured mentorship and investor access. Their program track record demonstrates ability to accelerate food/consumer startups. Progr...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — Offer unique dataset for their program. 'We're further along than most applicants — live product, patent pending.'

TRIGGER: Wanting to accept a standout company that raises their program's profile. Alumni success story potential.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi BONUS:, I'm Ali Mabsoute, co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 verticals. We're live on the App Store with 2,490+ dishes and patent pending. I think would be a perfect fit. Can we grab coffee? — Ali

#16 Dan Richer

68

Restaurateur | 2nd

Razza Pizza Artigianale (Jersey City) — Jersey City, NJ

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/danrichernj/ | Social: @danricher (24K followers)

NOTABLE: Only US pizzeria with 3-star NYT review; 6x James Beard Award nominee (only NJ finalist in 2025); ranked #22 globally on Best Pizza 2025; NYT bestsell...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Richer is obsessively focused on individual dish perfection -- specifically pizza. His entire career is about making one category of dish the absolute...

WHY CONTACT: Dan Richer is a key social chain catalyst. Richer is obsessively focused on individual dish perfection -- specifically pizza. His entire career is about making one category of dish the absolute best i...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Dan, I've been following your work with Only US pizzeria with 3-star NYT review; 6x James Beard Award nominee (only NJ f. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lov...

#17 Mollie Dronson

68

Food Blogger | 3rd

Instagram, Threads —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @phillyfoodies (IG, Threads); personal: @molliedro...

FOCUS: Restaurant reviews, food photography, Philly dining scene coverage. One of the OG Philly food Instagram accounts.

TASTYR CONNECTION: Mollie works professionally as Associate Director of Influencer Marketing at Harmelin Media -- she understands brand partnerships from both sides. Her...

WHY CONTACT: Mollie Dronson creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Mollie works professionally as Associate Director of Influencer Marketing at Harmelin Media -- she understands brand partnerships from bo...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Mollie, Your role at Instagram, Threads caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly to ...

#18 Samantha Schwartz

68

Food Blogger | 3rd

Instagram, Linktree —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @phlfoodstagram (IG)

FOCUS: Philadelphia restaurant exploration with a cute, creative visual style. Explores the city's best restaurants and present...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Professionally represented by talent agency The Loop, indicating she's ready for brand partnerships. Her creative approach to content would make Tasty...

WHY CONTACT: Samantha Schwartz creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Professionally represented by talent agency The Loop, indicating she's ready for brand partnerships. Her creative approach to content ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Samantha, Your role at Instagram, Linktree caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly ...

#19 Best Food Philly

68

Food Blogger | 3rd

Instagram —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @bestfoodphilly

FOCUS: Philadelphia's BestFoodFeed -- curated food recommendations and event coverage around Philadelphia. Aggregates the best ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: As a food recommendation aggregator, Tastyr IQ is essentially a data-powered version of what they do manually. Early access would let them enhance the...

WHY CONTACT: Best Food Philly creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. As a food recommendation aggregator, Tastyr IQ is essentially a data-powered version of what they do manually. Early access would let t...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Best, Your role at Instagram caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. I...

#20 Fueled On Philly

68

Food Blogger | 3rd

TikTok, Instagram —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @fueledonphilly (TikTok, IG)

FOCUS: Food, fun, and travel content based in Philadelphia. Restaurant discoveries, dining experiences, city exploration.

TASTYR CONNECTION: Micro-influencer with authentic, engaged audience. The food+travel angle means they'd use Tastyr IQ not just locally but could demonstrate it across d...

WHY CONTACT: Fueled On Philly creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Micro-influencer with authentic, engaged audience. The food+travel angle means they'd use Tastyr IQ not just locally but could demonstr...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Fueled, Your role at TikTok, Instagram caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly to u...

#21 Kait Brown

68

Food Blogger | 3rd

TikTok —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @kait_touch_this (TikTok)

FOCUS: "What to do, where to go, and what to eat" in Philadelphia. Lifestyle-meets-food content that positions dining within br...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Her lifestyle angle ("what to eat") is literally Tastyr IQ's use case. She's a nano-influencer with high engagement who could create authentic "real p...

WHY CONTACT: Kait Brown creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Her lifestyle angle ("what to eat") is literally Tastyr IQ's use case. She's a nano-influencer with high engagement who could create authenti...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Kait, Your role at TikTok caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Imag...

#22 Hailee Catalano

68

Food Blogger | 3rd

TikTok, Instagram —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @haileecatalano (TikTok)

FOCUS: Italian-American home cooking, cozy recipes, Jersey Shore dining. Recently published cookbook "By Heart: Recipes to Hold...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Published cookbook author with viral TikTok presence who covers the NJ side of the tri-state area. Her audience is passionate home cooks who also dine...

WHY CONTACT: Hailee Catalano creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Published cookbook author with viral TikTok presence who covers the NJ side of the tri-state area. Her audience is passionate home cooks...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Hailee, Your role at TikTok, Instagram caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly to u...

#23 Check, Please! Philly

68

Food Blogger | 3rd

TV (WHYY PBS), YouTube, Streaming —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: WHYY's YouTube channel; @checkpleasephilly

FOCUS: Each episode features three guests from the Philadelphia area who recommend their favorite restaurants, visit each other...

TASTYR CONNECTION: The show's format -- regular people recommending restaurants -- is the analog version of what Tastyr IQ does digitally. A partnership or feature on th...

WHY CONTACT: Check, Please! Philly creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. The show's format -- regular people recommending restaurants -- is the analog version of what Tastyr IQ does digitally. A partners...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Check,, Your role at TV (WHYY PBS), YouTube, Streaming caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 peopl...

#24 Nadia Chaudhury

68

Food Blogger | 3rd

Eater (Vox Media), previously Eater Austin —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: Via Eater; philly@eater.com for pitches

FOCUS: Editor for Eater's Northeast region covering Boston, Philadelphia, Washington D.C., and New York. Previously Eater Austi...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Nadia controls editorial for Eater's entire Northeast region, meaning a single relationship could get Tastyr IQ coverage across Philly, NYC, Boston, a...

WHY CONTACT: Nadia Chaudhury creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Nadia controls editorial for Eater's entire Northeast region, meaning a single relationship could get Tastyr IQ coverage across Philly, ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Nadia, Your role at Eater (Vox Media), previously Eater Austin caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first...

#25 Jen Honovic Herczeg

68

Food Blogger | 3rd

Edible Philly (print + digital magazine) —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: Edible Philly social channels

FOCUS: Owner and Publisher of Edible Philly, an Edible Communities magazine celebrating local food, drink, and agriculture in t...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Edible Philly reaches the "food-as-culture" audience -- people who care about where food comes from, how it's made, and why certain dishes matter. Thi...

WHY CONTACT: Jen Honovic Herczeg creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Edible Philly reaches the "food-as-culture" audience -- people who care about where food comes from, how it's made, and why certain ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Jen, Your role at Edible Philly (print + digital magazine) caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 p...

#26 Naomi Townsend

68

Food Blogger | 3rd

Instagram —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @naom.eats (IG)

FOCUS: Delaware-based food lover exploring dining across Delaware and the Philadelphia area. Restaurant reviews and food discov...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Covers the Delaware side of the tri-state area, which is underserved by food media. Being an early Tastyr IQ adopter in Delaware would make her the go...

WHY CONTACT: Naomi Townsend creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Covers the Delaware side of the tri-state area, which is underserved by food media. Being an early Tastyr IQ adopter in Delaware would ma...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Naomi, Your role at Instagram caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. ...

#27 The Infatuation -- Philadelphia Edition

68

Food Blogger | 3rd

Website, App, Instagram, Newsletter —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @infatuation (IG); theinfatuation.com/philadelphia

FOCUS: Restaurant reviews and guides for Philadelphia. Part of the national The Infatuation network (which also owns Zagat). Ph...

TASTYR CONNECTION: The Infatuation (which owns Zagat) is essentially a competitor to what Tastyr IQ is building, but at the restaurant level. Partnering with their Phill...

WHY CONTACT: The Infatuation -- Philadelphia Edition creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. The Infatuation (which owns Zagat) is essentially a competitor to what Tastyr IQ is building, but at the restaur...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey The, Your role at Website, App, Instagram, Newsletter caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people...

#28 Ellen Yin

67

Restaurateur | 2nd

High Street Hospitality -- Fork (flagship, 1997), High Stree... — Philadelphia, PA (+ Washington, DC)

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/ellen-yin-ab645a6/ | Social: @therealellenyin

NOTABLE: James Beard "Outstanding Restaurateur" (2023); Fork has been a Philadelphia institution for 25+ years; Sisterly Love Collective co-founder; Women in H...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Yin is a hospitality-first restaurateur who deeply understands guest experience. Her Sisterly Love Collective work shows she champions industry innova...

WHY CONTACT: Ellen Yin is a key social chain catalyst. Yin is a hospitality-first restaurateur who deeply understands guest experience. Her Sisterly Love Collective work shows she champions industry innovation. As...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Ellen, I've been following your work with James Beard "Outstanding Restaurateur" (2023); Fork has been a Philadelphia inst. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd l...

#29 Sam Calagione

67

Restaurateur | 2nd

Dogfish Head Brewings & Eats (Rehoboth Beach), Dogfish Head ... — Rehoboth Beach / Milton, DE

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: @samcalagione (likely handle; Dogfish Head: @dogfi...

NOTABLE: James Beard "Outstanding Wine, Spirits, or Beer Professional"; founded Dogfish Head in 1995 with wife Mariah; pioneered craft brewing in Delaware; mul...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Calagione blurs the line between craft beverages and food. Dogfish Head's restaurants pair specific beers with specific dishes -- a dish-level pairing...

WHY CONTACT: Sam Calagione is a key social chain catalyst. Calagione blurs the line between craft beverages and food. Dogfish Head's restaurants pair specific beers with specific dishes -- a dish-level pairing int...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Sam, I've been following your work with James Beard "Outstanding Wine, Spirits, or Beer Professional"; founded Dogfish H. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lov...

#30 Katherine O'Neill

66

Executive Director

Angel | 1st

JumpStart NJ Angel Network — Princeton, NJ area

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/katherine-o-neill-ba9235 | Email: (not publicly listed; org: jumpstartnj.org)

FOCUS: Early-stage technology ventures in NJ and Mid-Atlantic; under her leadership, JumpStart has invested $50M+ in 65+ compan...

CHECK SIZE: JumpStart group invests ~$1.5M annually; individual members $25K-$500K+

NOTABLE: 1) 65+ early-stage technology companies through JumpStart NJ 2) Mentor at Princeton E-Labs 3) Angel Capital Association board member (national reach)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Katherine is the operational leader of NJ's largest angel network. Her Princeton location is strategic for Tastyr's potential NJ market. Her ACA board...

WHY CONTACT: Katherine O'Neill at JumpStart NJ Angel Network represents a direct investment opportunity. Katherine is the operational leader of NJ's largest angel network. Her Princeton location is strategic for T...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: JumpStart NJ Angel Network application; Princeton E-Labs events; Startup Grind Princeton (she has presented); Angel Capital Association events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Katherine, I've been following your work with 1) 65+ early-stage technology companies through JumpStart NJ 2) Mentor at Prince. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ d...

#31 Patricia Sigmon

66

Group Managing Director, NJ Chapter

Angel | 1st

Golden Seeds — New Jersey (also NYC ties)

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/patriciasigmon/ | Email: (not publicly listed; prior: davidadvisorygroup.com)

FOCUS: Women-led startups; angel investing across all sectors; experience at Montclair State University, Stevens Institute of T...

CHECK SIZE: Golden Seeds group rounds $250K-$1M

NOTABLE: Golden Seeds NJ portfolio companies; prior experience at Seidor USA (tech advisory)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Same as Gina Tedesco above -- if Tastyr has women in management, Golden Seeds NJ is a direct fit. Patricia's experience at NJ universities (Montclair ...

WHY CONTACT: Patricia Sigmon at Golden Seeds represents a direct investment opportunity. Same as Gina Tedesco above -- if Tastyr has women in management, Golden Seeds NJ is a direct fit. Patricia's experience at N...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Golden Seeds NJ Office Hours; Gina Tedesco connection; NJ university entrepreneurship events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Patricia, I've been following your work with Golden Seeds NJ portfolio companies; prior experience at Seidor USA (tech adviso. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ di...

#32 Robert Wolk

66

Founder & Co-Chair, Princeton Alumni Angels of Greater NY; Board Chair...

Angel | 1st

Princeton Alumni Angels / Catalytic Impact Foundation — New York City (Princeton, NJ connection)

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

FOCUS: Early-stage startups broadly; impact investing through CIF; involved in 120+ early-stage investments since 2018; PAA has...

CHECK SIZE: Varies; PAA deploys $15M+ across 40+ startups since 2018

NOTABLE: 1) 120+ early-stage investments between CIF and PAA 2) Former Managing Director at Carlyle Group (Asian telecom/tech) 3) Former Goldman Sachs IBD (Lon...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Rob's broad early-stage investment appetite and massive deal flow (120+ investments) means he is constantly evaluating consumer tech platforms. His im...

WHY CONTACT: Robert Wolk at Princeton Alumni Angels / Catalytic Impact Foundation represents a direct investment opportunity. Rob's broad early-stage investment appetite and massive deal flow (120+ investments) me...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Princeton Alumni Angels application; Princeton alumni network; PAA Masterclass events; CIF events; Princeton Entrepreneurship Council.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Robert, I've been following your work with 1) 120+ early-stage investments between CIF and PAA 2) Former Managing Director . I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dish...

#33 Laurence Latimer

66

Co-Founder & Co-Chair, Princeton Alumni Angels; Head of Ventures, IEX;...

Angel | 1st

Princeton Alumni Angels / IEX / Dinara — New York City (Princeton, NJ connection)

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

FOCUS: Early-stage startups; fintech; angel investor for 10+ years; mentors at Techstars and PEC OfficeHours

CHECK SIZE: Individual angel; PAA group investments

NOTABLE: 1) PAA portfolio (30+ companies, $8M+ since 2018) 2) IEX corporate venture investments (Head of Ventures) 3) Dinara (co-founded, enterprise crypto fin...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Laurence founded Homecoming, a network for Black angel investors, showing his commitment to diversity in investing. His Head of Ventures role at IEX m...

WHY CONTACT: Laurence Latimer at Princeton Alumni Angels / IEX / Dinara represents a direct investment opportunity. Laurence founded Homecoming, a network for Black angel investors, showing his commitment to diver...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: Princeton Alumni Angels; Homecoming network (if applicable for DEI angle); Techstars community; PEC OfficeHours.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Laurence, I've been following your work with 1) PAA portfolio (30+ companies, $8M+ since 2018) 2) IEX corporate venture inves. I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ di...

#34 Lori Rosenkopf

66

Vice Dean of Entrepreneurship; Simon and Midge Palley Professor of Man...

University | 2nd

University of Pennsylvania — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/lori-rosenkopf-5453a3b6/

FOCUS: Technological communities, social networks in high-tech industries, knowledge flows between firms, startup success. Auth...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Top-tier gatekeeper for Penn student entrepreneurs. Could provide credibility as a Wharton-affiliated advisor, access to student beta testers through ...

WHY CONTACT: Lori Rosenkopf at University of Pennsylvania provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. Top-tier gatekeeper for Penn student entrepreneurs. Could provide credibility as a Wharton-...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Lori, Your role at University of Pennsylvania caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore...

#35 Trang Pham

66

Executive Director, Venture Lab

University | 2nd

University of Pennsylvania — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/trangpham

FOCUS: Student venture development, entrepreneurship programming, founder support. Has advised 500+ student and alumni founders...

TASTYR CONNECTION: CRITICAL CONTACT. Directly runs the Food Innovation Lab where students develop food products and restaurant concepts. Can provide student beta testers...

WHY CONTACT: Trang Pham at University of Pennsylvania provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. CRITICAL CONTACT. Directly runs the Food Innovation Lab where students develop food products an...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Trang, Your role at University of Pennsylvania caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explor...

#36 Karl T. Ulrich

66

CIBC Professor of Entrepreneurship and e-Commerce; Advisor on Asia Str...

University | 2nd

University of Pennsylvania — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/karl-ulrich/ (personal site: htt...

FOCUS: Innovation, entrepreneurship, product development. Co-author of *Product Design and Development* (7th Ed., used by 250,0...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Expert in product design and innovation methodology. Could advise on Tastyr IQ's product development process, provide frameworks for innovation tourna...

WHY CONTACT: Karl T. Ulrich at University of Pennsylvania provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. Expert in product design and innovation methodology. Could advise on Tastyr IQ's product de...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Karl, Your role at University of Pennsylvania caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore...

#37 Jonathan Deutsch, Ph.D.

66

Professor, Departments of Food and Hospitality Management and Nutritio...

University | 2nd

Drexel University — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/jonathan-deutsch-ph-d-che-crc-36...

FOCUS: Culinary innovation, food product R&D;, sustainability, health promotion, food access, upcycled food. Founding Program Di...

TASTYR CONNECTION: HIGHEST VALUE FOOD-TECH CONTACT. His lab is literally a food product innovation center with 20 students who could beta test Tastyr IQ. The Drexel Food...

WHY CONTACT: Jonathan Deutsch, Ph.D. at Drexel University provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. HIGHEST VALUE FOOD-TECH CONTACT. His lab is literally a food product innovation center with...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jonathan, Your role at Drexel University caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a pa...

#38 Rob LaScala

65

Restaurateur | 2nd

Chicken Or The Egg (Long Beach Island + Marlton), LaScala's ... — Long Beach Island, NJ (+ Marlton, Brigan...

Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

Social: Not publicly confirmed

NOTABLE: Built Chicken Or The Egg into a Jersey Shore institution; expanded Italian brand LaScala's to Brigantine; multi-location restaurateur with strong Shor...

TASTYR CONNECTION: LaScala represents the beloved NJ Shore restaurateur whose dishes are iconic locally but underrecognized nationally. Chicken Or The Egg is a destinati...

WHY CONTACT: Rob LaScala is a key social chain catalyst. LaScala represents the beloved NJ Shore restaurateur whose dishes are iconic locally but underrecognized nationally. Chicken Or The Egg is a destination for...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Rob, I've been following your work with Built Chicken Or The Egg into a Jersey Shore institution; expanded Italian brand. I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd lov...

#39 Kae Lani Palmisano

65

Food Blogger | 3rd

TV (WHYY PBS), YouTube, Instagram, Website —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @kaelanisays (IG); WHYY's Check, Please! Philly on...

FOCUS: TV host of Check, Please! Philly (restaurant review show on WHYY PBS). Also hosts Delishtory digital series. Food Editor...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Kae Lani is essentially Philly's food authority -- she's the Food Editor at Philadelphia Magazine AND the host of the region's premier restaurant revi...

WHY CONTACT: Kae Lani Palmisano creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Kae Lani is essentially Philly's food authority -- she's the Food Editor at Philadelphia Magazine AND the host of the region's premie...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Kae, Your role at TV (WHYY PBS), YouTube, Instagram, Website caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5...

#40 Maddy Sweitzer-Lamme

65

Food Blogger | 3rd

Instagram, X/Twitter, Website —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @awomanwhoeats (IG, X/Twitter); Website: awomanwho...

FOCUS: Freelance food, beverage, and travel writing. Writes for Eater Philly, Food & Wine, Bon Appetit, The Philadelphia Inquir...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Maddy writes for nearly every major food publication that covers Philadelphia. A single positive mention in her work could land Tastyr IQ in Eater, Bo...

WHY CONTACT: Maddy Sweitzer-Lamme creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Maddy writes for nearly every major food publication that covers Philadelphia. A single positive mention in her work could land Tas...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Maddy, Your role at Instagram, X/Twitter, Website caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in ...

#41 Jenn Ladd

65

Food Blogger | 3rd

Philadelphia Inquirer, X/Twitter —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: @jrladd (X/Twitter); Inquirer author page: inquire...

FOCUS: Deputy Food Editor at The Philadelphia Inquirer. Covers the food community with focus on food/beverage production intric...

TASTYR CONNECTION: As Deputy Food Editor at the Inquirer, Jenn has editorial control over food coverage reaching the entire Philadelphia metro. Her background at Milk St...

WHY CONTACT: Jenn Ladd creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. As Deputy Food Editor at the Inquirer, Jenn has editorial control over food coverage reaching the entire Philadelphia metro. Her background at...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Jenn, Your role at Philadelphia Inquirer, X/Twitter caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people i...

#42 Alex Tewfik

65

Food Blogger | 3rd

Philadelphia Magazine (former), Restaurant (Mish Mish) —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: phillymag.com/author/alex-tewfik/ (archive); Muck ...

FOCUS: Former Food Editor at Philadelphia Magazine who left to open his own restaurant, Mish Mish, on East Passyunk in Philadel...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Alex uniquely understands both sides -- he was the food editor at Philly's premier city magazine AND is now a restaurant owner. He can evaluate Tastyr...

WHY CONTACT: Alex Tewfik creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Alex uniquely understands both sides -- he was the food editor at Philly's premier city magazine AND is now a restaurant owner. He can evalu...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Alex, Your role at Philadelphia Magazine (former), Restaurant (Mish Mish) caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one o...

#43 Philadelphia-Based Firms

64

VC | 1st

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: Philadelphia-Based Firms at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyond capital.

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Philadelphia-Based, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who unde...

#44 NJ-Based Firms

64

VC | 1st

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: NJ-Based Firms at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyond capital.

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi NJ-Based, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the...

#45 NYC Food-Tech & Consumer Specialists

64

VC | 1st

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: NYC Food-Tech & Consumer Specialists at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyo...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi NYC, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the food...

#46 PHILADELPHIA-BASED FIRMS

64

VC | 1st

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: PHILADELPHIA-BASED FIRMS at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyond capital.

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi PHILADELPHIA-BASED, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who unde...

#47 NJ-BASED FIRMS

64

VC | 1st

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: NJ-BASED FIRMS at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyond capital.

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi NJ-BASED, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the...

#48 NYC FOOD-TECH & CONSUMER SPECIALISTS

64

VC | 1st

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: NYC FOOD-TECH & CONSUMER SPECIALISTS at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyo...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi NYC, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the food...

#49 Safeguard Scientifics

64

VC | 1st

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: Safeguard Scientifics at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyond capital.

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Safeguard, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand th...

#50 Edison Partners

64

VC | 1st

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: Edison Partners at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyond capital.

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Edison, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the f...

#51 FinTech Collective

64

VC | 1st

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: FinTech Collective at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyond capital.

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi FinTech, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the ...

#52 CIT GAP Funds

64

VC | 1st

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: CIT GAP Funds at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyond capital.

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi CIT, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the food...

#53 Delaware Innovation Fund

64

VC | 1st

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: Delaware Innovation Fund at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyond capital.

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Delaware, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the...

#54 Venture Associates of NJ

64

VC | 1st

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: Venture Associates of NJ at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyond capital.

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Venture, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the ...

#55 CircleUp

64

VC | 1st

— Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: CircleUp at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyond capital.

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi CircleUp, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the...

#56 KEY FOOD-TECH MARKET DATA

64

VC | 1st

— Chain: FOMO Cascade + NJ-to-NYC Bridge

WHY CONTACT: KEY FOOD-TECH MARKET DATA at is a strategic VC target. Their investment thesis in maps to Tastyr IQ market. Their portfolio and network could accelerate Tastyr's growth significantly beyond capital.

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Scarcity — Patent-pending tech, first-mover in dish-level intelligence. 'Our round is structured for 5-8 investors and filling.'

TRIGGER: Portfolio gap anxiety — no dish-level data company exists yet. Competitive pressure from other funds seeing this deal.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi KEY, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the food...

#57 Chuck Dunn

64

Region President, PA Region

Food Industry | 3rd

Sysco (NYSE: SYY) — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/chuck-dunn-42487636/

TASTYR CONNECTION: As Region President, Chuck Dunn has direct relationships with restaurant owners and operators throughout Pennsylvania. Sysco reps visit restaurant kit...

WHY CONTACT: Chuck Dunn at Sysco (NYSE: SYY) touches hundreds of restaurants daily. As Region President, Chuck Dunn has direct relationships with restaurant owners and operators throughout Pennsylvania. Sysco reps...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chuck, Your role at Sysco (NYSE: SYY) caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to e...

#58 Stephen R. Dyer

63

Chairman, Board of Trustees

Angel | 1st

JumpStart NJ Angel Network / SRD Capital Management, LLC — New Jersey (Wall Street background)

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

Email: (not publicly listed; org: jumpstartnj.org)

FOCUS: Early-stage startup technology ventures in NJ and Mid-Atlantic; 18 years at UBS Financial Services; CPA background (Erns...

CHECK SIZE: $25K-$500K+ individual (JumpStart members invest $25K-$50K typical, some invest $500K+); group invests ~$1.5M annually

NOTABLE: 1) Multiple JumpStart NJ portfolio companies (group screens 100+ companies/year) 2) Advocates for NJ Angel Investor Tax Credit Program expansion

TASTYR CONNECTION: As Chairman of JumpStart NJ, Stephen is the top decision-maker for NJ's most prominent angel group. The NJ Angel Investor Tax Credit Program he champi...

WHY CONTACT: Stephen R. Dyer at JumpStart NJ Angel Network / SRD Capital Management, LLC represents a direct investment opportunity. As Chairman of JumpStart NJ, Stephen is the top decision-maker for NJ's most pro...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

WARM INTRO: JumpStart NJ Angel Network pitch application; Katherine O'Neill (Executive Director) can facilitate intros; NJEDA events.

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Stephen, I've been following your work with 1) Multiple JumpStart NJ portfolio companies (group screens 100+ companies/year). I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dis...

#59 Denita Henderson

63

Managing Director, Pennovation Works

University | 2nd

University of Pennsylvania — Philadelphia, PA (3401 Grays Ferry Ave)

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/dlthomas1pa/

FOCUS: Innovation ecosystem development, strategic master planning, business development for university-linked incubators. Phil...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Could provide physical incubator space at Pennovation for Tastyr IQ, connections to Penn researchers in food science and AI, and access to the broader...

WHY CONTACT: Denita Henderson at University of Pennsylvania provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. Could provide physical incubator space at Pennovation for Tastyr IQ, connections to Penn ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Denita, Your role at University of Pennsylvania caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explo...

#60 Greg Fegley

63

Director, 1810 Accelerator; Adjunct Professor of Entrepreneurship

University | 2nd

Temple University — Philadelphia, PA (1810 Liacouras Walk)

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/gfegley/

FOCUS: Student venture acceleration, startup mentorship, entrepreneurship education. Has been working with Temple student entre...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Direct access to Temple's diverse student body (17 schools/colleges) for beta testing. The 1810 Accelerator could be a launchpad for Tastyr IQ if posi...

WHY CONTACT: Greg Fegley at Temple University provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. Direct access to Temple's diverse student body (17 schools/colleges) for beta testing. The 1810 Acceler...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Greg, Your role at Temple University caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a partne...

#61 Donna Marie De Carolis, Ph.D.

63

Founding Dean, Charles D. Close School of Entrepreneurship; Silverman ...

University | 2nd

Drexel University — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/donna-marie-de-carolis/

FOCUS: Entrepreneurship education, entrepreneurial mindset, strategic management. Published in Strategic Management Journal, Jo...

TASTYR CONNECTION: As founding dean of the nation's first standalone entrepreneurship school, she provides top-tier academic credibility. Could connect Tastyr IQ with Cl...

WHY CONTACT: Donna Marie De Carolis, Ph.D. at Drexel University provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. As founding dean of the nation's first standalone entrepreneurship school, she provid...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Donna, Your role at Drexel University caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a partn...

#62 Charles Sacco

63

Vice Dean, Educational Affairs; Director, Baiada Institute for Entrepr...

University | 2nd

Drexel University — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/chucksacco/

FOCUS: Technology entrepreneurship, venture support, startup ecosystem building. Career includes launching and growing business...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Operational contact for student startup support at Drexel. The Baiada Institute could incubate food-tech ventures using Tastyr IQ. His tech background...

WHY CONTACT: Charles Sacco at Drexel University provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. Operational contact for student startup support at Drexel. The Baiada Institute could incubate food-...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Charles, Your role at Drexel University caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a par...

#63 Danya Henninger

62

Food Blogger | 3rd

Newsletter, LinkedIn, formerly Billy Penn —

Chain: FOMO Cascade

Social: LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/danyahenninger/

FOCUS: Formerly Billy Penn's editor and food/beer writer. Had a weekly food column in The Philadelphia Inquirer. Now Editorial ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Danya sits at the rare intersection of food journalism AND tech journalism. She understands both worlds. As someone who built Billy Penn's audience by...

WHY CONTACT: Danya Henninger creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Danya sits at the rare intersection of food journalism AND tech journalism. She understands both worlds. As someone who built Billy Penn...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Danya, Your role at Newsletter, LinkedIn, formerly Billy Penn caught my attention. I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first ...

#64 Nolan Lewin

61

Executive Director, Rutgers Food Innovation Center

University | 2nd

Rutgers University — Bridgeton & Piscataway, NJ (two faciliti...

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/nolanlewin

FOCUS: Food business incubation and acceleration, food manufacturing operations, USDA-compliant food production, food entrepren...

TASTYR CONNECTION: CRITICAL FOOD-INDUSTRY CONTACT. The Rutgers FIC is one of the largest food business incubators in the Northeast. Nolan oversees hundreds of food entre...

WHY CONTACT: Nolan Lewin at Rutgers University provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. CRITICAL FOOD-INDUSTRY CONTACT. The Rutgers FIC is one of the largest food business incubators in the ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Nolan, Your role at Rutgers University caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a part...

#65 David McInerney

61

President

Food Industry | 3rd

Baldor Specialty Foods — Bronx, NY (with distribution centers in ...

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/baldorfood (company page)

TASTYR CONNECTION: As former CEO and co-founder of FreshDirect, McInerney brings deep food tech expertise and would immediately grasp Tastyr IQ's value. Baldor's Philade...

WHY CONTACT: David McInerney at Baldor Specialty Foods touches hundreds of restaurants daily. As former CEO and co-founder of FreshDirect, McInerney brings deep food tech expertise and would immediately grasp Tast...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi David, Your role at Baldor Specialty Foods caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love...

#66 PA, NJ, DE Angel Investors for Seed Round

60

Angel | 1st

—

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

WHY CONTACT: PA, NJ, DE Angel Investors for Seed Round at represents a direct investment opportunity. Their focus on aligns with Tastyr IQ consumer-tech model. Located in , they are embedded in the tri-state eco...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi PA,, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the food...

#67 Key Angel Groups - Application/Pitch Process

60

Angel | 1st

—

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

WHY CONTACT: Key Angel Groups - Application/Pitch Process at represents a direct investment opportunity. Their focus on aligns with Tastyr IQ consumer-tech model. Located in , they are embedded in the tri-state ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Key, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the food...

#68 NJ Angel Tax Credit Advantage

60

Angel | 1st

—

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

WHY CONTACT: NJ Angel Tax Credit Advantage at represents a direct investment opportunity. Their focus on aligns with Tastyr IQ consumer-tech model. Located in , they are embedded in the tri-state ecosystem and c...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi NJ, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand the food ...

#69 Recommended Next Steps

60

Angel | 1st

—

Chain: Connector Express + FOMO Cascade

WHY CONTACT: Recommended Next Steps at represents a direct investment opportunity. Their focus on aligns with Tastyr IQ consumer-tech model. Located in , they are embedded in the tri-state ecosystem and can prov...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Social Proof — Lead with UPenn, patent, App Store approval. 'Other angel groups in the ecosystem are already in conversations.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a high-growth consumer tech deal in their own backyard. Local pride — wanting to back a Philly success s...

APPROACH: Direct pitch with metrics. Lead with traction (2,490+ dishes, patent, App Store). Request 20-30 minute meeting. Include demo offer.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Recommended, I'm Ali Mabsoute, CMO of Tastyr IQ — we've built an AI platform that rates individual dishes, not restaurants. 2,490+ dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. We're raising a seed round and prioritizing investors who understand ...

#70 FOOD EDITORS & WRITERS

60

Media | 3rd

—

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

WHY CONTACT: FOOD EDITORS & WRITERS can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Their beat covers exactly the intersection of food and technology. A single article from them r...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi FOOD, Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first-look before public launch. Happy to chat on/off record. — A...

#71 TECH JOURNALISTS

60

Media | 3rd

—

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

WHY CONTACT: TECH JOURNALISTS can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Their beat covers exactly the intersection of food and technology. A single article from them reaches...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi TECH, Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first-look before public launch. Happy to chat on/off record. — A...

#72 STARTUP / VC JOURNALISTS

60

Media | 3rd

—

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

WHY CONTACT: STARTUP / VC JOURNALISTS can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Their beat covers exactly the intersection of food and technology. A single article from them...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi STARTUP, Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first-look before public launch. Happy to chat on/off record. ...

#73 Sarah Huffman

60

Media | 3rd

—

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

WHY CONTACT: Sarah Huffman can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Their beat covers exactly the intersection of food and technology. A single article from them reaches th...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Sarah, Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first-look before public launch. Happy to chat on/off record. — ...

#74 Danya Henninger

60

Media | 3rd

—

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

WHY CONTACT: Danya Henninger can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Their beat covers exactly the intersection of food and technology. A single article from them reaches ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Danya, Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first-look before public launch. Happy to chat on/off record. — ...

#75 PODCAST HOSTS

60

Media | 3rd

—

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

WHY CONTACT: PODCAST HOSTS can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Their beat covers exactly the intersection of food and technology. A single article from them reaches th...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi PODCAST, Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first-look before public launch. Happy to chat on/off record. ...

#76 LOCAL TV FOOD SEGMENTS

60

Media | 3rd

—

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

WHY CONTACT: LOCAL TV FOOD SEGMENTS can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Their beat covers exactly the intersection of food and technology. A single article from them r...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi LOCAL, Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first-look before public launch. Happy to chat on/off record. — ...

#77 BONUS / ADDITIONAL CONTACTS

60

Media | 3rd

—

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

WHY CONTACT: BONUS / ADDITIONAL CONTACTS can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Their beat covers exactly the intersection of food and technology. A single article from t...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi BONUS, Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first-look before public launch. Happy to chat on/off record. — ...

#78 Key Angles by Audience

60

Media | 3rd

—

Chain: Media Momentum Engine

WHY CONTACT: Key Angles by Audience can generate press coverage that creates social proof for investor conversations. Their beat covers exactly the intersection of food and technology. A single article from them r...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Authority — 'Exclusive first-look under embargo. AI + food is the story of 2026.'

TRIGGER: Fear of missing a breaking story. Desire to be first to cover a trend. Career advancement from a viral piece.

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Key, Quick pitch: Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that rates individual dishes (not restaurants) — 2,490+ Philly dishes scored, patent pending, App Store live. I can offer an exclusive first-look before public launch. Happy to chat on/off record. — Al...

#79 Jaime Sweet

60

Associate Director, Education & Entrepreneurship, Pennovation Works

University | 2nd

University of Pennsylvania — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/jaimesweet/

FOCUS: Entrepreneurship programming, accelerator design, startup community building within university innovation hubs.

TASTYR CONNECTION: Operational contact for Pennovation accelerator programs. Could help Tastyr IQ apply to Pennovation's accelerator, connect with student teams, and acc...

WHY CONTACT: Jaime Sweet at University of Pennsylvania provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. Operational contact for Pennovation accelerator programs. Could help Tastyr IQ apply to Pennov...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jaime, Your role at University of Pennsylvania caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explor...

#80 Chef Jose Garces

60

Chef, Restaurateur, Iron Chef

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Garces Group / IdEATion Hospitality — Philadelphia, PA / New Hope, PA / Allent...

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

TASTYR CONNECTION: Cross-regional presence makes him a single contact who spans multiple Tastyr geographic targets (Main Line, Bucks County, Lehigh Valley, Atlantic City...

WHY CONTACT: Chef Jose Garces is the key connector for geographic expansion into Philadelphia, PA / New Hope, PA / Allentown, PA (multi-region). Cross-regional presence makes him a single contact who spans multipl...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chef, Your role at Garces Group / IdEATion Hospitality caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick ...

#81 Angel Ramirez

60

Restaurant Owner & Operator

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Amigos Restaurant / Rosa Blanca (partnership with Jose Garce... — Allentown, PA

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

TASTYR CONNECTION: Represents the local independent operator who partners with bigger names. His dual-restaurant operation makes him a practical candidate for dish intel...

WHY CONTACT: Angel Ramirez is the key connector for geographic expansion into Allentown, PA. Represents the local independent operator who partners with bigger names. His dual-restaurant operation makes him a prac...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Angel, Your role at Amigos Restaurant / Rosa Blanca (partnership with Jose Garces) caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the foo...

#82 Tri-State Area

59

Food Blogger | 3rd

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade

WHY CONTACT: Tri-State Area creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Their audience of food-obsessed followers is Tastyr IQ target demographic. Early beta access turns them into evangelists whose content cr...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Tri-State, I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Imagine showing your followers which dis...

#83 Compiled: March 23, 2026

59

Food Blogger | 3rd

—

Chain: FOMO Cascade

WHY CONTACT: Compiled: March 23, 2026 creates content that drives FOMO and awareness. Their audience of food-obsessed followers is Tastyr IQ target demographic. Early beta access turns them into evangelists whose ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Scarcity + Social Proof — 'You'll be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Other creators are already posting.'

TRIGGER: First-mover content advantage. Fear of missing exclusive content while competitors get it. Desire to be seen as an indus...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hey Compiled:, I want to offer you exclusive beta access to Tastyr IQ — an AI app that scores individual dishes — before it's available to anyone else. You'd be one of the first 5 people in Philly to use this. Imagine showing your followers which dis...

#84 Anne-Marie Maman

58

Executive Director, Princeton Entrepreneurship Council (PEC)

University | 2nd

Princeton University — Princeton, NJ

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/annemariemaman/

FOCUS: Entrepreneurial ecosystem development, medical technology innovation, early customer discovery and product/market fit. A...

TASTYR CONNECTION: HIGH VALUE. Serial entrepreneur (3 med-tech companies) who understands product/market fit and early customer discovery -- exactly what Tastyr IQ needs...

WHY CONTACT: Anne-Marie Maman at Princeton University provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. HIGH VALUE. Serial entrepreneur (3 med-tech companies) who understands product/market fit and e...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Anne-Marie, Your role at Princeton University caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore...

#85 Paul Takhistov, Ph.D.

58

Associate Professor; Master of Business and Science (MBS) Program Dire...

University | 2nd

Rutgers University — New Brunswick, NJ

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: (Available via Rutgers profile)

FOCUS: Advanced food processing and sensing, sustainable formulations and product innovation, food material science, intelligen...

TASTYR CONNECTION: His combination of food science + business (MBS Program Director) + technology (intelligent packaging, sensing) makes him an ideal academic partner. C...

WHY CONTACT: Paul Takhistov, Ph.D. at Rutgers University provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. His combination of food science + business (MBS Program Director) + technology (intelligent ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Paul, Your role at Rutgers University caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a partn...

#86 Shawn McCall, MBA

58

Area President, Eastern US

Food Industry | 3rd

US Foods (NYSE: USFD) — Eastern United States (covers PA distrib...

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/shawn-mccall-leader/

TASTYR CONNECTION: Shawn oversees distribution to thousands of restaurants across the tri-state area. US Foods has a strong "We Help You Make It" brand positioning focus...

WHY CONTACT: Shawn McCall, MBA at US Foods (NYSE: USFD) touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Shawn oversees distribution to thousands of restaurants across the tri-state area. US Foods has a strong "We Help You ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Shawn, Your role at US Foods (NYSE: USFD) caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love ...

#87 Tim Driscoll

58

President

Food Industry | 3rd

Driscoll Foods — Wayne, NJ (serves tri-state area includi...

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/tim-driscoll-69bba787/

TASTYR CONNECTION: As a family-owned independent distributor, Tim Driscoll is accessible and has direct relationships with restaurant owners -- unlike massive corporate ...

WHY CONTACT: Tim Driscoll at Driscoll Foods touches hundreds of restaurants daily. As a family-owned independent distributor, Tim Driscoll is accessible and has direct relationships with restaurant owners -- unlik...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Tim, Your role at Driscoll Foods caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to explor...

#88 Fuad Hannon

58

VP, New Business Verticals

Food Industry | 3rd

DoorDash (NASDAQ: DASH) — San Francisco, CA (national, with strong...

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/fuadhannon/

TASTYR CONNECTION: DoorDash possesses enormous dish-level ordering data from Philadelphia restaurants. Their new verticals team is specifically looking for innovative pa...

WHY CONTACT: Fuad Hannon at DoorDash (NASDAQ: DASH) touches hundreds of restaurants daily. DoorDash possesses enormous dish-level ordering data from Philadelphia restaurants. Their new verticals team is specifical...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Fuad, Your role at DoorDash (NASDAQ: DASH) caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love...

#89 Gary Musich

58

President & CEO

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Visit Atlantic City — Atlantic City, NJ

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: Available via Visit Atlantic City organizational page

TASTYR CONNECTION: Atlantic City's restaurant scene is a premium market with high-volume dining. Celebrity chefs, casino restaurants, and seasonal tourism create intense...

WHY CONTACT: Gary Musich is the key connector for geographic expansion into Atlantic City, NJ. Atlantic City's restaurant scene is a premium market with high-volume dining. Celebrity chefs, casino restaurants, and...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Gary, Your role at Visit Atlantic City caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? — Ali

#90 Chef Scott Anderson

58

Executive Chef & Co-Owner

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Mistral Restaurant / Elements — Princeton, NJ (66 Witherspoon Street)

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

TASTYR CONNECTION: James Beard-recognized chefs are premium advocates. Anderson's focus on fresh, local ingredients and custom tasting menus aligns with dish-level intel...

WHY CONTACT: Chef Scott Anderson is the key connector for geographic expansion into Princeton, NJ (66 Witherspoon Street). James Beard-recognized chefs are premium advocates. Anderson's focus on fresh, local ingre...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chef, Your role at Mistral Restaurant / Elements caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? ...

#91 Ellen Weber

57

Executive Director, Innovation & Entrepreneurship Institute (IEI); Ass...

University | 2nd

Temple University — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: (Available via Fox School directory)

FOCUS: Angel investing, early-stage venture support, entrepreneurship education, building university-community startup connecti...

TASTYR CONNECTION: HIGH VALUE. Her 15-year tenure running Robin Hood Ventures (angel investment) means she has direct connections to Philadelphia angel investors who cou...

WHY CONTACT: Ellen Weber at Temple University provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. HIGH VALUE. Her 15-year tenure running Robin Hood Ventures (angel investment) means she has direct conn...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Ellen, Your role at Temple University caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a partn...

#92 Dan Freeman, Ph.D.

57

Founding Director, Horn Entrepreneurship; Associate Professor of Marke...

University | 2nd

University of Delaware — Newark, DE (132 E. Delaware Ave.)

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/proffreeman/

FOCUS: Consumer behavior, moral behaviors, social marketing, substance abuse prevention, symbolic aspects of consumption. Trans...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Horn Entrepreneurship impacts 1,500 students/year -- a massive potential beta tester pipeline. The Summer Founders program could support a student tea...

WHY CONTACT: Dan Freeman, Ph.D. at University of Delaware provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. Horn Entrepreneurship impacts 1,500 students/year -- a massive potential beta tester pipeli...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Dan, Your role at University of Delaware caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a pa...

#93 Chef Antimo DiMeo

57

Executive Chef & Co-Owner

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Bardea Restaurant Group — Wilmington, DE

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

TASTYR CONNECTION: A James Beard-level chef endorsing Tastyr would carry enormous credibility in the Mid-Atlantic. His culinary expertise means he deeply understands dis...

WHY CONTACT: Chef Antimo DiMeo is the key connector for geographic expansion into Wilmington, DE. A James Beard-level chef endorsing Tastyr would carry enormous credibility in the Mid-Atlantic. His culinary expert...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chef, Your role at Bardea Restaurant Group caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? — Ali

#94 Terrain

57

Managing Director, Terrain Cafe

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Terrain (URBN Inc. brand) at Delaware Valley University — Doylestown, PA (Delaware Valley Universi...

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

TASTYR CONNECTION: Unique farm-university-restaurant concept could be a compelling case study for Tastyr. The connection to agricultural education means data-driven appr...

WHY CONTACT: Terrain is the key connector for geographic expansion into Doylestown, PA (Delaware Valley University campus). Unique farm-university-restaurant concept could be a compelling case study for Tastyr. Th...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Terrain, Your role at Terrain (URBN Inc. brand) at Delaware Valley University caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food sce...

#95 Tony Iannelli

57

President & CEO

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Greater Lehigh Valley Chamber of Commerce — Allentown, PA

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/t-anthony-iannelli-983636b/

TASTYR CONNECTION: His media reach (7M+ TV viewers, radio, newspaper column) could amplify Tastyr's story across the entire Lehigh Valley and into NJ. His chamber's 5,00...

WHY CONTACT: Tony Iannelli is the key connector for geographic expansion into Allentown, PA. His media reach (7M+ TV viewers, radio, newspaper column) could amplify Tastyr's story across the entire Lehigh Valley a...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Tony, Your role at Greater Lehigh Valley Chamber of Commerce caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. ...

#96 Andrew Snyder

56

Managing Partner and President

PE | 2nd

Graham Partners — Newtown Square, PA (Devon, PA residence)

Chain: Connector Express (long-game)

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/andrew-snyder-40a4412/

FOCUS: $50M-$500M+ equity; firm has ~$6.4B non-Reg AUM since inception

TASTYR CONNECTION: Graham Partners has a dedicated food & consumer practice with Andrew Snyder leading it. Their investment in Bite (restaurant kiosk technology, $9M Ser...

WHY CONTACT: Andrew Snyder at Graham Partners represents a longer-term relationship target. Graham Partners has a dedicated food & consumer practice with Andrew Snyder leading it. Their investment in Bite (restaur...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Commitment — Reference their food/consumer portfolio. 'You've built a thesis around food — here's the data layer that's missing.'

TRIGGER: Strategic portfolio enhancement — dish intelligence as infrastructure for their restaurant/food investments.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Andrew, Your role at Graham Partners caught my attention. I'm building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence for the $371B restaurant industry. While we're at seed stage now, I'd love to build a relationship given your food/consumer portfolio. ...

#97 Howard Migdal

56

CEO

Food Industry | 3rd

Grubhub (owned by Wonder Group) — New York, NY / Chicago, IL

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/howard-migdal-90275142/

TASTYR CONNECTION: Grubhub/Wonder has massive dish-level ordering data that could complement Tastyr IQ's intelligence. Grubhub's 2025 Restaurant Leadership Council inclu...

WHY CONTACT: Howard Migdal at Grubhub (owned by Wonder Group) touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Grubhub/Wonder has massive dish-level ordering data that could complement Tastyr IQ's intelligence. Grubhub's 20...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Howard, Your role at Grubhub (owned by Wonder Group) caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia...

#98 Sigrid Adriaenssens

55

Director, Keller Center for Innovation in Engineering Education; Profe...

University | 2nd

Princeton University — Princeton, NJ

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/sigrid-adriaenssens-bb23515/

FOCUS: Cross-disciplinary collaboration, design for societal impact, lightweight structures, sustainable engineering. Appointed...

TASTYR CONNECTION: Provides access to Princeton's elite entrepreneurship ecosystem. The Keller Center's accelerator and incubator could support Tastyr IQ development, an...

WHY CONTACT: Sigrid Adriaenssens at Princeton University provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. Provides access to Princeton's elite entrepreneurship ecosystem. The Keller Center's acceler...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Sigrid, Your role at Princeton University caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a p...

#99 Jeffrey A. Robinson, Ph.D.

55

Interim Chancellor, Rutgers-Newark; Prudential Chair in Business; Prof...

University | 2nd

Rutgers University — Newark, NJ

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: (Available via Rutgers Business School profile)

FOCUS: Urban entrepreneurship, high-growth African American women entrepreneurs, early-stage social entrepreneurship, inner cit...

TASTYR CONNECTION: His focus on urban entrepreneurship and inner-city food businesses aligns with Tastyr IQ's potential impact in underserved food communities. As Interi...

WHY CONTACT: Jeffrey A. Robinson, Ph.D. at Rutgers University provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. His focus on urban entrepreneurship and inner-city food businesses aligns with Tastyr I...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jeffrey, Your role at Rutgers University caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a pa...

#100 Jonathan Vassil

55

Chief Revenue Officer (CRO)

Food Industry | 3rd

Toast (NYSE: TOST) — Boston, MA (national, with strong Philad...

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/jonathanvassil

TASTYR CONNECTION: Toast is the dominant restaurant POS platform and a natural integration/data partner for Tastyr IQ. Toast's field reps already have trusted relationsh...

WHY CONTACT: Jonathan Vassil at Toast (NYSE: TOST) touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Toast is the dominant restaurant POS platform and a natural integration/data partner for Tastyr IQ. Toast's field reps alre...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jonathan, Your role at Toast (NYSE: TOST) caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love ...

#101 Vinny Gallagher

55

Owner / Operator

Food Industry | 3rd

Pizzata Pizzeria — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: N/A (search for direct contact)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Same as Jay Shin above -- Vinny is a Philly restaurant operator advising a national delivery platform on restaurant needs. Pizza is one of the highest...

WHY CONTACT: Vinny Gallagher at Pizzata Pizzeria touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Same as Jay Shin above -- Vinny is a Philly restaurant operator advising a national delivery platform on restaurant needs. Pi...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Vinny, Your role at Pizzata Pizzeria caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to ex...

#102 Marilyn Johnson

55

Founder & Editor, Award-Winning Food Writer

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

South Jersey Food Scene — South Jersey, NJ (Camden County coverage...

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/marilyn-johnson-south-jersey-foo...

TASTYR CONNECTION: The single most important contact for penetrating the South Jersey restaurant market. Her endorsement or feature would instantly provide credibility a...

WHY CONTACT: Marilyn Johnson is the key connector for geographic expansion into South Jersey, NJ (Camden County coverage area). The single most important contact for penetrating the South Jersey restaurant market....

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Marilyn, Your role at South Jersey Food Scene caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? — A...

#103 Chef Giancarlo Generosi

55

Executive Chef

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Bally's Park Place (Atlantic City) — Atlantic City, NJ

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

TASTYR CONNECTION: Casino restaurants serve enormous volumes and cater to diverse diners. Chef Generosi's long tenure means he understands what dishes resonate with Atla...

WHY CONTACT: Chef Giancarlo Generosi is the key connector for geographic expansion into Atlantic City, NJ. Casino restaurants serve enormous volumes and cater to diverse diners. Chef Generosi's long tenure means h...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chef, Your role at Bally's Park Place (Atlantic City) caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick c...

#104 Robin Lapidus

55

Executive Director

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Experience Princeton — Princeton, NJ (92 Nassau Street)

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/robin-lapidus-70b769a

TASTYR CONNECTION: Experience Princeton is a direct channel to Princeton's restaurant community. Restaurant Week events and tourism promotion align with Tastyr's dish in...

WHY CONTACT: Robin Lapidus is the key connector for geographic expansion into Princeton, NJ (92 Nassau Street). Experience Princeton is a direct channel to Princeton's restaurant community. Restaurant Week events ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Robin, Your role at Experience Princeton caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? — Ali

#105 Vince DiFelice

54

Senior Instructor of Entrepreneurship; Faculty Director of Venture Sup...

University | 2nd

University of Delaware — Newark, DE

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/vince-difelice-002952139/

FOCUS: Venture development, startup mentorship, entrepreneurship education. 2024 Technical.ly Educator of the Year (Delaware). ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: His VC background (30 startups, 3 IPOs, 3 acquisitions) makes him a valuable connector to investors. Could directly mentor Tastyr IQ's founding team, ...

WHY CONTACT: Vince DiFelice at University of Delaware provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. His VC background (30 startups, 3 IPOs, 3 acquisitions) makes him a valuable connector to inves...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Vince, Your role at University of Delaware caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a ...

#106 Johann Ducharme, Ph.D.

54

Assistant Professor of Entrepreneurship; Faculty Director, Siegfried F...

University | 2nd

University of Delaware — Newark, DE

Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: (Available via UD Lerner directory)

FOCUS: Entrepreneurship, leadership, intellectual virtues (specifically intellectual humility in business and entrepreneurship)...

TASTYR CONNECTION: His Siegfried Fellows and Entrepreneurial Leadership Certificate programs reach students across ALL UD departments -- including food science and hospi...

WHY CONTACT: Johann Ducharme, Ph.D. at University of Delaware provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. His Siegfried Fellows and Entrepreneurial Leadership Certificate programs reach student...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Johann, Your role at University of Delaware caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a...

#107 Scott Stein

54

Co-Founder & Partner (Business Operations)

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Bardea Restaurant Group — Wilmington, DE (downtown)

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/scott-stein-a9b42324/

TASTYR CONNECTION: Multi-concept restaurant operator who could deploy Tastyr across 6+ venues simultaneously. His DRA board seat means he influences industry peers. His ...

WHY CONTACT: Scott Stein is the key connector for geographic expansion into Wilmington, DE (downtown). Multi-concept restaurant operator who could deploy Tastyr across 6+ venues simultaneously. His DRA board seat ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Scott, Your role at Bardea Restaurant Group caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? — Ali

#108 Marty Grims

54

Owner

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Fearless Restaurants (White Dog Cafe, 5 locations) — Wayne, PA / Haverford, PA / Glen Mills, ...

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

TASTYR CONNECTION: Multi-location operator (5 venues, 1,200 employees) who is already data-conscious about sourcing and sustainability. Dish intelligence could help him ...

WHY CONTACT: Marty Grims is the key connector for geographic expansion into Wayne, PA / Haverford, PA / Glen Mills, PA / University City, Philadelphia. Multi-location operator (5 venues, 1,200 employees) who is al...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Marty, Your role at Fearless Restaurants (White Dog Cafe, 5 locations) caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in y...

#109 Theresa M. Fera

54

President & CEO

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Central Bucks Chamber of Commerce — Doylestown, PA

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/theresa-fera-80a6556b/

TASTYR CONNECTION: Uniquely positioned as both a chamber leader AND a hospitality industry veteran. She understands restaurants from the operator's perspective. Could ch...

WHY CONTACT: Theresa M. Fera is the key connector for geographic expansion into Doylestown, PA. Uniquely positioned as both a chamber leader AND a hospitality industry veteran. She understands restaurants from the...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Theresa, Your role at Central Bucks Chamber of Commerce caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick...

#110 Chef Tim Pervisi

54

Chef-Owner

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Heirloom Doylestown — Doylestown, PA (54 East State Street)

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

TASTYR CONNECTION: Chef-owner of an intimate farm-to-table BYOB -- the most common restaurant format in PA suburbs. His pedigree (CIA, James Beard-connected chefs) means...

WHY CONTACT: Chef Tim Pervisi is the key connector for geographic expansion into Doylestown, PA (54 East State Street). Chef-owner of an intimate farm-to-table BYOB -- the most common restaurant format in PA subur...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chef, Your role at Heirloom Doylestown caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? — Ali

#111 Mark & Deena Frank

54

Owners

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

The Inn at Barley Sheaf Farm — Holicong, PA (281 York Road, Bucks Count...

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

TASTYR CONNECTION: Represents the agritourism and farm-to-table dining segment in Bucks County. Their emphasis on local sourcing and high-quality ingredients aligns with...

WHY CONTACT: Mark & Deena Frank is the key connector for geographic expansion into Holicong, PA (281 York Road, Bucks County). Represents the agritourism and farm-to-table dining segment in Bucks County. Their emp...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Mark, Your role at The Inn at Barley Sheaf Farm caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? —...

#112 Social Chain Strategy Contacts

53

Restaurateur | 2nd

— Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

WHY CONTACT: Social Chain Strategy Contacts is a key social chain catalyst. Their restaurant influence in the tri-state creates organic social proof. Their endorsement of Tastyr IQ would validate the platform for ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Social, I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd love to share your scores (no strings attached). We're also inviting select restaurants into our Founding Cohort. Int...

#113 Key Connection Point: UPenn Network

53

Restaurateur | 2nd

— Chain: Restaurateur Gateway

WHY CONTACT: Key Connection Point: UPenn Network is a key social chain catalyst. Their restaurant influence in the tri-state creates organic social proof. Their endorsement of Tastyr IQ would validate the platform...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Scarcity — Give dish scores first, then invite to founding cohort. 'Only 50 spots — your competitors are already seeing their scores.'

TRIGGER: Competitive curiosity — how do MY dishes compare? Pride in seeing high scores. Fear of being left out while competitors ...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Key, I'm building an AI platform that scores individual dishes across Philadelphia. Your dishes are trending in our data — I'd love to share your scores (no strings attached). We're also inviting select restaurants into our Founding Cohort. Intere...

#114 Mukesh M. Patel

52

Assistant Professor of Professional Practice; Director, Collaborative ... University | 2nd

Rutgers University — Newark/New Brunswick, NJ Chain: University Pipeline

LinkedIn: (Available via Rutgers profile)

FOCUS: Technology entrepreneurship, commercialization of scientific discoveries, venture capital, angel investing, innovation. ...

TASTYR CONNECTION: His CTEC program specifically commercializes tech discoveries into startups -- Tastyr IQ fits this model perfectly. As founder of JuiceTank (NJ's larg...

WHY CONTACT: Mukesh M. Patel at Rutgers University provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. His CTEC program specifically commercializes tech discoveries into startups -- Tastyr IQ fits this...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Mukesh, Your role at Rutgers University caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a par...

#115 Dave Kasinetz

52

Vice President

Food Industry | 3rd

Advanced Hospitality Systems (AHS) / POS Philly (SpotOn Regi... — Greater Philadelphia (serves PA, NJ, DE)

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/dave-kasinetz-b65a19/

TASTYR CONNECTION: Dave has 30+ years of direct relationships with restaurant owners in the exact Tastyr IQ target market (Philadelphia and tri-state). With 4,000+ insta...

WHY CONTACT: Dave Kasinetz at Advanced Hospitality Systems (AHS) / POS Philly (SpotOn Regional Dealer) touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Dave has 30+ years of direct relationships with restaurant owners in th...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Dave, Your role at Advanced Hospitality Systems (AHS) / POS Philly (SpotOn Regional Dealer) caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've s...

#116 Jay Shin

52

Owner / Operator

Food Industry | 3rd

Fibber's Sports Bar & Grille — Philadelphia, PA

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: N/A (search for direct contact)

TASTYR CONNECTION: As a Philadelphia restaurant owner on Grubhub's national advisory council, Jay Shin is a perfect early adopter and validator for Tastyr IQ. He can pro...

WHY CONTACT: Jay Shin at Fibber's Sports Bar & Grille touches hundreds of restaurants daily. As a Philadelphia restaurant owner on Grubhub's national advisory council, Jay Shin is a perfect early adopter and valid...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Jay, Your role at Fibber's Sports Bar & Grille caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd ...

#117 Deborah Smith

52

Founder & Executive Editor; President, Foxtrot Media LLC

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

JerseyBites.com / Foxtrot Media LLC — Red Bank area, NJ (statewide coverage)

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://about.me/deborahsmith (primary professional profile)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Dual value -- as a food influencer AND a restaurant marketing consultant. She already helps restaurants improve their digital presence. Tastyr's dish ...

WHY CONTACT: Deborah Smith is the key connector for geographic expansion into Red Bank area, NJ (statewide coverage). Dual value -- as a food influencer AND a restaurant marketing consultant. She already helps res...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Deborah, Your role at JerseyBites.com / Foxtrot Media LLC caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Qui...

#118 Chef Jason Hanin

52

Chef (2025 NJRHA Chef of the Year)

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

The Ebbitt Room at The Virginia Hotel — Cape May, NJ

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

TASTYR CONNECTION: Award-winning chefs are ideal early adopters and brand ambassadors. His recognition means he's already networked across the NJ food scene. Cape May re...

WHY CONTACT: Chef Jason Hanin is the key connector for geographic expansion into Cape May, NJ. Award-winning chefs are ideal early adopters and brand ambassadors. His recognition means he's already networked acros...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Chef, Your role at The Ebbitt Room at The Virginia Hotel caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quic...

#119 Bilal & Celal Bodur

52

Co-Owners

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Aspendos Mediterranean Cuisine — Princeton, NJ (Nassau Street)

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

TASTYR CONNECTION: Independent restaurant owners who would directly benefit from dish-level intelligence to understand which menu items resonate. Their Nassau Street loc...

WHY CONTACT: Bilal & Celal Bodur is the key connector for geographic expansion into Princeton, NJ (Nassau Street). Independent restaurant owners who would directly benefit from dish-level intelligence to understan...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Bilal, Your role at Aspendos Mediterranean Cuisine caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call...

#120 Andrew Richards

51

Founder, CEO, and Managing Director

PE | 2nd

Swander Pace Capital (SPC) — San Francisco, CA & Bedminster, NJ (NJ o...

Chain: Connector Express (long-game)

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/andrew-richards-1008bb38/

FOCUS: Lower middle market; ~$2.2B cumulative equity commitments since 1996; 60+ platform companies

TASTYR CONNECTION: SPC is one of the most food-focused PE firms in the tri-state region with their NJ office. Their entire portfolio is consumer food & wellness brands. ...

WHY CONTACT: Andrew Richards at Swander Pace Capital (SPC) represents a longer-term relationship target. SPC is one of the most food-focused PE firms in the tri-state region with their NJ office. Their entire port...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Commitment — Reference their food/consumer portfolio. 'You've built a thesis around food — here's the data layer that's missing.'

TRIGGER: Strategic portfolio enhancement — dish intelligence as infrastructure for their restaurant/food investments.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Andrew, Your role at Swander Pace Capital (SPC) caught my attention. I'm building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence for the $371B restaurant industry. While we're at seed stage now, I'd love to build a relationship given your food/consumer ...

#121 Andrew Heyer

51

Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director (Founder)

PE | 2nd

Mistral Equity Partners — New York, NY (650 Fifth Avenue, 10th Flo...

Chain: Connector Express (long-game)

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/andrew-heyer-53336411/

FOCUS: $100M-$300M enterprise value targets

TASTYR CONNECTION: Mistral is squarely focused on restaurant and consumer brands -- exactly Tastyr IQ's target market. Their Insomnia Cookies and 7 Brew Coffee investmen...

WHY CONTACT: Andrew Heyer at Mistral Equity Partners represents a longer-term relationship target. Mistral is squarely focused on restaurant and consumer brands -- exactly Tastyr IQ's target market. Their Insomnia...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Commitment — Reference their food/consumer portfolio. 'You've built a thesis around food — here's the data layer that's missing.'

TRIGGER: Strategic portfolio enhancement — dish intelligence as infrastructure for their restaurant/food investments.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Andrew, Your role at Mistral Equity Partners caught my attention. I'm building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence for the $371B restaurant industry. While we're at seed stage now, I'd love to build a relationship given your food/consumer por...

#122 Justin R. Green

51

Partner and Co-Head of Flagship Funds

PE | 2nd

Palladium Equity Partners — New York, NY

Chain: Connector Express (long-game)

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/justin-green-070b814/

FOCUS: $50M-$150M investments; $10M-$75M EBITDA targets; ~$3B AUM

TASTYR CONNECTION: Palladium's focus on Hispanic food brands (Del Real Foods, Source Logistics) and consumer services is highly aligned with Tastyr IQ's Philadelphia mar...

WHY CONTACT: Justin R. Green at Palladium Equity Partners represents a longer-term relationship target. Palladium's focus on Hispanic food brands (Del Real Foods, Source Logistics) and consumer services is highly ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Commitment — Reference their food/consumer portfolio. 'You've built a thesis around food — here's the data layer that's missing.'

TRIGGER: Strategic portfolio enhancement — dish intelligence as infrastructure for their restaurant/food investments.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Justin, Your role at Palladium Equity Partners caught my attention. I'm building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence for the $371B restaurant industry. While we're at seed stage now, I'd love to build a relationship given your food/consumer p...

#123 Ayanna Khan

51

Founder, President & CEO

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Delaware Black Chamber of Commerce (DEBCC) — Wilmington, DE (East 11th Street HQ)

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/posts/ayanna-khan-m-s-23885542 (act...

TASTYR CONNECTION: DEBCC represents a growing and underserved restaurant community. Black-owned restaurants often lack access to food-tech tools -- Tastyr could address ...

WHY CONTACT: Ayanna Khan is the key connector for geographic expansion into Wilmington, DE (East 11th Street HQ). DEBCC represents a growing and underserved restaurant community. Black-owned restaurants often lack...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Ayanna, Your role at Delaware Black Chamber of Commerce (DEBCC) caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your are...

#124 Bernard Dagenais

51

President & CEO

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

The Main Line Chamber of Commerce — Wayne, PA

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/bernard-dagenais-ba549310/

TASTYR CONNECTION: The Main Line represents Philadelphia's most affluent suburban dining market. Chamber events and member communications reach businesses throughout thi...

WHY CONTACT: Bernard Dagenais is the key connector for geographic expansion into Wayne, PA. The Main Line represents Philadelphia's most affluent suburban dining market. Chamber events and member communications re...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Bernard, Your role at The Main Line Chamber of Commerce caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick...

#125 Avram Hornik

51

Owner

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

FCM Hospitality (Lola's Garden, Ardmore) — Ardmore, PA (Suburban Square)

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

TASTYR CONNECTION: Multi-concept hospitality group expanding from Philly to suburbs -- exactly the growth trajectory Tastyr wants to follow. Suburban location means he's...

WHY CONTACT: Avram Hornik is the key connector for geographic expansion into Ardmore, PA (Suburban Square). Multi-concept hospitality group expanding from Philly to suburbs -- exactly the growth trajectory Tastyr ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Avram, Your role at FCM Hospitality (Lola's Garden, Ardmore) caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. ...

#126 MainLine Investment Partners

50

Managing Principals -- Mr. Landman (co-founder) and Mr. Clapper (co-fo...

PE | 2nd

MainLine Investment Partners — Wynnewood, PA (308 E. Lancaster Avenue) ...

Chain: Connector Express (long-game)

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/mainline-investment-partner...

FOCUS: Middle market; ~$1B invested capital and AUM; principals have managed $3B+ in alternatives since 1987

TASTYR CONNECTION: Located on the Philadelphia Main Line, MainLine Investment Partners is the most geographically proximate PE firm to Tastyr IQ's Philadelphia base. The...

WHY CONTACT: MainLine Investment Partners at MainLine Investment Partners represents a longer-term relationship target. Located on the Philadelphia Main Line, MainLine Investment Partners is the most geographicall...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Commitment — Reference their food/consumer portfolio. 'You've built a thesis around food — here's the data layer that's missing.'

TRIGGER: Strategic portfolio enhancement — dish intelligence as infrastructure for their restaurant/food investments.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi MainLine, Your role at MainLine Investment Partners caught my attention. I'm building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence for the $371B restaurant industry. While we're at seed stage now, I'd love to build a relationship given your food/consu...

#127 Date: 2026-03-23

49

University | 2nd

—

Chain: University Pipeline

WHY CONTACT: Date: 2026-03-23 at provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. Their research/program focus creates natural collaboration opportunity. University partnerships generate data, cred...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Date:, I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a partnership — data access for your students, collaboratio...

#128 Total Contacts: 19

49

University | 2nd

—

Chain: University Pipeline

WHY CONTACT: Total Contacts: 19 at provides academic credibility and student beta tester pipeline. Their research/program focus creates natural collaboration opportunity. University partnerships generate data, cr...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Unity — 'Fellow Penn alum offering research data access. Students get beta testing opportunity.'

TRIGGER: Academic curiosity about novel food-tech dataset. Desire to connect students with real startups. Research publication po...

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Total, I'm Ali Mabsoute (UPenn), co-founder of Tastyr IQ — AI dish ratings across 9 food verticals. Our dataset of 2,490+ scored dishes could be valuable for research. I'd love to explore a partnership — data access for your students, collaboratio...

#129 Joe Massaro

49

President & CEO

Food Industry | 3rd

Pennsylvania Restaurant & Lodging Association (PRLA) — Harrisburg, PA

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/joe-massaro-2852a29/

TASTYR CONNECTION: Joe Massaro is the single most connected person to Pennsylvania restaurant owners. PRLA membership gives Tastyr IQ direct access to restaurant operato...

WHY CONTACT: Joe Massaro at Pennsylvania Restaurant & Lodging Association (PRLA) touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Joe Massaro is the single most connected person to Pennsylvania restaurant owners. PRLA membe...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Joe, Your role at Pennsylvania Restaurant & Lodging Association (PRLA) caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes a...

#130 Andrew Howell

49

Senior Vice President of Operations

Food Industry | 3rd

Baldor Specialty Foods — Bronx, NY (oversees Philadelphia distrib...

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: Search on LinkedIn (joined Baldor December 2023)

TASTYR CONNECTION: Andrew is the operational leader responsible for Baldor's Philadelphia footprint. He has direct visibility into what restaurants are ordering and what...

WHY CONTACT: Andrew Howell at Baldor Specialty Foods touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Andrew is the operational leader responsible for Baldor's Philadelphia footprint. He has direct visibility into what rest...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Andrew, Your role at Baldor Specialty Foods caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd lov...

#131 Christina Renna

49

President & CEO

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Chamber of Commerce Southern New Jersey (CCSNJ) — Voorhees, NJ

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: Available via CCSNJ organizational page

TASTYR CONNECTION: Gateway to the South Jersey business community. An endorsement from CCSNJ could open doors to hundreds of restaurant members. Chamber events and showc...

WHY CONTACT: Christina Renna is the key connector for geographic expansion into Voorhees, NJ. Gateway to the South Jersey business community. An endorsement from CCSNJ could open doors to hundreds of restaurant me...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Christina, Your role at Chamber of Commerce Southern New Jersey (CCSNJ) caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in ...

#132 Daniel Klim

49

President & CEO

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

New Jersey Restaurant & Hospitality Association (NJRHA) / NJ... — Trenton, NJ (statewide scope, strong Sou...

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/danielklim14/

TASTYR CONNECTION: The single most important institutional contact for NJ restaurant market penetration. NJRHA partnership could provide access to the entire NJ restaura...

WHY CONTACT: Daniel Klim is the key connector for geographic expansion into Trenton, NJ (statewide scope, strong South Jersey presence). The single most important institutional contact for NJ restaurant market pen...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Daniel, Your role at New Jersey Restaurant & Hospitality Association (NJRHA) / NJ Restaurant Educational Foundation (NJREF) caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-st...

#133 Henk Hartong III

48

Chairman and CEO

PE | 2nd

Brynwood Partners — Greenwich, CT

Chain: Connector Express (long-game)

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/brynwood-partners (firm pag...

FOCUS: Lower middle market; ~$2.4B cumulative committed equity capital; currently raising Brynwood Partners IX

TASTYR CONNECTION: Brynwood is one of the most active food-focused PE acquirers in the tri-state area. Their strategy of revitalizing consumer food brands could benefit ...

WHY CONTACT: Henk Hartong III at Brynwood Partners represents a longer-term relationship target. Brynwood is one of the most active food-focused PE acquirers in the tri-state area. Their strategy of revitalizing c...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Commitment — Reference their food/consumer portfolio. 'You've built a thesis around food — here's the data layer that's missing.'

TRIGGER: Strategic portfolio enhancement — dish intelligence as infrastructure for their restaurant/food investments.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Henk, Your role at Brynwood Partners caught my attention. I'm building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence for the $371B restaurant industry. While we're at seed stage now, I'd love to build a relationship given your food/consumer portfolio. ...

#134 Centre Partners

48

Managing Partners (current leadership not publicly named in recent sou...

PE | 2nd

Centre Partners Management LLC — New York, NY and Los Angeles, CA

Chain: Connector Express (long-game)

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/centre-partners-management-...

FOCUS: Middle market; $2.5B+ equity capital invested across 80+ transactions; 30 team members including 21 partners

TASTYR CONNECTION: Centre Partners has one of the highest concentrations of food/restaurant investments among NYC-based PE firms (12 food/ag deals, 11 consumer goods). T...

WHY CONTACT: Centre Partners at Centre Partners Management LLC represents a longer-term relationship target. Centre Partners has one of the highest concentrations of food/restaurant investments among NYC-based PE ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Commitment — Reference their food/consumer portfolio. 'You've built a thesis around food — here's the data layer that's missing.'

TRIGGER: Strategic portfolio enhancement — dish intelligence as infrastructure for their restaurant/food investments.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Centre, Your role at Centre Partners Management LLC caught my attention. I'm building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence for the $371B restaurant industry. While we're at seed stage now, I'd love to build a relationship given your food/consu...

#135 Carrie Leishman

48

President & CEO

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Delaware Restaurant Association (DRA) / Delaware Restaurant ... — Wilmington, DE

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/carrie-leishman-4129899/

TASTYR CONNECTION: THE most important contact for Delaware market entry. Her organization represents virtually every restaurant in Delaware. Partnership with DRA could p...

WHY CONTACT: Carrie Leishman is the key connector for geographic expansion into Wilmington, DE. THE most important contact for Delaware market entry. Her organization represents virtually every restaurant in Delaw...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Carrie, Your role at Delaware Restaurant Association (DRA) / Delaware Restaurant Foundation (DRF) caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connec...

#136 Michael Quaranta

48

President

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Delaware State Chamber of Commerce — Wilmington, DE

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/michael-j-quaranta-74ab01a9/

TASTYR CONNECTION: Chamber partnership could position Tastyr as a featured technology for Delaware's business community. Chamber events, newsletters, and advocacy channe...

WHY CONTACT: Michael Quaranta is the key connector for geographic expansion into Wilmington, DE. Chamber partnership could position Tastyr as a featured technology for Delaware's business community. Chamber events...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Michael, Your role at Delaware State Chamber of Commerce caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quic...

#137 Lehigh Valley Economic Development Corp

48

President & CEO

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Lehigh Valley Economic Development Corporation (LVEDC) — Allentown/Bethlehem, PA

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: Available via LVEDC organizational page

TASTYR CONNECTION: LVEDC could position Tastyr as part of the Lehigh Valley's growing food-tech ecosystem. Their focus on food & beverage manufacturing means they unders...

WHY CONTACT: Lehigh Valley Economic Development Corp is the key connector for geographic expansion into Allentown/Bethlehem, PA. LVEDC could position Tastyr as part of the Lehigh Valley's growing food-tech ecosyst...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Lehigh, Your role at Lehigh Valley Economic Development Corporation (LVEDC) caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene...

#138 Daniel Klim, MS

47

President & CEO

Food Industry | 3rd

New Jersey Restaurant & Hospitality Association (NJRHA) and ... — Trenton, NJ

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/danielklim14/

TASTYR CONNECTION: NJ is a key part of the tri-state market for Tastyr IQ. Klim's background in nonprofit management (25+ years, including 12 years at American Physical ...

WHY CONTACT: Daniel Klim, MS at New Jersey Restaurant & Hospitality Association (NJRHA) and NJ Restaurant Educational Foundation (NJREF) touches hundreds of restaurants daily. NJ is a key part of the tri-state mar...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Daniel, Your role at New Jersey Restaurant & Hospitality Association (NJRHA) and NJ Restaurant Educational Foundation (NJREF) caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant cli...

#139 Carrie Leishman

46

President & CEO

Food Industry | 3rd

Delaware Restaurant Association (DRA) and Delaware Restauran... — Wilmington, DE

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/carrie-leishman-4129899/

TASTYR CONNECTION: Carrie Leishman is a powerhouse in the restaurant industry at both state and national levels. Her national NRAEF chairmanship gives her connections fa...

WHY CONTACT: Carrie Leishman at Delaware Restaurant Association (DRA) and Delaware Restaurant Foundation (DRF) touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Carrie Leishman is a powerhouse in the restaurant industry at b...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Carrie, Your role at Delaware Restaurant Association (DRA) and Delaware Restaurant Foundation (DRF) caught my attention. Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus....

#140 Liat Krawczyk

46

Inaugural Executive Director

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

NJ AI Hub (Princeton University / NJEDA / Microsoft / CoreWe... — Princeton, NJ (619 Alexander Road, Route...

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/liatkrawczyk/

TASTYR CONNECTION: Tastyr is an AI-powered platform -- the NJ AI Hub is the perfect ecosystem for visibility, networking, and potential accelerator participation. Krawcz...

WHY CONTACT: Liat Krawczyk is the key connector for geographic expansion into Princeton, NJ (619 Alexander Road, Route 1 corridor). Tastyr is an AI-powered platform -- the NJ AI Hub is the perfect ecosystem for vi...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Liat, Your role at NJ AI Hub (Princeton University / NJEDA / Microsoft / CoreWeave partnership) caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect ...

#141 Eric Melloul

45

Senior Advisor (formerly Managing Director, 2008-2024)

PE | 2nd

Verlinvest — New York, NY (offices also in Brussels, ...

Chain: Connector Express (long-game)

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/verlinvest (firm page; Eric...

FOCUS: $20M-$200M per company; ~$2B AUM

TASTYR CONNECTION: Verlinvest co-acquired Philadelphia-based Insomnia Cookies ($350M EV, July 2024), showing direct investment in the Philadelphia food market. Their por...

WHY CONTACT: Eric Melloul at Verlinvest represents a longer-term relationship target. Verlinvest co-acquired Philadelphia-based Insomnia Cookies ($350M EV, July 2024), showing direct investment in the Philadelphia...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Commitment — Reference their food/consumer portfolio. 'You've built a thesis around food — here's the data layer that's missing.'

TRIGGER: Strategic portfolio enhancement — dish intelligence as infrastructure for their restaurant/food investments.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Eric, Your role at Verlinvest caught my attention. I'm building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence for the $371B restaurant industry. While we're at seed stage now, I'd love to build a relationship given your food/consumer portfolio. Coffee ...

#142 Andrew C. Taub

45

Managing Partner (Buyout Fund)

PE | 2nd

L Catterton — Greenwich, CT (599 West Putnam Avenue)

Chain: Connector Express (long-game)

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/andrew-taub-921695/

FOCUS: Large middle market to large-cap; ~$40B AUM; 300+ investments since 1989

TASTYR CONNECTION: L Catterton is THE dominant consumer PE firm globally with deep restaurant expertise (Del Frisco's, Barcelona/Bartaco). While their deal sizes are lar...

WHY CONTACT: Andrew C. Taub at L Catterton represents a longer-term relationship target. L Catterton is THE dominant consumer PE firm globally with deep restaurant expertise (Del Frisco's, Barcelona/Bartaco). Whil...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Commitment — Reference their food/consumer portfolio. 'You've built a thesis around food — here's the data layer that's missing.'

TRIGGER: Strategic portfolio enhancement — dish intelligence as infrastructure for their restaurant/food investments.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Andrew, Your role at L Catterton caught my attention. I'm building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence for the $371B restaurant industry. While we're at seed stage now, I'd love to build a relationship given your food/consumer portfolio. Coff...

#143 Saeed Amidi

43

Founder & CEO

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

Plug and Play Tech Center (operating NJ AI Hub Accelerator) — Princeton, NJ (NJ AI Hub) / Sunnyvale, C...

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

LinkedIn: Available (public figure)

TASTYR CONNECTION: If Tastyr applies to the Plug and Play AI Accelerator at Princeton, Amidi's network provides access to 550+ corporate partners and massive investor ne...

WHY CONTACT: Saeed Amidi is the key connector for geographic expansion into Princeton, NJ (NJ AI Hub) / Sunnyvale, CA (HQ). If Tastyr applies to the Plug and Play AI Accelerator at Princeton, Amidi's network provi...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Saeed, Your role at Plug and Play Tech Center (operating NJ AI Hub Accelerator) caught my attention. I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food s...

#144 Helen Chiang

42

Managing Director (transitioning to Senior Advisor)

PE | 2nd

American Securities — New York, NY

Chain: Connector Express (long-game)

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/helen-chiang-17671b2/

FOCUS: $200M-$2B revenue companies; $50M-$250M EBITDA; ~$26B AUM

TASTYR CONNECTION: American Securities' Potbelly investment and exit ($689M, Oct 2025) demonstrates direct restaurant chain investment experience. Helen Chiang's backgro...

WHY CONTACT: Helen Chiang at American Securities represents a longer-term relationship target. American Securities' Potbelly investment and exit ($689M, Oct 2025) demonstrates direct restaurant chain investment ex...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Commitment — Reference their food/consumer portfolio. 'You've built a thesis around food — here's the data layer that's missing.'

TRIGGER: Strategic portfolio enhancement — dish intelligence as infrastructure for their restaurant/food investments.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Helen, Your role at American Securities caught my attention. I'm building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence for the $371B restaurant industry. While we're at seed stage now, I'd love to build a relationship given your food/consumer portfoli...

#145 SOUTH JERSEY

40

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

—

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

WHY CONTACT: SOUTH JERSEY is the key connector for geographic expansion into . Their local influence opens doors in markets outside Philadelphia core. Geographic coverage ensures Tastyr demonstrates tri-state trac...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi SOUTH, I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? — Ali

#146 PRINCETON / ROUTE 1 CORRIDOR

40

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

—

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

WHY CONTACT: PRINCETON / ROUTE 1 CORRIDOR is the key connector for geographic expansion into . Their local influence opens doors in markets outside Philadelphia core. Geographic coverage ensures Tastyr demonstrate...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi PRINCETON, I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? — Ali

#147 WILMINGTON / DELAWARE

40

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

—

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

WHY CONTACT: WILMINGTON / DELAWARE is the key connector for geographic expansion into . Their local influence opens doors in markets outside Philadelphia core. Geographic coverage ensures Tastyr demonstrates tri-s...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi WILMINGTON, I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? — Ali

#148 MAIN LINE

40

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

—

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

WHY CONTACT: MAIN LINE is the key connector for geographic expansion into . Their local influence opens doors in markets outside Philadelphia core. Geographic coverage ensures Tastyr demonstrates tri-state tractio...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi MAIN, I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? — Ali

#149 BUCKS COUNTY

40

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

—

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

WHY CONTACT: BUCKS COUNTY is the key connector for geographic expansion into . Their local influence opens doors in markets outside Philadelphia core. Geographic coverage ensures Tastyr demonstrates tri-state trac...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi BUCKS, I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? — Ali

#150 LEHIGH VALLEY / READING

40

NJ-DE-Suburb | 3rd

—

Chain: NJ-to-NYC Bridge + Restaurateur Gateway

WHY CONTACT: LEHIGH VALLEY / READING is the key connector for geographic expansion into . Their local influence opens doors in markets outside Philadelphia core. Geographic coverage ensures Tastyr demonstrates tri...

PSYCHOLOGY: Unity + Scarcity — 'We're expanding beyond Philly into your area. You're the key connector for [region].'

TRIGGER: Local pride — putting their community on the food-tech map. Desire to be the go-to connector. Fear of missing the expans...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi LEHIGH, I'm Ali Mabsoute, building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence. We're expanding across the tri-state and I'd love to connect about the food scene in your area. Quick call? — Ali

TIER 3 — LONG GAME — RANK 1-39

11 contacts — track, engage on social, wait for the right moment

#1 FOOD DISTRIBUTORS

38

Food Industry | 3rd

—

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

WHY CONTACT: FOOD DISTRIBUTORS at touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Their industry position gives them relationships with restaurant decision-makers at scale. Partnership creates distribution channel and val...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi FOOD, Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to explore how we could work together. 15 minutes? — Ali ...

#2 RESTAURANT POS / TECH

38

Food Industry | 3rd

—

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

WHY CONTACT: RESTAURANT POS / TECH at touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Their industry position gives them relationships with restaurant decision-makers at scale. Partnership creates distribution channel and...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi RESTAURANT, Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to explore how we could work together. 15 minutes? ...

#3 FOOD DELIVERY PLATFORMS

38

Food Industry | 3rd

—

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

WHY CONTACT: FOOD DELIVERY PLATFORMS at touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Their industry position gives them relationships with restaurant decision-makers at scale. Partnership creates distribution channel a...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi FOOD, Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to explore how we could work together. 15 minutes? — Ali ...

#4 FOOD INDUSTRY ORGANIZATIONS

38

Food Industry | 3rd

—

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

WHY CONTACT: FOOD INDUSTRY ORGANIZATIONS at touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Their industry position gives them relationships with restaurant decision-makers at scale. Partnership creates distribution chann...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi FOOD, Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to explore how we could work together. 15 minutes? — Ali ...

#5 BONUS: DISTRIBUTOR OPERATIONS LEADERSHIP

38

Food Industry | 3rd

—

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

WHY CONTACT: BONUS: DISTRIBUTOR OPERATIONS LEADERSHIP at touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Their industry position gives them relationships with restaurant decision-makers at scale. Partnership creates distr...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi BONUS:, Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to explore how we could work together. 15 minutes? — Al...

#6 Key Talking Points by Category

38

Food Industry | 3rd

—

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

WHY CONTACT: Key Talking Points by Category at touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Their industry position gives them relationships with restaurant decision-makers at scale. Partnership creates distribution ch...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Key, Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to explore how we could work together. 15 minutes? — Ali M...

#7 For Distributors :

38

Food Industry | 3rd

—

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

WHY CONTACT: For Distributors : at touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Their industry position gives them relationships with restaurant decision-makers at scale. Partnership creates distribution channel and va...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi For, Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to explore how we could work together. 15 minutes? — Ali M...

#8 For POS/Tech :

38

Food Industry | 3rd

—

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

WHY CONTACT: For POS/Tech : at touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Their industry position gives them relationships with restaurant decision-makers at scale. Partnership creates distribution channel and valida...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi For, Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to explore how we could work together. 15 minutes? — Ali M...

#9 For Delivery Platforms :

38

Food Industry | 3rd

—

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

WHY CONTACT: For Delivery Platforms : at touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Their industry position gives them relationships with restaurant decision-makers at scale. Partnership creates distribution channel ...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi For, Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to explore how we could work together. 15 minutes? — Ali M...

#10 For Industry Associations :

38

Food Industry | 3rd

—

Chain: Food Industry Backdoor

WHY CONTACT: For Industry Associations : at touches hundreds of restaurants daily. Their industry position gives them relationships with restaurant decision-makers at scale. Partnership creates distribution chann...

PSYCHOLOGY: Reciprocity + Authority — 'Dish intelligence data could help your restaurant clients. Let me show you the platform.'

TRIGGER: Business value — offering clients differentiated insights. Partnership revenue potential. Being seen as innovative in th...

APPROACH: Exclusive access offer. Lead with what THEY get (beta access, exclusive data, first-look). Build engagement before any ask.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi For, Tastyr IQ is an AI platform that scores individual dishes — data that could help your restaurant clients optimize their menus. We've scored 2,490+ dishes across Philadelphia. I'd love to explore how we could work together. 15 minutes? — Ali M...

#11 Key Takeaways

33

PE | 2nd

—

Chain: Connector Express (long-game)

WHY CONTACT: Key Takeaways at represents a longer-term relationship target. Their food/consumer portfolio creates strategic alignment. While PE timing may not match seed stage, building this relationship now pays...

PSYCHOLOGY: Authority + Commitment — Reference their food/consumer portfolio. 'You've built a thesis around food — here's the data layer that's missing.'

TRIGGER: Strategic portfolio enhancement — dish intelligence as infrastructure for their restaurant/food investments.

APPROACH: Warm approach via shared network. Lead with value/advice request. Build relationship first, then introduce investment opportunity naturally.

DRAFT MESSAGE:

Hi Key, I'm building Tastyr IQ — AI-powered dish intelligence for the $371B restaurant industry. While we're at seed stage now, I'd love to build a relationship given your food/consumer portfolio. Coffee sometime? — Ali Mabsoute, Tastyr IQ

QUICK REFERENCE — ALL CONTACTS BY RANK

#	Name	Organization	Segment	Rank	Chain
1	Josh Kopelman	First Round Capital	VC	90	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
2	Isabelle Kent	Startup Leaders (formerly...	Founder-Conn	89	Connector Express
3	Danae Mobley	1Philadelphia (1PHL) / Co...	Founder-Conn	89	Connector Express
4	Gabriel Weinberg	DuckDuckGo	Founder-Conn	89	Connector Express
5	Chris Stanchak	Loveseat / StanForce Labs	Founder-Conn	89	Connector Express
6	David Cabello	Black and Mobile	Founder-Conn	89	Connector Express
7	Nick Bayer	Saxbys	Founder-Conn	89	Connector Express
8	Wayne Kimmel	SeventySix Capital	VC	87	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
9	Marc Lore	Wonder Group	Founder-Conn	87	Connector Express
10	John Moore	ImpactPHL / Investors Cir...	Angel	86	Connector Express + ...
11	Anthony Edwards	EatOkra	Accelerator	86	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
12	Kae Lani Palmisano	Philadelphia Magazine (Fo...	Media	86	Media Momentum Engin...
13	Kiki Aranita	The Philadelphia Inquirer	Media	86	Media Momentum Engin...
14	Rudy J. Ellis	Switchboard Live	Founder-Conn	86	Connector Express
15	Bob Moore	Crossbeam (now merged wit...	Founder-Conn	86	Connector Express
16	Apu Gupta	Madaket Group (formerly C...	Founder-Conn	86	Connector Express
17	Mikal Harden	Juno Search Partners / Ju...	Founder-Conn	86	Connector Express
18	Abhi Ramesh	Misfits Market	Founder-Conn	86	Connector Express
19	Abu Kamara	Grovara	Founder-Conn	86	Connector Express
20	Dean Miller	PACT (Philadelphia Allian...	Founder-Conn	86	Connector Express
21	Scott Nissenbaum	Ben Franklin Technology P...	Founder-Conn	86	Connector Express
22	Greg Fegley	Temple University -- Fox ...	Accelerator	85	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
23	Scott Nissenbaum	Ben Franklin Technology P...	Accelerator	85	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
24	Darren Sandberg	Dreamit Ventures	VC	84	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
25	Andrew Ive	Big Idea Ventures (BIV)	VC	84	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
26	Allen Fogel	Robin Hood Ventures / Mid...	Angel	83	Connector Express + ...
27	Richard Binswanger	TLG Group / ImpactPHL / G...	Angel	83	Connector Express + ...
28	Craig LaBan	The Philadelphia Inquirer	Media	83	Media Momentum Engin...
29	Maddy Sweitzer-Lamme	Eater Philly, PhillyMag, ...	Media	83	Media Momentum Engin...
30	Sarah Huffman	Technical.ly	Media	83	Media Momentum Engin...
31	Ryan Mulligan	Philadelphia Business Jou...	Media	83	Media Momentum Engin...
32	Eli Kulp, Marisa Magna...	Delicious City Philly Pod...	Media	83	Media Momentum Engin...
33	Chris Wink	Technical.ly	Founder-Conn	83	Connector Express
34	Rick Nucci	Guru (AI knowledge manage...	Founder-Conn	83	Connector Express
35	Danny Meyer	Enlightened Hospitality I...	VC	82	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
36	Luke Butler	Comcast NBCUniversal LIFT...	Accelerator	82	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
37	Brigitte Daniel	Launch Lane Accelerator (...	Accelerator	82	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
38	Lori Rosenkopf	Penn Venture Lab (Wharton...	Accelerator	82	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
39	Chuck Sacco	Drexel University -- Clos...	Accelerator	82	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
40	Dan Ostien	i2n Angels / Chester Coun...	Angel	80	Connector Express + ...
41	Danya Henninger	Technical.ly	Media	80	Media Momentum Engin...

#	Name	Organization	Segment	Rank	Chain
42	Alicia Vitarelli	6ABC / WPVI-TV (Philadelp...	Media	80	Media Momentum Engin...
43	Gloria Bell	Inspiring Tech Foundation...	Founder-Conn	80	Connector Express
44	Frank Shultz & Bo Motl...	United Effects Ventures (...	Founder-Conn	80	Connector Express
45	Craig Shapiro	Collaborative Fund	VC	79	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
46	Sophie Bakalar	Collaborative Fund	VC	79	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
47	Sanjeev Krishnan	S2G Ventures (now S2G Inv...	VC	79	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
48	Chuck Templeton	S2G Ventures (S2G Investm...	VC	79	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
49	Walter Robb	S2G Investments	VC	79	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
50	Brett Gibson	Initialized Capital	VC	79	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
51	David Barber	Almanac Insights	VC	79	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
52	Brian Halweil	Almanac Insights	VC	79	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
53	Katie Teuber	Comcast NBCUniversal LIFT...	Accelerator	79	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
54	Dan Freeman	Horn Entrepreneurship, Un...	Accelerator	79	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
55	Andrew D. Ive	Big Idea Ventures (BIV)	Accelerator	79	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
56	Darren Sandberg	Dreamit Ventures	Accelerator	79	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
57	Marc Vetri	Vetri Cucina (flagship, 1...	Restaurateur	79	Restaurateur Gateway
58	Michael Solomonov	CookNSolo Restaurants -- ...	Restaurateur	79	Restaurateur Gateway
59	Jose Garces	Garces Group -- Amada, Vi...	Restaurateur	79	Restaurateur Gateway
60	Cristina Martinez	South Philly Barbacoa, Ca...	Restaurateur	79	Restaurateur Gateway
61	Nick Elmi	Laurel (relocating to Cen...	Restaurateur	79	Restaurateur Gateway
62	Jesse Ito	Royal Sushi & Izakaya, Ro...	Restaurateur	79	Restaurateur Gateway
63	Amanda Shulman	Her Place Supper Club (Ri...	Restaurateur	79	Restaurateur Gateway
64	Robert Adelson	Osage Venture Partners	VC	78	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
65	Nate Lentz	Osage Venture Partners	VC	78	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
66	Chad Stender	SeventySix Capital	VC	78	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
67	Michael DiPiano	NewSpring Capital	VC	78	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
68	Peter Genovese	NJ.com / NJ Advance Media	Media	78	Media Momentum Engin...
69	Deborah Smith	Jersey Bites (JerseyBites...	Media	78	Media Momentum Engin...
70	Aaron Price	TechUnited:NJ (formerly N...	Founder-Conn	78	Connector Express
71	James Barrood	Innovation+ / Innovate 10...	Founder-Conn	78	Connector Express
72	RoseAnn Rosenthal	Broad Street Angels / Str...	Angel	77	Connector Express + ...
73	Chuck Carter	Keiretsu Forum Mid-Atlant...	Angel	77	Connector Express + ...
74	Scott Nissenbaum	Ben Franklin Technology P...	Angel	77	Connector Express + ...
75	Peter Leone	Robin Hood Ventures	Angel	77	Connector Express + ...
76	Anne-Marie Maman	Princeton Entrepreneurshi...	Accelerator	77	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
77	Robert Grey	Plug and Play Tech Center	Accelerator	77	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
78	Michael Klein	The Philadelphia Inquirer	Media	77	Media Momentum Engin...
79	Hayley Barna	First Round Capital	VC	76	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
80	Ben Lerer	Lerer Hippeau	VC	76	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
81	Sam Jones	Torch Capital	VC	76	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
82	Natalie Massenet	Imaginary Ventures	VC	76	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
83	Mark Leavitt	Enlightened Hospitality I...	VC	76	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...

#	Name	Organization	Segment	Rank	Chain
84	Brett Thomas	CAVU Consumer Partners	VC	76	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
85	Greg Vernick	Vernick Food & Drink (fla...	Restaurateur	76	Restaurateur Gateway
86	Kevin Sbraga	The Fat Ham (University C...	Restaurateur	76	Restaurateur Gateway
87	Nok Suntaranon	Kalaya (South Philadelphi...	Restaurateur	76	Restaurateur Gateway
88	Yun Fuentes	Bolo (Rittenhouse Square)	Restaurateur	76	Restaurateur Gateway
89	Joey Baldino	Zeppoli (Collingswood, NJ...	Restaurateur	76	Restaurateur Gateway
90	Tyler Akin	Le Cavalier at Hotel du P...	Restaurateur	76	Restaurateur Gateway
91	Townsend Wentz	TWRG (Townsend Wentz Rest...	Restaurateur	76	Restaurateur Gateway
92	Sean Dowling	Osage Venture Partners	VC	75	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
93	Saul Richter	Rittenhouse Ventures	VC	75	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
94	Donna Cordner	Robin Hood Ventures; Co-f...	Angel	74	Connector Express + ...
95	Sasha Schrode	Robin Hood Ventures	Angel	74	Connector Express + ...
96	Bob Ciaruffoli	Broad Street Angels (Unio...	Angel	74	Connector Express + ...
97	Howard Lubert	Keiretsu Forum Mid-Atlant...	Angel	74	Connector Express + ...
98	Chris Topolewski	Wick Capital Partners / B...	Angel	74	Connector Express + ...
99	Shintaro Kaido	Stevens Institute of Tech...	Accelerator	74	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
100	Will Lutz	NJIT -- VentureLink / New...	Accelerator	74	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
101	Aaron Price	TechUnited:NJ (formerly N...	Accelerator	74	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
102	Janique Edwards	EatOkra	Accelerator	74	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
103	MJ Durkin	New Jersey Innovation Ins...	Accelerator	74	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
104	Jacklin Altman	Instagram	Food Blogger	74	FOMO Cascade
105	David Wez	TikTok, Instagram; Co-hos...	Food Blogger	74	FOMO Cascade
106	Sofia H.	Instagram, TikTok	Food Blogger	74	FOMO Cascade
107	Eli Kulp & Marisa Magn...	Podcast (Apple, Spotify),...	Food Blogger	74	FOMO Cascade
108	Joy Manning	Instagram, Substack/Newsl...	Food Blogger	74	FOMO Cascade
109	Jason Sheehan	Philadelphia Magazine (Fo...	Food Blogger	74	FOMO Cascade
110	Craig LaBan	Philadelphia Inquirer, In...	Food Blogger	74	FOMO Cascade
111	Zachary Brand	Founding Philly Podcast	Media	74	Media Momentum Engin...
112	Alyana Gomez	6ABC / WPVI-TV (Philadelp...	Media	74	Media Momentum Engin...
113	Meka Asonye	First Round Capital	VC	73	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
114	Dan Borok	Newark Venture Partners (...	VC	73	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
115	Vaughn Crowe	Newark Venture Partners (...	VC	73	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
116	Cristina Rohr	S2G Investments	VC	73	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
117	Isabelle Phelps	Lerer Hippeau	VC	73	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
118	Jonathan Keidan	Torch Capital	VC	73	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
119	Jordan Gaspar	AF Ventures (formerly Acc...	VC	73	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
120	Andrew Bluestein	Bluestein Ventures	VC	73	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
121	Mike Bowman	Delaware SBDC (University...	Accelerator	73	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
122	Stephen Starr	Starr Restaurants -- 30+ ...	Restaurateur	73	Restaurateur Gateway
123	Aimee Olexy	Talula's Table (Kennett S...	Restaurateur	73	Restaurateur Gateway
124	Skip Maner	NewSpring Capital	VC	72	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
125	Jeffrey Kanige	NJBIZ	Media	72	Media Momentum Engin...

#	Name	Organization	Segment	Rank	Chain
126	Glen Gaddy	Robin Hood Ventures	Angel	71	Connector Express + ...
127	Doc Parghi	SRI Capital / Ben Frankli...	Angel	71	Connector Express + ...
128	Mark Henderson	Broad Street Angels / Gra...	Angel	71	Connector Express + ...
129	Jon Beschen	Ben Franklin Technology P...	Angel	71	Connector Express + ...
130	Loren Danzis	Delaware Crossing Investo...	Angel	71	Connector Express + ...
131	David Burke	Red Horse Steakhouse (Rum...	Restaurateur	71	Restaurateur Gateway
132	David Viana	Heirloom Kitchen (Old Bri...	Restaurateur	71	Restaurateur Gateway
133	Dane DeMarco	Gass & Main (Haddonfield,...	Restaurateur	71	Restaurateur Gateway
134	Nur-E Gulshan Rahman	Korai Kitchen (Jersey Cit...	Restaurateur	71	Restaurateur Gateway
135	Maricel Presilla	Cucharamama (Hoboken, per...	Restaurateur	71	Restaurateur Gateway
136	Jason Cichonski	Attico, Messina Social Cl...	Restaurateur	71	Restaurateur Gateway
137	Josh Moore	Instagram, TikTok, Facebo...	Food Blogger	71	FOMO Cascade
138	Angeliki Nakos & Jon D...	Instagram, TikTok, YouTub...	Food Blogger	71	FOMO Cascade
139	Becca Neckritz & Chris...	Instagram, TikTok	Food Blogger	71	FOMO Cascade
140	Lea Thierman & Ross Le...	Instagram, Website, Faceb...	Food Blogger	71	FOMO Cascade
141	Anyela Santos	Instagram, TikTok, Thread...	Food Blogger	71	FOMO Cascade
142	Morgan L. Wright	Instagram	Food Blogger	71	FOMO Cascade
143	Philly Tech Connect Po...	Philly Tech Connect Podca...	Media	71	Media Momentum Engin...
144	Nick Brown	Imaginary Ventures	VC	70	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
145	Antimo DiMeo	Bardea Food & Drink (flag...	Restaurateur	70	Restaurateur Gateway
146	Bryan Sikora	La Fia (Wilmington), Merc...	Restaurateur	70	Restaurateur Gateway
147	Chad Rosenthal	Mary's (Ambler, PA)	Restaurateur	70	Restaurateur Gateway
148	Will Langlois	Bar Lucca (Conshohocken, ...	Restaurateur	70	Restaurateur Gateway
149	Mario Casabona	TechLaunch / Casabona Ven...	Angel	69	Connector Express + ...
150	Gina Tedesco	Golden Seeds NJ / Amala V...	Angel	69	Connector Express + ...
151	Tri-State Connectors		Founder-Conn	69	Connector Express
152	Total Contacts: 21 ver...		Founder-Conn	69	Connector Express
153	Categories Covered:		Founder-Conn	69	Connector Express
154	Jerry Johnson	Axum Advisors / Broad Str...	Angel	68	Connector Express + ...
155	Kathleen Brunner	Acumen Analytics / Broad ...	Angel	68	Connector Express + ...
156	Jeff Snellenburg	PA Angel Network / Delawa...	Angel	68	Connector Express + ...
157	Liz Sigety	Delaware Crossing Investo...	Angel	68	Connector Express + ...
158	RoseAnn Rosenthal	Delaware's First Fund (al...	Angel	68	Connector Express + ...
159	PENNSYLVANIA		Accelerator	68	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
160	NEW JERSEY		Accelerator	68	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
161	DELAWARE		Accelerator	68	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
162	FOOD-TECH SPECIFIC		Accelerator	68	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
163	BONUS: ADDITIONAL PHIL...		Accelerator	68	Accelerator Fast-Tra...
164	Dan Richer	Razza Pizza Artigianale (...	Restaurateur	68	Restaurateur Gateway
165	Mollie Dronson	Instagram, Threads	Food Blogger	68	FOMO Cascade
166	Samantha Schwartz	Instagram, Linktree	Food Blogger	68	FOMO Cascade
167	Best Food Philly	Instagram	Food Blogger	68	FOMO Cascade

#	Name	Organization	Segment	Rank	Chain
168	Fueled On Philly	TikTok, Instagram	Food Blogger	68	FOMO Cascade
169	Kait Brown	TikTok	Food Blogger	68	FOMO Cascade
170	Hailee Catalano	TikTok, Instagram	Food Blogger	68	FOMO Cascade
171	Check, Please! Philly	TV (WHYY PBS), YouTube, S...	Food Blogger	68	FOMO Cascade
172	Nadia Chaudhury	Eater (Vox Media), previo...	Food Blogger	68	FOMO Cascade
173	Jen Honovic Herczeg	Edible Philly (print + di...	Food Blogger	68	FOMO Cascade
174	Naomi Townsend	Instagram	Food Blogger	68	FOMO Cascade
175	The Infatuation -- Phi...	Website, App, Instagram, ...	Food Blogger	68	FOMO Cascade
176	Ellen Yin	High Street Hospitality -...	Restaurateur	67	Restaurateur Gateway
177	Sam Calagione	Dogfish Head Brewings & E...	Restaurateur	67	Restaurateur Gateway
178	Katherine O'Neill	JumpStart NJ Angel Networ...	Angel	66	Connector Express + ...
179	Patricia Sigmon	Golden Seeds	Angel	66	Connector Express + ...
180	Robert Wolk	Princeton Alumni Angels /...	Angel	66	Connector Express + ...
181	Laurence Latimer	Princeton Alumni Angels /...	Angel	66	Connector Express + ...
182	Lori Rosenkopf	University of Pennsylvani...	University	66	University Pipeline
183	Trang Pham	University of Pennsylvani...	University	66	University Pipeline
184	Karl T. Ulrich	University of Pennsylvani...	University	66	University Pipeline
185	Jonathan Deutsch, Ph.D...	Drexel University	University	66	University Pipeline
186	Rob LaScala	Chicken Or The Egg (Long ...	Restaurateur	65	Restaurateur Gateway
187	Kae Lani Palmisano	TV (WHYY PBS), YouTube, I...	Food Blogger	65	FOMO Cascade
188	Maddy Sweitzer-Lamme	Instagram, X/Twitter, Web...	Food Blogger	65	FOMO Cascade
189	Jenn Ladd	Philadelphia Inquirer, X/...	Food Blogger	65	FOMO Cascade
190	Alex Tewfik	Philadelphia Magazine (fo...	Food Blogger	65	FOMO Cascade
191	Philadelphia-Based Fir...		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
192	NJ-Based Firms		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
193	NYC Food-Tech & Consum...		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
194	PHILADELPHIA-BASED FIR...		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
195	NJ-BASED FIRMS		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
196	NYC FOOD-TECH & CONSUM...		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
197	Safeguard Scientifics		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
198	Edison Partners		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
199	FinTech Collective		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
200	CIT GAP Funds		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
201	Delaware Innovation Fu...		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
202	Venture Associates of ...		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
203	CircleUp		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
204	KEY FOOD-TECH MARKET D...		VC	64	FOMO Cascade + NJ-to...
205	Chuck Dunn	Sysco (NYSE: SYY)	Food Industr	64	Food Industry Backdo...
206	Stephen R. Dyer	JumpStart NJ Angel Networ...	Angel	63	Connector Express + ...
207	Denita Henderson	University of Pennsylvani...	University	63	University Pipeline
208	Greg Fegley	Temple University	University	63	University Pipeline
209	Donna Marie De Carolis...	Drexel University	University	63	University Pipeline

#	Name	Organization	Segment	Rank	Chain
210	Charles Sacco	Drexel University	University	63	University Pipeline
211	Danya Henninger	Newsletter, LinkedIn, for...	Food Blogger	62	FOMO Cascade
212	Nolan Lewin	Rutgers University	University	61	University Pipeline
213	David McInerney	Baldor Specialty Foods	Food Industr	61	Food Industry Backdo...
214	PA, NJ, DE Angel Inves...		Angel	60	Connector Express + ...
215	Key Angel Groups - App...		Angel	60	Connector Express + ...
216	NJ Angel Tax Credit Ad...		Angel	60	Connector Express + ...
217	Recommended Next Steps		Angel	60	Connector Express + ...
218	FOOD EDITORS & WRITERS		Media	60	Media Momentum Engin...
219	TECH JOURNALISTS		Media	60	Media Momentum Engin...
220	STARTUP / VC JOURNALIS...		Media	60	Media Momentum Engin...
221	Sarah Huffman		Media	60	Media Momentum Engin...
222	Danya Henninger		Media	60	Media Momentum Engin...
223	PODCAST HOSTS		Media	60	Media Momentum Engin...
224	LOCAL TV FOOD SEGMENTS		Media	60	Media Momentum Engin...
225	BONUS / ADDITIONAL CON...		Media	60	Media Momentum Engin...
226	Key Angles by Audience		Media	60	Media Momentum Engin...
227	Jaime Sweet	University of Pennsylvani...	University	60	University Pipeline
228	Chef Jose Garces	Garces Group / IdEATion H...	NJ-DE-Suburb	60	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
229	Angel Ramirez	Amigos Restaurant / Rosa ...	NJ-DE-Suburb	60	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
230	Tri-State Area		Food Blogger	59	FOMO Cascade
231	Compiled: March 23, 20...		Food Blogger	59	FOMO Cascade
232	Anne-Marie Maman	Princeton University	University	58	University Pipeline
233	Paul Takhistov, Ph.D.	Rutgers University	University	58	University Pipeline
234	Shawn McCall, MBA	US Foods (NYSE: USFD)	Food Industr	58	Food Industry Backdo...
235	Tim Driscoll	Driscoll Foods	Food Industr	58	Food Industry Backdo...
236	Fuad Hannon	DoorDash (NASDAQ: DASH)	Food Industr	58	Food Industry Backdo...
237	Gary Musich	Visit Atlantic City	NJ-DE-Suburb	58	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
238	Chef Scott Anderson	Mistral Restaurant / Elem...	NJ-DE-Suburb	58	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
239	Ellen Weber	Temple University	University	57	University Pipeline
240	Dan Freeman, Ph.D.	University of Delaware	University	57	University Pipeline
241	Chef Antimo DiMeo	Bardea Restaurant Group	NJ-DE-Suburb	57	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
242	Terrain	Terrain (URBN Inc. brand)...	NJ-DE-Suburb	57	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
243	Tony Iannelli	Greater Lehigh Valley Cha...	NJ-DE-Suburb	57	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
244	Andrew Snyder	Graham Partners	PE	56	Connector Express (l...
245	Howard Migdal	Grubhub (owned by Wonder ...	Food Industr	56	Food Industry Backdo...
246	Sigrid Adriaenssens	Princeton University	University	55	University Pipeline
247	Jeffrey A. Robinson, P...	Rutgers University	University	55	University Pipeline
248	Jonathan Vassil	Toast (NYSE: TOST)	Food Industr	55	Food Industry Backdo...
249	Vinny Gallagher	Pizzata Pizzeria	Food Industr	55	Food Industry Backdo...
250	Marilyn Johnson	South Jersey Food Scene	NJ-DE-Suburb	55	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
251	Chef Giancarlo Generos...	Bally's Park Place (Atlan...	NJ-DE-Suburb	55	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...

#	Name	Organization	Segment	Rank	Chain
252	Robin Lapidus	Experience Princeton	NJ-DE-Suburb	55	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
253	Vince DiFelice	University of Delaware	University	54	University Pipeline
254	Johann Ducharme, Ph.D.	University of Delaware	University	54	University Pipeline
255	Scott Stein	Bardea Restaurant Group	NJ-DE-Suburb	54	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
256	Marty Grims	Fearless Restaurants (Whi...	NJ-DE-Suburb	54	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
257	Theresa M. Fera	Central Bucks Chamber of ...	NJ-DE-Suburb	54	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
258	Chef Tim Pervisi	Heirloom Doylestown	NJ-DE-Suburb	54	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
259	Mark & Deena Frank	The Inn at Barley Sheaf F...	NJ-DE-Suburb	54	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
260	Social Chain Strategy ...		Restaurateur	53	Restaurateur Gateway
261	Key Connection Point: ...		Restaurateur	53	Restaurateur Gateway
262	Mukesh M. Patel	Rutgers University	University	52	University Pipeline
263	Dave Kasinetz	Advanced Hospitality Syst...	Food Industr	52	Food Industry Backdo...
264	Jay Shin	Fibber's Sports Bar & Gri...	Food Industr	52	Food Industry Backdo...
265	Deborah Smith	JerseyBites.com / Foxtrot...	NJ-DE-Suburb	52	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
266	Chef Jason Hanin	The Ebbitt Room at The Vi...	NJ-DE-Suburb	52	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
267	Bilal & Celal Bodur	Aspendos Mediterranean Cu...	NJ-DE-Suburb	52	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
268	Andrew Richards	Swander Pace Capital (SPC...	PE	51	Connector Express (l...
269	Andrew Heyer	Mistral Equity Partners	PE	51	Connector Express (l...
270	Justin R. Green	Palladium Equity Partners	PE	51	Connector Express (l...
271	Ayanna Khan	Delaware Black Chamber of...	NJ-DE-Suburb	51	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
272	Bernard Dagenais	The Main Line Chamber of ...	NJ-DE-Suburb	51	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
273	Avram Hornik	FCM Hospitality (Lola's G...	NJ-DE-Suburb	51	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
274	MainLine Investment Pa...	MainLine Investment Partn...	PE	50	Connector Express (l...
275	Date: 2026-03-23		University	49	University Pipeline
276	Total Contacts: 19		University	49	University Pipeline
277	Joe Massaro	Pennsylvania Restaurant &...	Food Industr	49	Food Industry Backdo...
278	Andrew Howell	Baldor Specialty Foods	Food Industr	49	Food Industry Backdo...
279	Christina Renna	Chamber of Commerce South...	NJ-DE-Suburb	49	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
280	Daniel Klim	New Jersey Restaurant & H...	NJ-DE-Suburb	49	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
281	Henk Hartong III	Brynwood Partners	PE	48	Connector Express (l...
282	Centre Partners	Centre Partners Managemen...	PE	48	Connector Express (l...
283	Carrie Leishman	Delaware Restaurant Assoc...	NJ-DE-Suburb	48	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
284	Michael Quaranta	Delaware State Chamber of...	NJ-DE-Suburb	48	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
285	Lehigh Valley Economic...	Lehigh Valley Economic De...	NJ-DE-Suburb	48	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
286	Daniel Klim, MS	New Jersey Restaurant & H...	Food Industr	47	Food Industry Backdo...
287	Carrie Leishman	Delaware Restaurant Assoc...	Food Industr	46	Food Industry Backdo...
288	Liat Krawczyk	NJ AI Hub (Princeton Univ...	NJ-DE-Suburb	46	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
289	Eric Melloul	Verlinvest	PE	45	Connector Express (l...
290	Andrew C. Taub	L Catterton	PE	45	Connector Express (l...
291	Saeed Amidi	Plug and Play Tech Center...	NJ-DE-Suburb	43	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
292	Helen Chiang	American Securities	PE	42	Connector Express (l...
293	SOUTH JERSEY		NJ-DE-Suburb	40	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...

#	Name	Organization	Segment	Rank	Chain
294	PRINCETON / ROUTE 1 CO...		NJ-DE-Suburb	40	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
295	WILMINGTON / DELAWARE		NJ-DE-Suburb	40	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
296	MAIN LINE		NJ-DE-Suburb	40	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
297	BUCKS COUNTY		NJ-DE-Suburb	40	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
298	LEHIGH VALLEY / READIN...		NJ-DE-Suburb	40	NJ-to-NYC Bridge + R...
299	FOOD DISTRIBUTORS		Food Industr	38	Food Industry Backdo...
300	RESTAURANT POS / TECH		Food Industr	38	Food Industry Backdo...
301	FOOD DELIVERY PLATFORM...		Food Industr	38	Food Industry Backdo...
302	FOOD INDUSTRY ORGANIZA...		Food Industr	38	Food Industry Backdo...
303	BONUS: DISTRIBUTOR OPE...		Food Industr	38	Food Industry Backdo...
304	Key Talking Points by ...		Food Industr	38	Food Industry Backdo...
305	For Distributors :		Food Industr	38	Food Industry Backdo...
306	For POS/Tech :		Food Industr	38	Food Industry Backdo...
307	For Delivery Platforms...		Food Industr	38	Food Industry Backdo...
308	For Industry Associati...		Food Industr	38	Food Industry Backdo...
309	Key Takeaways		PE	33	Connector Express (I...